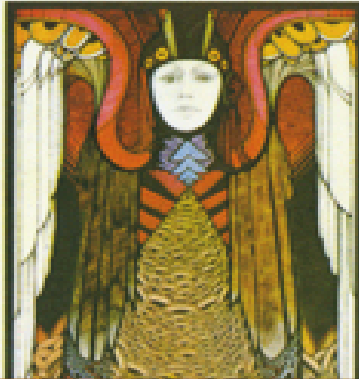


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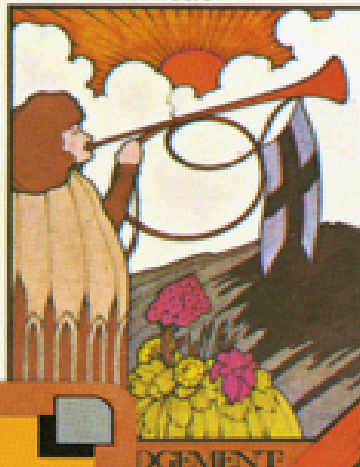


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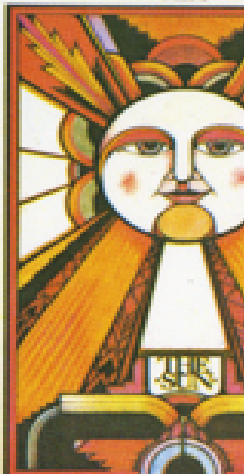


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JUDGEMENT

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VIII



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XXI



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4880 Lower Valley Rd.
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To Goethe
whose valedictory for a suffering humanity was “More light!”

Classic Tarot Spreads
by Sandor Konraad

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Library of Congress Control Number: 84-62282
ISBN: 978-0-914918-64-6
978-1-5073-0166-1 (EPUB)

Edited by Marah Ren
Cover design by Ralph Poness and Robert Killam
Illustrations by Todd Sweet
Graphics by Robert Killam
Typeset by Patrice LeBlanc

Published by Whitford Press
A Division of Schiffer Publishing, Ltd.
4880 Lower Valley Road
Atglen, PA 19310
Phone: (610) 593-1777; Fax: (610) 593-2002
E-mail: Info@schifferbooks.com
Web: www.schifferbooks.com

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Preface

It is not difficult to find books on the Tarot. Most of them, however, dwell upon the history, symbology, mythological associations, archetypal imagery, and metaphysical meanings of the cards. What is generally glossed over—or in many cases, omitted entirely—is the simple fact that the 78-card Tarot pack is a magical tool that will provide answers to any questions, help solve problems, or clear the way for difficult decision-making that an individual may be facing at a given moment in time. Before one can receive this help, it is only necessary to know how to spread the cards and read and interpret them in divination.

This book deals with this “hands on” aspect of the Tarot. Tarot texts often confuse the beginning student by offering multiple meanings of each card, which places a weighty burden on memory. In this book, the potential reader will find only the essential meanings needed for doing a reading. Additional meanings will be perceived by the reader through experience.

Some intelligent and skillful readers know only one or two ways of spreading the cards, which makes it difficult for them to answer certain types of questions or to do in-depth readings. It is important to have a variety of spreads at one’s command because each spread is designed for answering certain types of questions.

The transcripts of client readings in the final section of this book offer examples of card and spread synthesis.

For the individual who wishes to apply the mighty and mysterious powers of the Tarot for living a saner and wiser life—or helping others to do so—the important thing is to handle the cards, practice the spreads, and begin to do readings.

By de-mystifying the meanings and providing a schematic, simplified, and readable set of guidelines, this book will help you to do that in no time

at all.

Confessions of a Reluctant Tarot Reader

A dry cleaning shop seems an unlikely place to be hit by lightning but that is where it all began. I had presented my garment claim-check to the young woman behind the counter and upon glancing at the name on the ticket her features lit up and she exclaimed, “Mr. Konraad—oh, you’re the man who is into the Tarot!”

One did not have to be Sherlock Holmes to figure out how she had made the connection between the Tarot and me, for her accent indicated that she hailed from the South. Since the chamber maid at the New England guest home where I was staying for the summer was also from that region, it was possible that the two women were friends or roommates and had compared notes. My room at the guest home was brimming over with occult works—including one dealing with the Tarot, along with a Tarot pack.

But what this young woman did not know was that I was hardly “into” the Tarot but rather a total neophyte. A few weeks earlier I had gained permission from the headmaster of the school where I teach to set up a course in parapsychology and was summering at this salt-air village on Cape Cod for the purpose of preparing the curriculum. It was to be a survey course and the Tarot was only something I added at the last minute because the day before I left New York City for the Cape I had stopped off at an occult book shop to pick up some research materials and a book on Tarot found its way into my purchases. I selected a Tarot pack as well so as to familiarize myself with the imagery on the cards.

So, when the woman behind the counter in the dry cleaners said, “Oh, you’re the man who is into the Tarot!,” I was quick to correct her

misconception by telling her the truth of the matter. “So you see,” I ended my explanation lamely, “I know next to nothing about the Tarot.”

The woman, however, desperately wanted a reading and was not going to take no for an answer.

Somehow the words I intended were not what came out of my mouth for I found myself saying, “I have never done a reading in my life but I guess there has to be a first time for everything.”

While waiting for my first consultant to arrive I was having second thoughts. For one thing, I was somewhat shaky on the meanings of the cards in divination so I would have to keep thumbing through the Tarot book during the reading, which would be awkward at best.

Then too, my involvement with Tarot stemmed from its probable inclusion in the survey course on the occult that I was preparing. If I were to take up the Tarot at all in the course it would be in a scholarly vein: I planned to approach it historically and trace its origins and evolution over the centuries. Probably too, I would get into the symbolism of the beautiful and mysterious cards and discuss how the images related to ancient mythology and medieval history.

But to spread the cards and peer into the future—that was something else. Connected as it was in my mind with sleazy gypsy store-fronts and all one’s questions on love, marriage, and career, there seemed to be something disreputable about it.

But more than anything else I was not convinced that the cards actually worked. I mean, how could they? It went against all rules of logic to think that a few cards selected at random could possibly relate to a person’s life and foretell the future with any degree of accuracy—it did not make sense. I was about to make my way to the phone and beg off from what was clearly a ludicrous project when a knock at the door indicated that the young woman had arrived and with great reluctance I would have to go through with the charade.

I smiled grimly in an attempt to put a good face on the enterprise, drew up a table and chairs, and asked the woman to sit down. In what was probably a vain attempt to hide my skepticism, I asked her if she had a question concerning the future for which she sought an answer. She looked thoughtful for a moment and then said, “Yes, a’mm wonderin’ how a’mm goin’ to do in graduate school next year.”

After handing her the pack to shuffle, I then threw my first spread according to the method given in Rolla Nordic's *The Tarot Shows the Path* (Samuel Weiser, Inc.: New York, 1979).

When I had turned over all the cards in the spread my worst fears were realized for none of the cards that came up seemed to have any bearing on the young woman's question. It was at this point that I realized that if the Tarot worked at all it had little or nothing to do with the cutting or shuffling or the pattern in which the cards were arranged but everything to do with ESP (extra sensory perception). It was all coming together now: A reader probably employed a Tarot pack in much the manner a psychic used a crystal ball. This was an interesting insight but I had the feeling that the young person seated across from me at the table was more concerned with an answer to her question than an explanation of how it was achieved. As I had never been accused of being psychic, I feared I would have no answer to give her.

I managed to mumble something and then replaced the cards in the pack and we repeated the process of shuffling and spreading the cards. Once again the cards were turned over and I gazed at them with quiet horror for it was now becoming increasingly clear that this was turning into a fiasco of the first magnitude. I understood enough of the Tarot deck at this point to know that the suit of Wands and the suit of Coins both had to do with career-related questions and there was not a single Wand or Coin card in the spread! I was tempted to tell my first—and probably last—consultant that the Tarot was obviously some kind of hoax that had been perpetuated over the centuries and as intelligent human beings we should realize that attempting to divine the future with pieces of colored cardboard had to be an exercise in futility and the last word in silliness.

But for some reason I did not.

For one thing, I noticed that some of the same cards that had been in the first spread had reappeared in the second one. Considering that the Tarot pack contains seventy-eight cards and that there were fewer than ten cards in the spreads I had thrown, the reappearance of several seemed a remarkable coincidence even though the cards did not seem to relate to the question. I made some perfunctory remarks and then once again we repeated the shuffling and spreading ritual—only this time I shuffled the pack with special thoroughness before handing it to the consultant to shuffle.

On this occasion, when the cards in the spread were turned over, I was amazed to see some of the same cards that had appeared in the other two spreads! Perhaps even more amazing, they were in roughly the same positions! Clearly the Tarot had absolutely no respect for the Law of Averages.

“Elaine, I am going to be honest with you,” I said, upon regaining some semblance of my composure. “There is absolutely nothing here about graduate school.”

“Nothing?”

“Nothing! But let me ask you this: Are you interested right now in a certain young man?,” and I then proceeded to describe the young man as signified by the Page of Cups.

She replied in the affirmative.

“Okay, now we’re getting somewhere,” I said, “and since the Queen of Swords appears to be an obstacle, I am going to ask you, is there an older woman in the picture—someone rather opinionated and domineering,—quite possibly the young man’s mother?”

“Why yes, that is absolutely correct,” Elaine replied.

“Well, let’s look at the matter straight,” I said. “I can’t answer your question about graduate school for the Tarot is not talking about graduate school. What the Tarot is talking about is your relationship with this young man and the problem concerning his mother, so why don’t we pursue that question for the rest of the reading?”

Elaine was only too happy to comply, and by the end of the reading I was able to tell her that there would be hurdles to overcome, particularly the man’s mother, but that by exercising patience, understanding, and tact with this woman, she would be successful.

After Elaine had left I went over the reading in my mind and it became increasingly clear that something was happening during the course of the reading although I was not quite sure what. For one thing, each spread was coherent and all of a piece. The information in regard to past and present aspects of a question was verified by the consultant. In an hour-long reading the Tarot was consistent; if it said something was likely to occur in the future it always said substantially the same thing when returning to the same question—it never contradicted itself. Against all laws of chance, some of the same cards kept reappearing in successive spreads. I also realized that the Tarot was not fortune-telling in the sense of telling you

what is going to happen *to* you, but rather that it identified the responsibility of the individual by pointing out what the likely outcome would be if *you* were to choose a particular course of action. The outcome predicted by the Tarot might be positive or negative but the individual clearly had the option of exercising free will in the matter. So more than anything the Tarot appeared to act as a non-directive counselor.

But to me the single most incredible aspect of the reading was the fact that the Tarot did not bother with the question articulated by the consultant but rather selected the unspoken question of her psyche, acting as not only a wise counselor but as a highly perceptive psychologist as well!

The reading had actually answered two sets of questions: The consultant wanted to know what course of action to pursue concerning her young man and the Tarot had told her. But the hidden agenda of the reading had to do with my own reservations about the Tarot and it was brought home to me that the Tarot worked and was a force for good.

It is one thing to accept something and quite another to become truly involved with it and I doubt that I would have gone any further with the Tarot had it not been for another “coincidence” that occurred upon my return to New York at the end of the summer. I do not have my mail forwarded when I leave town for an extended period and so my tendency upon returning is to wade through the accumulated printed matter in a rather cavalier fashion and toss most of it into the circular file.

My wastebasket was soon screaming for mercy and I prided myself on having made a clean sweep. One letter, however, managed to tumble on to the floor, and I decided that this act of *chutzpah* on the part of a seemingly inanimate object had earned the letter a respectful reading. Wonder of wonders: It was an invitation to sign up for a course on Tarot by Rolla Nordic. I knew she was considered a leading authority on Tarot and I had brought her book with me to the Cape that summer. In thinking about how she got my name, there was a perfectly logical explanation for she had been a guest lecturer at a course on the occult that I had taken at the New School during the spring and she had most likely obtained the list of student names and addresses from the instructor.

So it all made sense. Perfectly logical. Easily explained. But still—there was something about the whole thing I couldn’t quite put my finger on. Coincidence is what they call it but it was around this time that I was beginning to realize that calling something “coincidence” may well be the

last refuge of the superstitious. Without further ado I signed up for the course and the Tarot has been my friend and counselor ever since.

Well, not entirely. If the truth be told, that last statement needs to be amended somewhat. For almost immediately I tried the Tarot on friends and kin who all commented on the accuracy of the readings and how they had been helped by them. Weeks or months later I would run into somebody I had read and the person would tell me that a future trend had turned out exactly as predicted and when they followed a course of action prescribed by the Tarot, the results had been everything the Tarot said they would be.

But while I was quick to consult the Tarot for others, I was hesitant to read my own cards and I realized much later that in the back of my mind I was still harboring some small measure of reluctance. In a sense, the Tarot was a prophet without honor in its own country for while I was generous in dispensing its prescriptions for others, I was slow to accept them for myself. But the events of the following summer were to change that rather radically.

With the cheerful sounds of Pomp and Circumstance at my school's commencement exercises I began to give serious thought to what I would do over the summer. Somebody has said that there are three reasons for going into teaching: June, July, and August. For many, there is a fourth reason, plugged into the first three, which is "getting away."

In regard to destination this particular summer, there was absolutely no question at all in my mind as to where I wanted to go for I hungered to return to that ocean Eden on the Cape that I had discovered the previous summer in setting up my parapsychology course. The only question was how I was going to fund it. I decided I was getting too old to be a waiter or a bellman and so I sifted other possibilities but failed to come up with anything concrete. Then the thought struck me, "Why not work as a Tarot reader?" But the more I thought about it the less viable it seemed as an option. Logic certainly dictated against it for there was the question of what I could use as a base of operations, how people would find out about me, and of course, the minor detail of earning enough through readings to pay my summer expenses. Logically, pragmatically, and realistically it was indeed a cuckoo idea.

About a week passed and I had just about reached the point where sanity was beginning to prevail and I was talking sense to myself and preparing to abandon what was obviously a harebrained enterprise when the

Great Light Bulb in the sky lit up with the subliminal message flashing: “Ask the Tarot!”

It was with some trepidation that I removed my Tarot pack from the wooden box in which it resides and put the question to the cards. Nervously, I threw a spread, turned the cards over and found it hard to believe the sight that greeted my eyes. For there in the same spread were the Four of Coins (monetary attainment), the Four of Wands (more monetary attainment), The Empress and The Emperor (success), The Chariot (victory), the Ten of Coins or “Wall Street Card,” (hitting the jackpot) and The Sun (happiness) and The World (joy) tossed in for good measure.

“Tarot,” I said, “this is no time for horseplay. I am asking a serious question and I want a serious answer.” I shuffled and threw a different spread. Again, there was an embarrassment of riches. Could it be? Was it possible? But after an hour’s worth of spreads my last shred of reluctance had vanished. The Tarot was deadly serious and it was telling me that the life of a Tarot reader—at least, for the summer on Cape Cod—would give me both monetary and spiritual fulfillment. At this point I knew that there were times when the Tarot was shouting and this was clearly one of them.

Tossing abandon to the winds I packed my gear and set out for the Cape.

Admittedly, I was a bit apprehensive about the undertaking. I mean, I knew only that it was going to work—the Tarot had assured me of that—but I had no idea as to *how* it was going to work and not a single thought of where to start. And it had to work if I was not to return home in a barrel as my funds unaided by supplementary income would only see me through about half the summer.

Things were off to a good start, however, as I had been fortunate in securing a room at the last minute in the same charming guest home I had spent the previous summer. This proved to be a happy circumstance in several ways as the house itself—or rather, its owner—was to play a central role in the unfolding drama.

Upon my arrival I told the woman who ran the guest home what I had in mind. She merely looked thoughtful.

After unpacking I set out for a walk but just as I was going out the door this kind soul came up to me and said, “Mr. Konraad, would you have any objections to a story appearing in the local paper about what you are planning to do this summer?”

I gulped and allowed that I would have no particular objections. “Mrs. Kindsoul” informed me that she had a granddaughter, Karen, who was a reporter on the local paper. She then called Karen and an interview was set up for later in the week.

In the interim I wondered whether a newspaper story was going to do me more harm than good. For I had picked up the local weekly and saw that it was a fairly conservative paper in a fairly conservative community. And my impression of newspaper people was that they tended to be rather hard nosed about anything to do with the occult and I was fearful that possibly this Cape Cod reporter might turn out to be one of those “fearless” crusaders against anything and everything to do with the occult.

During the course of the interview it was impossible to perceive Karen’s inner responses to the answers I was giving to her questions. At the conclusion of the interview I read Karen’s cards and throughout the reading she remained inscrutable. So it was with some trepidation a few days later I picked up the paper and turned to the story. After looking over the lead I realized that my fears had been groundless, for the reading of Karen’s cards had been in her words, “very much on the money,” and the overall article was a ringing acclamation.

A day or so after the story appeared I received a phone call from a woman who had read the story and wanted a reading but in the interest of discretion she asked me if I could come out to her place. I didn’t tell her that I had no place of my own—I didn’t think Mrs. Kindsoul would have been particularly wild about my doing readings in the front parlor of her guest home—and merely replied that I would be happy to oblige. The reading proved to be an awesome experience for the woman held court in a sumptuous villa overlooking the sea where she played hostess to the Beautiful People who happened to be passing through. As it turned out, this woman had a single question: Would she get the million dollars she was asking from her ex-husband? The culminating cards of the first spread I threw for her were the Ten of Coins in the “immediate future” slot and The World as the “outcome.” So without hesitation (I had learned to trust the Tarot fully by this time) I told her, “Not only will you get the million dollars you are asking for, but you will get it soon.” The precision of the Tarot in this instance was striking for I later learned that this woman’s attorney had called her *the following day* to tell her that the offer had come through. Another consultant might have regarded this as coincidence but this woman

definitely did not and she called everybody she knew—and she knew everybody—and told them about the reading and from that point on, the telephone at Mrs. Kindsoul's guest home started to ring for Mr. Konraad—and it simply didn't stop.

The summer proved to be everything (and more) that the Tarot said it would be. And it happened in a way that no amount of logic, common sense, or practiced thinking could have foreseen. It came about through the individual efforts of an unlikely trinity—the owner of a guest home, a journalist, and a divorcee!

Toward the end of that summer I was strolling down the local Main Street when I happened upon Elaine, my first consultant, who it turned out was in town only for the day. She looked wonderful and there was a glow about her.

“How was graduate school?,” I asked.

Elaine broke into a radiant grin. “Absolutely marvelous,” she answered, “it couldn't have been better.”

She punctuated her statement by giving me her hand and I noticed there was a sparkling addition on her third finger.

“Congratulations!,” I said. “Tell me, was it the Page of Cups?”

“The Page of Cups it was—and is,” she answered. “I really want to thank you for what you told me. It all happened just as you said.”

“Oh, don't thank me, thank the Tarot; I was merely the middle man. But in any event, it is I who should be thanking you.”

“Good heavens, why?,” she exclaimed.

“Because if you hadn't asked for the reading, I don't know that I would have ever learned the secret of the Tarot. I mean, I might have just gone along for years treating it as an abstraction—you know, sort of an interesting curiosity. In all likelihood, I would have gone the road of so many others and simply placed it on a shelf and forgotten about it. But you forced me to put it to the test and it passed with flying colors. And that realization has literally changed my life.

“So, Elaine, thank *you* so much!”

Part One

Exploring Inner Space: Reading and Interpreting the Cards in Divination

A Tarot reading could be likened to a journey into space: The craft in this case is an unlikely transport vehicle for it is the seventy-eight-card pack of the Tarot. The pilot is the consultant, that is, the individual being read. Or, more specifically, it is the unconscious mind of that person. So this space journey differs from other space flights in that it could be seen as a journey into *inner* space. Quite literally, a journey into the mind.

For many people this is unexplored terrain and so this inner space journey can be quite revealing. Often the Tarot will pick up the question consciously posed but it always goes beyond the superficial and reveals the root of a problem or question.

To the uninitiated, a Tarot reading is fortune-telling. Every once in a while you will hear someone say, “I am going to a Tarot reader to have my fortune told.” Nothing could be further from the truth.

But if a Tarot reading is not fortune-telling, what exactly is it? Quite possibly, it is not *exactly* anything but it could be likened to weather forecasting in that a certain pattern can be foreseen with certain probable results.

Most people tune in to a weather report before they leave for work in the morning not so much to find out what the weather is going to *do* to them, but rather, what *they* can do about the weather and that involves preparation. In short, they prepare to cope with *probable* conditions.

It is the same with a Tarot reading. The reader does not say what is going to happen to you but rather, what trends will be developing and what will be the probable outcome if a certain course of action is followed.

The major difference between a weather forecast and a Tarot reading is that the Tarot forecast is generally more accurate. The reason for this is that there are usually more variables in a weather forecast than in a Tarot reading. In a Tarot reading, most people have questions that have to do with their own decisions concerning a particular course of action.

Weather forecasting is aided by arrow-chasing area maps that reveal that the drop in the mercury expected the following day is not something that just simply happens but rather is connected to other atmospheric events that can be clearly seen on the map.

Now it is just possible that the pattern of our lives could also be “mapped” in some similar way. It is significant that most Tarot spreads deal not only with future time but also past and present. There is a reason for that as what we do or become in the future is the culminating point of a pattern of thoughts and actions rooted in the past and evolving in the present.

On another level the card of the past in a spread can aid the reader in counseling. Let us say that a young man comes for a reading. You learn that he is going with a girl but is not sure he wants to marry her. Now if the other cards in the spread indicate that his fears are groundless and that she is right for him, look very carefully at that card of the past. If, for example, that card is the Three of Swords—which usually means separation or divorce—it would indicate that he came from a broken home and fears making the same kind of marriage his parents did. You can then tell him that either he or his parents probably had a karmic debt to pay but there is absolutely no reason for him to fear that the same thing will happen to him for the Three of Swords—the “bad marriage” card—is not in the future, it is in the past, and therefore he has no cause for worry for there is only one Three of Swords in the Tarot pack and as far as he is concerned it is in the past and will remain in the past.

We have at this point perhaps a somewhat clearer view of the mechanics involved in a reading. But there is one question we have not taken up. And that is the real question. It might be phrased piecemeal: *Who* or *what* is the Tarot? *How* does it know what it knows? And finally, how does it deliver the goods in a reading? Important questions, all of them, but

no one seems to know the answers. Let us attempt a supposition: Let us take as our starting point the belief that there is a Force or Being that is *omniscient*. And the Tarot is “the hot line” to this Cosmic Mind. In the ritual of cutting and shuffling the cards the consultant is, in effect, “dialing” the answer. And if we go one step further and make the assumption that this force is not only omniscient but also *omnipotent*, it would be the simplest of cosmic tasks to program a Tarot reading while the consultant is shuffling the pack.

This explanation is admittedly difficult to accept rationally but anyone who has ever witnessed or participated in a Tarot reading knows that something is happening that defies normal explanations. If a theory offers a reasonable description of something that would be otherwise unexplainable, it seems prudent to use it. The Tarot is a thing of beauty and a thing of truth but most mysterious. As Albert Einstein said, “The most beautiful experience we can have is the mysterious.”

Let us now get into the preliminaries of doing a reading. The logical first step is to acquire a Tarot pack. It might be pointed out that while there are a number of different Tarot packs on the market, there are basically two types—the illustrated and non-illustrated. That is to say that in an illustrated deck, the fifty-six cards of the Minor Arcana depict scenes of people doing things; in a non-illustrated pack, these Minor Arcana cards bear only the symbols of the suit they represent such as Swords or Cups. If you are coming as a novice to the Tarot it would be best to start with a *non-illustrated* deck such as the Richard Gardner pack, the Oswald Wirth deck, or the Tarot de Marseilles. The vocabulary of the Tarot is limited to seventy-eight images and while a given card might mean one thing in one reading, in another reading, the same card might take on a somewhat different shade of meaning. If you start with an illustrated pack you are really beginning with a handicap for the inclination will be to confine your interpretation to the scene depicted on the card rather than to exercise your imagination and subconscious. In fact, in some cases the scene depicted is actually at variance with the traditional meaning of the card, which is confusing at best and can certainly help to distort a reading.

Another reason is that the Tarot is a magickal tool (This spelling is used to signify authentic magick as opposed to the illusory variety.) and the symbols are considered to be more effective when unadorned.

Illustrated packs do have their place in certain types of readings, but are really not the best with which to learn. Some illustrated decks such as the Rider pack and the Morgan-Greer pack are really quite beautiful and most suitable for meditation or certain types of spreads, particularly ones done in a life reading (see [Part Three](#)).

After acquiring your Tarot pack it would be good to become acquainted with it by holding each card face up in your hand and experiencing the impressions you receive. You might even try this before you read the meanings and later learn that some of your first impressions were pretty close to the mark. This would work best for the twenty-two cards of the Major Arcana for in all packs these cards have human figures on them and it is quite easy to relate to them. Try the Minor Arcana cards also and record your impressions. For instance, you could be looking at the Ten of Coins and feel that those ten large gold pieces represent a lot of money and you would be right for that card is known as the “Wall Street Card.”

When you have finished examining the cards return them to the container in which they came. Always complete the ritual of a reading by putting away the cards. Before you do so it would be well to go through the pack and make sure that all cards are in the upright position in preparation for the next reading. An extra touch is to “seal” the pack in a positive way by placing benevolent cards—such as the card of The Sun and the card of The World—at the top and bottom of the deck.

You can also procure a cloth, preferably purple, and preferably silk or velvet, to wrap your cards in and perhaps a wooden box to contain them. You first return them to the cardboard box in which they came, then wrap the purple cloth around them, and the final step is to place them in the wooden box. The reason for all this is that Tarot packs are considered to be highly sensitive to all vibrations and so when not in use it is best to protect them in the manner just described. It is difficult to say exactly how important the above is regarding the effectiveness of the pack in a reading but what is of considerable importance is the reader’s *attitude*. Compliance to Tarot traditions is an indication of her or his seriousness and respect for the Tarot.

One other thing: Never lend your pack to anyone else. It is yours and yours alone.

SUMMARY OF PRELIMINARY STEPS

Acquire Tarot pack.
Familiarize yourself with the cards.
Shuffle deck thoroughly.
Make sure all cards are upright.
“Seal” the pack by placing benevolent cards
at the top and bottom.
Return pack to original cardboard box.
Wrap purple cloth around it.
Place it in a wooden box which has a cover or lid.

The next step is the all-important one of learning the meanings of the cards. There are seventy-eight cards each with a meaning of its own. Tips will be given shortly in regard to looking for patterns that will considerably facilitate the learning process. Best not to try to digest it all at once but rather do it slowly. If you are willing to devote half an hour to an hour a day to learning the Tarot for one month you will find that by the end of the month you will be able to do reliable readings for yourself and others without the need to refer to this or any other book. In fact, it is best that you do not let yourself get into the habit of doing “open book readings.” First of all, you are not going to inspire much confidence in the people you read if you have to keep thumbing through a book. Second, and more important, stopping to refer to a book hampers the imagination and serves to disrupt the rhythm and chemistry of a Tarot reading.

Here is a suggested schedule for learning the Tarot in a thirty-day period. This program will allow you to do readings with competence and in time you will be an accomplished reader.

Schedule for Learning the Tarot in Thirty Days

- Day 1: Learn the basic patterns (see below) of the Major Arcana, the Minor Arcana, and the numerical correspondences of the first ten cards of both the Major and Minor Arcana.
- Day 2: Learn the correspondences and meanings of the #1 cards in both the Major and Minor Arcana—The Magician and the four Aces.

Take the cards out of the pack and meditate upon them. After you do so, associate each card with the meaning attributed to it.

Day 3: Review the meanings of the #1 cards. Learn the meanings of all #2 cards. Study and meditate upon the #2 cards. Take all #1 and #2 cards out of the deck and using those ten cards only, throw a spread (see [Part Two](#)) that uses less than ten cards such as the Horseshoe or Eastern Cross. Read and interpret the cards, referring to the book only after you have done the best you can without it. From here on, only the new cards to be learned for each day will be given but the method (described above) of review, studying and meditating upon the new cards, selecting all cards learned and using them in a reading, is the plan to follow each day.

Day 4: Learn the meanings of all #3 cards and repeat process given for Day 3.

Days 5–15: Concentrating on one number a day, continue to learn the meanings of all cards #4 through #15, repeating the process given for Day 3.

Day 16: Review everything to date.

Day 17: If you have been following the schedule, you have learned all fifty-six cards of the Minor Arcana; there are only eight more cards in the Major Arcana to learn! The emphasis from this point on will be review. Review all #1 cards. Learn card #15, The Devil, and repeat process given for Day 3.

Day 18: Review all #2 cards. Learn card #16, The Lightning-Struck Tower, and repeat process given for Day 3.

Day 19: Review all #3 cards. Learn card #17, The Star, and repeat process given for Day 3.

Day 20: Review all #4 cards. Learn card #18, The Moon, and repeat process given for Day 3.

Day 21: Review all #5 cards. Learn card #19, The Sun, and repeat process given for Day 3.

Day 22: Review all #6 cards. Learn card #20, Day of Judgment, and repeat process given for Day 3.

Day 23: Review all #7 cards. Learn card #21, The World, and repeat process given for Day 3.

Day 24: Review all #8 cards. Learn The Unnumbered Card (The Fool) and repeat process given for Day 3.

Day 25: Review all #9 and #10 cards and repeat process given for Day 3.
Day 26: Review all #11 and #12 cards and repeat process given for Day 3.
Day 27: Review all #13 and #14 cards and repeat process given for Day 3.
Day 28: Review Major Arcana cards #15, 16, 17 and 18 and repeat process given for Day 3.
Day 29: Review Major Arcana cards #19, 20, 21 and the card of The Fool and repeat process given for Day 3.
Day 30: Take a break—you have earned it!

Basic Patterns

Knowing how to recognize patterns can be a tremendous boon to the beginning student for with this knowledge under your belt you can do a general reading almost immediately and certainly long before you have mastered the individual meanings of each card in the seventy-eight-card Tarot deck. Some students of the Tarot may not have the time or inclination to commit seventy-eight cards to memory but might be interested in a short-cut method that would enable them to do readings of a general nature. If that is the case, this section on patterns can be both the starting and stopping point for you. Once you have mastered the few simple steps outlined here, you can do a coherent and intelligible reading. If you plan to do in-depth readings, you can work with pattern analysis while you are learning the ropes.

So whatever your desires or intentions, this section is the place to start.

The first thing to note is that the seventy-eight-card Tarot pack has a division into twenty-two cards of the Major Arcana and fifty-six cards of the Minor Arcana. There is also the subdivision of the Court Cards within the Minor Arcana of the kings, queens, knights, and pages. Now, let us get into the actual patterns:

Major Arcana

For the most part, the twenty-two cards in this category represent psychological states of mind or people. If there is a predominance of Major Arcana cards in a spread and the cards are basically positive, this would indicate a psychologically healthy person and one who could master events. These are the easiest cards to interpret in the Tarot for the figures depicted on the cards are usually a strong indication of whether the card is positive or negative in divination. The card of The Empress is clearly positive for an empress is a leader and the woman on the card is smiling and happy. The card of The Devil, as the name alone would suggest, is extremely negative and is further reinforced by the depiction of a frightening creature and two captives bound in chains.

Minor Arcana

Whereas the cards of the Major Arcana largely depict psychological states or people, the cards of the Minor Arcana have to do with material events. There are four suits in the Minor Arcana—Coins, Wands, Cups, and Swords—and each represents a different type of condition. Following are the primary guidelines:

Coins—questions having to do with money or business.

Wands—questions having to do with school, career, or creative ventures.

Cups—questions having to do with relationships, love, romance, marriage, and family.

Swords—questions having to do with problems, sorrows, afflictions.

Court Cards

As mentioned above, these cards are the kings, queens, knights, and pages and technically are part of the Minor Arcana but are really in a class by themselves. Although there are only sixteen of these cards in a seventy-eight-card deck, it is a rare spread that does not contain one or more of them and the reason for that is that they represent people and most people's questions have to do with other people.

If a king appears the question has to do with a man; a queen, a woman; and a page, a child or young man or woman. The one exception in the Court

Cards is the knight, or horseman, which does not represent a person (usually) but rather, a person's thoughts. What type of thoughts would be indicated by the suit? The Knight of Coins would be thoughts about money or business; the Knight of Wands, thoughts about school or career; the Knight of Cups, romantic or loving thoughts; and the Knight of Swords, unhappy or bitter thoughts.

Numerical Correspondences

A truly major pattern has to do with the numbers on the cards. Cards bearing the same number will share some qualities in common. For example, since 1 is the first of the numbers and stands alone, anything under a 1-vibration will have qualities of independence and leadership. Since 1 is the starting point of the root numbers, the vibration is associated with beginnings, often of a powerful nature. All of these traits are exemplified by the Number One card of the Major Arcana, The Magician, and the four aces of the Minor Arcana.

These numerical correspondences are most clearly discerned by the cards bearing the root numbers one to nine. If you will memorize the root number pattern along with the pattern of the four suits of the Minor Arcana—Coins, Wands, Cups, and Swords—you will be amazed at the results when you sit down to do a reading *based on these patterns alone*.

Here is a table of root numbers with the meaning of each number as it applies in divination along with the corresponding cards from both the Major and Minor Arcana.

Table of Root Number Associations in the Major and Minor Arcana
--

1

Major Arcana: The Magician

Minor Arcana: Ace of Coins, Wands, Cups, and Swords

Divinatory Meaning: Beginnings

2

Major Arcana: The High Priestess

Minor Arcana: Two of Coins, Wands, Cups, and Swords

Divinatory Meaning: Conflict

3

Major Arcana: The Empress

Minor Arcana: Three of Coins, Wands, Cups, and Swords

Divinatory Meaning: Career

4

Major Arcana: The Emperor

Minor Arcana: Four of Coins, Wands, Cups, and Swords

Divinatory Meaning: Attainment

5

Major Arcana: The Hierophant

Minor Arcana: Five of Coins, Wands, Cups, and Swords

Divinatory Meaning: Fulfillment

6

Major Arcana: The Lovers

Minor Arcana: Six of Coins, Wands, Cups, and Swords

Divinatory Meaning: Decision

7

Major Arcana: The Chariot

Minor Arcana: Seven of Coins, Wands, Cups, and Swords

Divinatory Meaning: Change

8

Major Arcana: Justice (The card of Justice can represent imbalance or balance. This is determined by the surrounding cards in the spread.)

Minor Arcana: Eight of Coins, Wands, Cups, and Swords Divinatory
Meaning: Imbalance

9

Major Arcana: The Hermit

Minor Arcana: Nine of Coins, Wands, Cups, and Swords
Divinatory Meaning: A New Path

Minor Arcana

There are fifty-six cards in the Minor Arcana consisting of four suits of fourteen cards each. In each suit cards numbered 11 to 14 are known as the Court Cards and comprise the kings, queens, knights, and pages.

Instead of presenting each suit separately, the scheme here is to approach the cards numerically beginning with the four aces and ending with the four pages. The reason for this is so you can better see the numerical correspondences and start by learning the general meaning for a given number before tackling the four variations.

The Minor Arcana are said to deal with material conditions and events which are depicted by the following four suits:

- Coins (or Pentacles)—finances, business
- Wands (or Rods)—career, creative ventures
- Cups (or Chalices)—matters of the heart
- Swords (or Blades)—sorrows, afflictions

As with the Major Arcana, divinatory meanings will be given for both upright and reversed positions. But it is not essential to memorize the reversed meanings as in most cases it is simply *less* good or *less* bad. In practice, if you are using a non-illustrated deck it is often difficult to tell when a Minor Arcana card has been reversed. More than anything else, reversed cards in the Minor Arcana spell delays.

1

General Meaning: Beginnings

Ace of Coins: New financial venture.

Reversed: Financial setback or delay.

Ace of Wands: Start of program of study, job, career, or news of same.

Reversed: Problems or delays in starting something.

Ace of Cups: Beginning of romance. Letter from loved one.

Reversed: Difficulties in starting a relationship.

Ace of Swords: Failure of something to materialize. Bad news.

Reversed: Meaning is much the same, only slightly less so.

Combinations (in the same spread):

Three aces: Success assured.

Four aces: Powerful forces at work. Virtually a total new beginning to the life.

2

General Meaning: Conflict

2 of Coins: Conflict in money matters.

Reversed: Failure to read “the bottom line.”

2 of Wands: Conflict over career or with business associates.

Reversed: Failure to do one’s homework.

2 of Cups: The “Love Conquers All” card. Conflict has been resolved by patience and affectionate cooperation

Reversed: Problem not entirely solved.

2 of Swords: Conflict on several levels. Inability to resolve conflict.

Reversed: Hidden enemies at work.

Combinations:

Three 2s: Need to reorganize.

Four 2s: Traumatic period in the life.

3

General Meaning: Career

3 of Coins: Contract. Business partnership. Marriage involving money.

Reversed: Financial reversals in business or marriage.

3 of Wands: Letter of acceptance. Position in education or the arts. Marriage based upon mutual interests.

Reversed: Delay in acquiring desired post.

3 of Cups: A marriage based upon deep affection.

Reversed: Broken marriage.

3 of Swords: Separation or divorce.

Reversed: Domestic strife.

Combinations:

Three 3s: Highly eventful period.

Four 3s: Milestone in the life.

4

General Meaning: Attainment

4 of Coins: Success in career through one's own efforts.

Reversed: Job or career frustration.

4 of Wands: Promotion or advancement. Financial windfall.

Reversed: Delays or problems regarding career or legacy.

4 of Cups: A lover, friend, or baby comes into one's life in a sudden or unexpected fashion.

Reversed: Sexual or love problems.

4 of Swords: Loss. Illness requiring hospitalization.

Reversed: Personal, business, or health problems not as serious as expected.

Combinations:

Three 4s: Work is heavy and demanding.

Four 4s: Desire to get away from it all.

5

General Meaning: Fulfillment

5 of Coins: Financial fulfillment.

Reversed: Delay in receiving financial benefits.

5 of Wands: Fulfillment in career.

Reversed: Delays or reverses regarding career.

5 of Cups: Fulfillment in love. Emotional fulfillment.

Reversed: Lover untrue or neglectful.

5 of Swords: There will be problems but the spirit guides are in control.

Reversed: Difficulties will not be entirely cleared up.

Combinations:

Three 5s: A general good feeling about oneself and the world and everybody in it.

Four 5s: Everything is coming up roses.

6

General Meaning: Time of Decision

6 of Coins: Decision concerning an organization or group of people.
A wedding.

Reversed: Problems or delays making or carrying out a decision.

6 of Wands: Decision concerning the theatre, art, music, or the occult.

Reversed: Difficulties in realizing one's creative potential.

6 of Cups: Decision involving love or marriage. Emotional decision.

Reversed: Disappointment concerning lover, mate, or family member.

6 of Swords: Warning card. Person is unable to make a decision and this card mandates that a decision be made if individual is ever to have peace of mind.

Reversed: Tension beginning to abate.

Combinations:

Three 6s: Much confusion.

Four 6s: Get life sorted out without further delay as this combination is an invitation to disaster.

7

General Meaning: Change

7 of Coins: A change in business or career. Business trip.

Reversed: Business change or trip does not work as planned.

7 of Wands: The card of The Writer. Also the card of The Student and The Teacher—but in regard to some type of change relating to career.

Reversed: Change in career due to frustration.

7 of Cups: Change regarding family or residence. Visit to or from relatives. A live-in relationship.

Reversed: Difficulties with home or family situation.

7 of Swords: Warning card. This is a more serious warning card than the 6 of Swords for it indicates that the person may be

on the edge of a breakdown. Also a warning against accident—particularly with the 3 or 9 of Swords or The Lightning-Struck Tower. Both the 6 and 7 of Swords in the same spread would indicate severe depression and possible suicidal tendencies.

Reversed: The problem of accident increases due to individual's extreme self-destructive tendencies at the present time.

Combinations:

Three 7s: Help may be expected from friends.

Four 7s: Probable neurosis if the individual does not slow down and learn to live one day at a time.

8

General Meaning: Imbalance

8 of Coins: Reckless spending. Imbalance in financial or business affairs.

Reversed: Financial losses can be trimmed.

8 of Wands: Imbalance in creative or career ventures. Card of The Politician—but usually with regard to some problem or impropriety.

Reversed: Problems with professional associates lessened through tact or diplomacy.

8 of Cups: Imbalance in love life or family matters.

Reversed: Positive action helps to heal situation regarding a relationship.

8 of Swords: General imbalance in personal affairs.

Reversed: Problems lessened by facing them openly and honestly.

Combinations:

Three 8s: Time to slow down as the psychological speed limit is being exceeded.

Four 8s: Professional counseling is clearly called for.

9

General Meaning: A New Path

9 of Coins: Unexpected costs in the way of money or emotions.

Reversed: Indicates a need to guard against unwise personal loans or investments.

9 of Wands: New friends or environment.

Reversed: A visit or communication with someone from the past.

9 of Cups: The Wish Card. A dream comes true.

Reversed: Delay in seeing a wish realized.

9 of Swords: Deep personal loss. Time of danger and/or endings.

Reversed: Need to soften one's nature or there can be much unhappiness.

Combinations:

Three 9s: Much going on in the way of correspondence and communications.

Four 9s: Be prepared to take on a number of added responsibilities.

10

General Meaning: Wins and Losses

10 of Coins: The Wall Street Card. It is the business or financial break for which one has been waiting.

Reversed: Profits less than anticipated.

10 of Wands: Major career gains. Potential is there for rising to the top of one's chosen field.

Reversed: Potential needs to be tapped and developed before it can bear fruit.

10 of Cups: Heavy emotional costs regarding someone else.

Reversed: Eccentric behavior can cause severance of a relationship.

10 of Swords: Emotional or psychological bankruptcy. The edge of the abyss of despair.

Reversed: Person beginning to learn to cope.

Combinations:

Three 10s: Much buying and selling.

Four 10s: Age of anxiety.

11

Kings General Meaning: Men, Usually Over Thirty-Five

King of Coins: Business type. Rigid outlook. Well organized. Conservative.

Reversed: Presently ill or suffering from some affliction involving the physical body.

King of Wands: A counselor. Fair, honest, and just. Understanding person—one in whom you can confide.

Reversed: Somewhat puritanical. Tends to do everything “by the book.” Something upside down in the life of this man.

King of Cups: A man of keen sensibilities. Artistically inclined. A good lover but somewhat manipulative.

Reversed: Not entirely honest with himself and others. The Great American Compromiser. May have identity problem.

King of Swords: A blunt, hardnosed forceful type. Often an executive, lawyer, or doctor.

Reversed: Highly insecure. May be suffering from mental illness or some type of psychosomatic complaint.

Combinations:

Three Kings: A prize, honor, or award in the offing.

Four Kings: Top-level meeting with VIPs.

12

Queens General Meaning: Women, Usually Over Thirty-Five

Queen of Coins: Highly organized female. Often a business woman or executive.

Reversed: Difficult person to deal with as she is lacking in basic human understanding. Woman presently ill or bedridden.

Queen of Wands: Motherly type. Woman of keen insight and understanding.

Reversed: Restless individual who tends to scatter her energies.

Queen of Cups: Compassionate woman. Very warm and affectionate. Devoted wife and mother.

Reversed: Love life is somewhat chaotic.

Queen of Swords: Strong-minded woman. Highly independent. Widow, divorcee, or single woman.

Reversed: Domineering woman. Insecure person. May have deep-seated sexual problems—particularly if the reversed Queen of Swords appears in the same spread with The Enchantress, The Devil, or The Moon.

Combinations:

Three Queens: Discretion is called for at the present moment.

Four Queens: Words—uttered or published by consultant—can be an

explosive force.

13

Knights (or Horsemen) General Meaning: Thoughts

Knight of Coins: Thoughts about money or business.

Reversed: Misunderstanding or poor judgment regarding a business deal or investment.

Knight of Wands: Thoughts about career or what one does creatively.

Reversed: Inability to see clearly the road to take regarding career.

Knight of Cups: Loving and happy thoughts.

Reversed: Confusion regarding an affair of the heart.

Knight of Swords: Unhappy or bitter thoughts.

Reversed: Highly destructive thoughts. If reversed Knight of Swords appears in the same spread as the 2 or 7 of Swords, The Devil, or The Lightning-Struck Tower, individual is prone to violence—and violence of a most negative order.

Combinations:

Three Knights: It would be best at this time to shelve all decisions and go off on vacation.

Four Knights: A crisis of the worst kind is brewing.

14

Pages General Meaning: Young People (Men or Women) Under Thirty-Five, Children, Infants, or Pets

Page of Coins: A serious young person. Quiet or withdrawn. Good head for studies or business.

Reversed: Tends to be stubborn. Somewhat careless with money.

Page of Wands: Fair-minded and straightforward youth. Loyal and faithful friend.

Reversed: Overly serious. Inclined to be a loner.

Page of Cups: Warm and affectionate youngster or young adult.

Reversed: Lacking in self-confidence. Spoiled brat.

Page of Swords: Independent and adventuresome youth. Willful and obstinate child.

Obstreperous individual. Early rule of the rod is called
Reversed: for as this child has all the makings of a maverick and rebel.

Combinations:

Three Pages: Good news is on the way.

Four Pages: News pertaining to school or camp.

SUMMARY OF MEANINGS IN DIVINATION FOR MAJOR AND MINOR ARCANA
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1

Major Arcana—The Magician: Self-mastery. Powerful will. Inspirational teacher.

Minor Arcana—Beginnings.

2

Major Arcana—The High Priestess: Duality. Moody or critical woman.

Minor Arcana—Conflict.

3

Major Arcana—The Empress: The launching of a creative enterprise.
Marriage.

Minor Arcana—Career.

4

Major Arcana—The Emperor: Material attainment. Marriage.

Minor Arcana—Attainment.

5

Major Arcana—The Hierophant: A wise counselor. Spiritual fulfillment.
Introspective man.

Minor Arcana—Fulfillment.

6

Major Arcana—The Lovers: A time of decision.

Minor Arcana—A time of decision.

7

Major Arcana—The Chariot: Victory.

Minor Arcana—Change.

8

Major Arcana—Justice: Balance or imbalance depending upon surrounding
cards.

Minor Arcana—Imbalance.

9

Major Arcana—The Hermit: A searching. Spiritual renewal. Highly
cautious individual.

Minor Arcana—A new path.

10

Major Arcana—The Wheel of Fortune: A turn in one's fortunes for the better.

Minor Arcana—Wins and losses.

11

Major Arcana—The Enchantress: Inner strength. Difficult period in the life. Aggressive woman.

Minor Arcana—Kings are men, usually over thirty-five.

12

Major Arcana—The Hanged Man: Sacrifice. Reverses. Total change of values.

Minor Arcana—Queens are women, usually over thirty-five.

13

Major Arcana—The Reaper: Change. Reaping what one has sown.

Minor Arcana—Knights are thoughts.

14

Major Arcana—The Angel of Time: Regeneration. Renewed inner harmony and a more loving and understanding acceptance of others.

Minor Arcana—Pages are young people (men or women) under thirty-five, children, infants, or pets.

15

Major Arcana—The Devil: Fear. Division within the self. Evil influences at work.

16

Major Arcana—The Lightning-Struck Tower: Psychological crisis. Accident or disaster.

17

Major Arcana—The Star: Hope. New lease on life.

18

Major Arcana—The Moon: Deception. Delays. Illusion.

19

Major Arcana—The Sun: Paradise found. The love of the life. Filling up with happiness.

20

Major Arcana—Day of Judgment: Decision of the utmost importance is in the making.

21

Major Arcana—The World: Joy.

The Unnumbered Card

Major Arcana—The Fool: At or near the beginning of a spread The Fool indicates confusion, simple-mindedness, or ill-fated undertaking. At or near the end of a spread the indication is that he is a magus, or wise fool, who has had more than his share of challenges and hurts but who has grown in wisdom and humanity.

Major Arcana

First to be taken up will be the twenty-two cards of the Major Arcana. In general, the Tarot Trumps, as they are known, refer to psychological states of mind or people. Following a brief description of the cards in regard to symbolism, mythology, and psychological meanings, will be the meaning in divination. Please note that the cards have one meaning upright and another when they are reversed.

NOTE: Tarot packs differ somewhat in the way symbols are used and also in the artistic rendering of the figures depicted. The descriptions that follow pertain to the Oswald Wirth Deck.

The Unnumbered Card The Fool

The single card that wears no number in the Tarot is the card of The Fool. Because of this, he is considered to be the most profound card of the Tarot for he can be seen as both the beginning and ending card of the Major Arcana. Garbed as he is in a suit of motley and wearing a cap and bells, he is reminiscent of the court jester of another age. Fools were considered to be essentially cases of arrested development or even demented. However, these very qualities of madness or simplicity endeared them to members of the court for they were considered to have a sacred quality about them and in their babblings the voice of God might be heard.



In modern playing card packs, The Fool is the one card from the Major Arcana that has survived. As The Joker he is not at all unlike his ancestor for he holds no rank or station but as a “wild” man he can pretty much go as he pleases and at times his power is equal to and even greater than that of a king. In a Tarot reading, The Fool has the same trick as his medieval counterpart of popping up like a jack-in-the-box when you least expect him. Often he will appear as the very first card in a spread and at other times as the very last. The meanings in divination differ and for that reason The Fool will be listed as both the beginning and ending card of the Major Arcana. When The Fool appears at or near the beginning of a spread, he is truly a fool for he is about to embark upon an enterprise for which he has not properly prepared himself.

Divinatory Meaning: Confusion. Simple-mindedness. Ill-fated undertaking.

Reversed: Inability to begin something due to conflicting drives.

Arcanum I

The Magician

The Number I card of the Major Arcana, The Magician, is probably the card that more people identify with than any other, which is interesting considering the duality of the card. In some decks—the Rider Pack particularly—he appears as almost a Christ-like figure talking in parables to the multitudes. In most traditional packs, however, he seems more the carnival trickster, the confidence man, manipulating others with his sleight-of-hand techniques. It is perhaps this very duality that appeals to us for he speaks to both the dark and light sides of each of us. He appears to be performing before an unseen audience and he clearly relishes what he is doing. The Magician stands behind a table out in the open and in most Tarot packs the table contains a pentacle, a sword, a chalice, and a wand. Since these are the symbols for the four suits of the Minor Arcana and represent material conditions, The Magician is a forceful personality indeed for he is in control of both himself and his destiny.



Divinatory Meaning: Self-mastery. Powerful will. Inspirational teacher.

Reversed: An individual lacking in willpower or one who uses his or her will to exploit others. The clue as to which meaning pertains may be found in the surrounding cards: Exploitation would be suggested by the Eight of Swords or particularly the card of The Devil (another name for this card is The Black Magician). Surrounded by The High Priestess, The Emperor, or a King or Queen, the indication is that s/he is a weak person who has been dominated by an authority figure.

Arcanum II

The High Priestess

The first female figure, The High Priestess, is also considered to be a magician for she is said to represent Isis, the horned moon goddess of

ancient Egypt. The central myth of the mystery religion of Isis was the story of how her husband, Osiris, was slain by his evil brother, Seth. Isis searched everywhere for his body and when she found it, she used her magick to bring Osiris back to life and by him conceived Horus, who became the Sun God. The resurrected Osiris also became a god and the myth of his death and resurrection was believed to have provided a pattern that human beings could follow. Those who became initiated into the Egyptian mysteries believed that they would gain eternal life.



In one hand The High Priestess holds a manuscript, in the other, a golden key. On the cover of the scroll appears the white and black symbol of yin and yang—the Law of Opposites. This Law is reinforced by the two poles she is seated between—a red one and a blue one, and also the floor beneath her throne, which is made up of contrasting white and black marble squares. This Law then will provide the golden key to the mystery of her own personality and once she learns it she will be able to integrate the

differing forces within her psyche. She needs to work on herself, and until then to deal with her may be somewhat “difficult.”

Divinatory Meaning: Duality. Moody or critical woman.

Reversed: A confused or neurotic person.

Arcanum III

The Empress

In many ancient religions the godhead was considered to be three-fold—a sacred trinity. Since Arcanum III is The Empress she may be seen as the woman who is here on earth to demonstrate the workings of heaven in the things of earth. This is suggested on the card by the scepter she holds, which is topped by the cross of spirit. Beside the Empress’s throne a lily is growing and one is reminded of the Biblical parable about the lillies of the field and “even Solomon in all his glory was not arrayed like one of these.” The ascending eagle on The Empress’s shield further illustrates the connection between heaven and earth.



The Empress is said to be a depiction of Venus, who mothered humankind and thus is the goddess of love, creation, art, and beauty. The psychologist Carl Jung spoke of archetypes—figures or images with which people of all times could identify. He believed that the mother archetype was primary for the young child's first formative experience is with the mother. The Empress could be seen as the mother archetype for she is Venus, the heavenly mother—the great earth mother—the mother of us all.

Divinatory Meaning: The launching of a creative enterprise. Marriage.

Reversed: Setback in career. Divorce. Should the reversed Empress appear in the same spread with the Three of Swords (which indicates divorce) it could refer to an on-again, off-again marriage.

Arcanum IV

The Emperor

The eagle crest on The Emperor's throne establishes that he is the consort of The Empress. They complement each other well for as Arcanum III, The Empress is self-expressive, creative, and intuitive. Four, however, the number of The Emperor, is the number of earth, practicality, discipline, and reason. In Jungian terms, he is the authority figure father archetype, the *animus*, or male principle, as contrasted with the *anima* or female principle represented by The Empress. Since The Empress is associated with Venus, The Emperor could be seen as Mars, the god of war and destruction. In mythology, Mars was the lover of Venus and their child was Harmony, the ordered and regular arrangement of things.



The Emperor is considered quite positive when it appears in a spread. Not always as positive as The Empress, for The Emperor lacks her flexibility, openness, creativity, and spiritual values. When The Emperor appears in a spread, look at the surrounding cards. Flanked by Coins and Wands, the individual may be overly self-seeking and materialistic. But

when The Emperor appears with The Hierophant, The Star, or The Empress, the consultant has built on a firm foundation.

Divinatory Meaning: Material attainment. Marriage.

Reversed: Failure to recognize one's potential or to attain material success. Divorce.

Arcanum V

The Hierophant

Arcanum V, The Hierophant, depicts another archetypal figure, and since the card is also known as The Pope, which means “papa” or “father” he is the spiritual father to his flock. “Pontiff” is an appellation for a pope, and the word stems from the Etruscans, meaning “bridge builder.” The spiritual father serves as the bridge between heaven and earth.

But the word, “hierophant,” by which this card is generally known, has a somewhat different meaning for in antiquity he was the chief priest of the Eleusinian Mysteries of ancient Egypt and was known as the Revealer of Sacred Things. This reminds us of the myth of Isis, the moon goddess hovering above the dead Osiris, the Sun God, to revive him. In the Eleusinian Mysteries, the hierophant made himself impotent by drinking hemlock, which was equivalent to Osiris lying dead. The rite of a “sacred marriage” performed between the hierophant and a priestess represented the union of Isis and Osiris. Later would be proclaimed the birth of Horus, who was to become the Sun God. The myth teaches that Osiris was born a man and became a god, thereby setting an example others could follow.



In his red robe and white beard, The Hierophant of the Tarot looks a little like St. Nicholas. The novices with their backs to us might be perceived as children telling Santa what they want for Christmas. But what they want is a far cry from what “pop” can afford so The Hierophant is counseling them and attempting to raise their spiritual quotient.

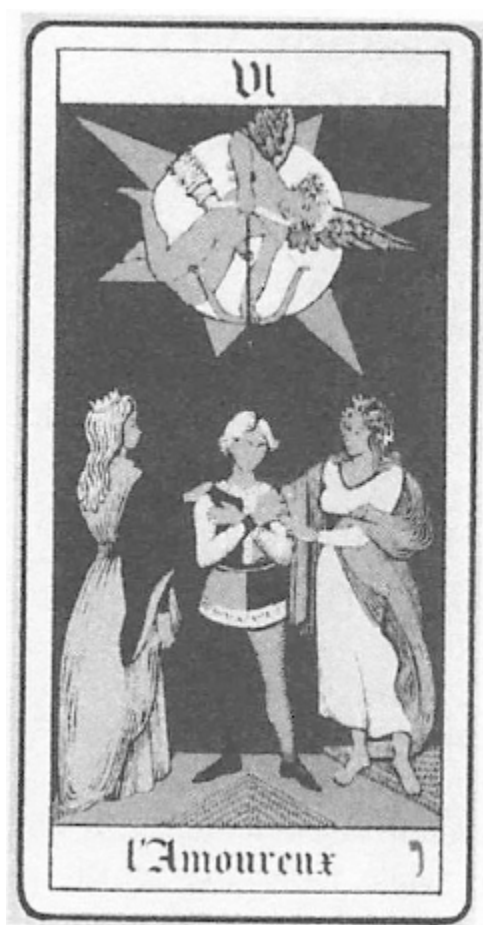
Divinatory Meaning: A wise counselor. Spiritual fulfillment. Introspective man.

Reversed: Identity crisis. Loss of faith. Should the reversed Hierophant appear in the same spread with the King or Queen of Wands it would indicate that the person had been seeing a psychiatrist or some other type of counselor.

Arcanum VI

The Lovers

Some Tarot decks depict only a man and a woman but in most packs Arcanum VI depicts a youth and two women. The older woman is said to be the youth's mother, the younger one, his lover. The youth has reached a crossroad in his life and must choose between them. It is not an easy choice for the young man to make for the road his mother is standing on represents security and the known; the path of his lover, adventure and the unknown. A difficult choice, yes, but a necessary one and in this case there will be help from the gods for Eros—or Cupid, as he is more commonly known—is about to release his Freudian shaft in the youth's direction. Cupid's role in this scenario is indeed interesting for the youth and two women may be seen as human types whereas he is a god. As allegory the message of the card seems to be that when we reach a crossroad of the life and wonder which road to take we can get help from the world of Spirit if we will open ourselves to it.



This card in divination may or may not depict actual lovers.

Divinatory Meaning: A time of decision.

Reversed: Inability to make a choice or face a decision.

Arcanum VII

The Chariot

As Arcanum VII, The Chariot could be seen mythologically as the product of Arcanum II, The High Priestess or Isis, and Arcanum V, The Hierophant, who (as Osiris) in the Eleusinian rite copulated with The High Priestess. The Charioteer then could be taken as Horus, the Sun God, driving the chariot of the sun. This may prove a difficult task for him as The Chariot is being pulled by two sleepy sphinx-like creatures and a sphinx is not usually noted for speed and mobility. The two creatures are clearly quite different and may be seen as conflicting inner forces. If The Chariot is taken to be the vehicle of personality for the driver, this can be seen as a critical time in the life for he has to reconcile these opposing forces before he can drive down life's road. He seems to be on the right track for the three stars on his crown suggest an integration of the forces that comprise personality—Id, Ego, and Superego. The fact that they appear on his crown indicates that basically he is comfortable with himself but total integration only comes through work. That he is ultimately successful is clear from the card's meaning.



Divinatory Meaning: Victory.

Reversed: Dark victory. Defeat.

Arcanum VIII

Justice

The figure in Arcanum VIII is rather formidable for in addition to the scales she holds in her left hand, in her right hand she wields the “terrible swift sword” of Divine Justice. Unlike human justice which is blind, this deity can take your measure with unerring accuracy. Actually, the whole idea of Divine Justice stems from the Egyptian belief that every soul—regardless of the class, rank, or station it occupied in life—was to be judged by Osiris. After death the soul was weighed in the balance against the feather of Maat, Goddess of Truth. To pass the test the dead person’s conscience had to

weigh exactly the same as the feather, so that the scales were in perfect equilibrium. Someone has said that it is not injustice we fear, but justice. We need not fear Divine Justice, however, for she helps us to find the proper balance for maintaining equilibrium and harmony in our lives.



Divinatory Meaning: Balance or imbalance depending upon the surrounding cards.

Reversed: The meaning is much the same, only slightly less so.

Arcanum IX

The Hermit

Having learned the balance of Justice, The Hermit teaches caution. He is afraid of the condemnation of others—criticism from those who do not understand—so he hides his light under his cloak. Essentially, he is in

search of truth and since this is usually not a group activity, he appears solitary and withdrawn, treading the lonely path of his pilgrimage although he is at the same time a light and beacon to others. Jung talked about four basic stages of life: Childhood, Youth and Young Adulthood, Middle Age, and Old Age. He felt that the first major transformation of the individual occurs around puberty when the individual undergoes a “psychic revolution” and the psyche takes on a new shape and the individual emerges as a new person. Jung referred to this as a “psychic birth” and he felt that it was the single most important stage in a person’s life. He pointed out that this occurs again during middle age and the man or woman over thirty-five must then meet the challenge of reordering the life around a new set of values—and Jung felt that they must be spiritual values. The Lovers’ card could be seen as the “psychic birth” of the adolescent, and The Hermit as the psychic revolution of middle age. This might be thought of as the “Wilderness Card.”



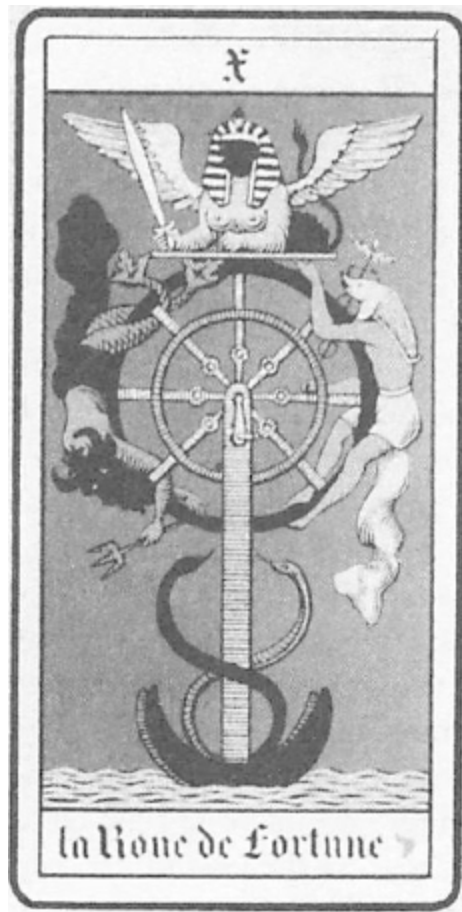
Divinatory Meaning: A searching. Spiritual renewal. Highly cautious individual.

Reversed: Rashness. Someone indiscreet or out of control.

Arcanum X

The Wheel of Fortune

The golden creature ascending on the right is thought to be Anubis, the dog-faced god of Egypt who weighed the souls of the dead. The bizarre figure descending on the left is said to be Typhon, the god of destruction and disintegration. Anubis is considered a positive force whereas Typhon is a negative force. It is the old story of good versus evil. The sphinx guarding the wheel reminds us of Arcanum VII, The Chariot, and the two sphinx types pulling the chariot of personality. Those sphinxes, remember, represented opposing forces within the personality that needed to be reconciled. Here again in Arcanum X is a depiction of the yin and yang principle and the need to integrate. What is interesting is that the opposing forces on the card are on the wheel, which is a mandala and a symbol of psychic wholeness, an indication that the super-structure for harmony is there.



Divinatory Meaning: A turn in one's fortunes for the better.

Reversed: The beginning of an unhappy or unlucky period.

Arcanum XI

The Enchantress

This card is known by several names including Fortitude and Strength. The Enchantress, however, suggests an allusion to Circe, the great enchantress in *The Odyssey* who turned men into animals. The card is numbered 11 which in numerology is considered a Master Number. People born under this vibration often have great difficulties to contend against. If, however, they live at the highest level of their being and rise above petty things and petty people they become “messengers of light.” The Enchantress, although she appears to be in great danger, seems quite relaxed as she proceeds to close the jaws of the lion. She does not have to use brute strength for she

has learned the lesson of The Wheel; she knows who she is; and in any situation she is able to remain calm and poised for she can now rely on her inner *strength*.



Divinatory Meaning: Inner strength. Difficult period in the life. Aggressive woman.

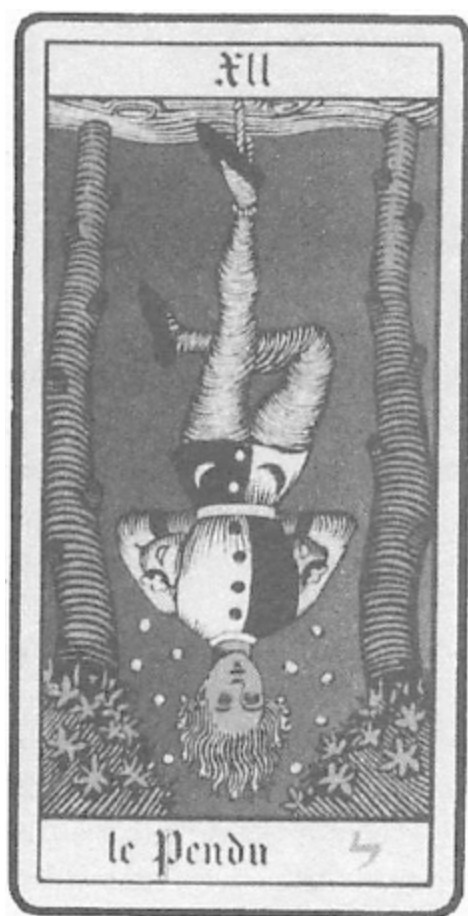
Reversed: Difficulty coping. Sexual perversion. If the reversed Enchantress appears with The Empress, The Emperor, or the Three of Cups, it would indicate sexual difficulties in the marriage.

Arcanum XII

The Hanged Man

In Arcanum XI, The Enchantress, although having an encounter with “the king of beasts,” remained cool and collected. In Arcanum XII, The Hanged

Man does not appear to be in a particularly comfortable position, suspended as he is by one foot from a gibbet. But like The Enchantress, The Hanged Man appears cool and relaxed. The position of The Hanged Man may indicate that the conventional values of society are topsy-turvy and that truth is the reverse of what most people think it is. In this position, the eyes of The Hanged Man are on the heavens, which suggests that the seeker after truth must concern her- or himself with the laws of the universe rather than the laws of society and, in a reversal of values, spiritually and psychologically stand on his or her head. This is not easy to do.



Divinatory Meaning: Sacrifice. Reverses. Total change of values.

Reversed: A grim omen for it would indicate that the individual was unable or unwilling to drop old habits and ways or make a needed sacrifice.

Arcanum XIII

The Reaper

When Arcanum XIII comes up in a spread it is usually greeted with a grimace for it is known to be “the death card” and in some packs it is labeled “Death.” In most packs the imagery is rather vivid for The Grim Reaper appears as a skeleton wielding a scythe while engaging in the dance of death. If the truth be told, there are certain cards in the Minor Arcana that are closer to being “death cards”—at least, in the sense of physical death. In general, this is a positive card in divination for the type of death depicted is the ending of things in the life that need to leave the life so that other things can take their place. In actuality, The Reaper is not so much an outside force as he is the individual who reaps what s/he has sown. Since The Reaper is doing his dance of death in a green and fertile field, the card is really an image of the continuity of life in nature in which death is part of a cycle of life, death and life renewed.



Divinatory Meaning: Change. Reaping what one has sown.

Reversed: Inability to accept or make necessary changes.

Arcanum XIV

The Angel of Time

Temperance is the name some students of the Tarot give to this card but The Angel of Time seems more descriptive for according to Jung, “An angel personifies the coming into consciousness of something new arising from the deep unconscious.” That “something new” may be suggested by the card’s association with Aquarius, who in ancient Egypt was called Hapi, the god of the Nile, who ruled over both the agricultural waters that gave life to the soil and the spiritual waters that nourished the soul. Since The Angel of Time is pouring waters from a blue urn into a red one. This card could be seen as another depiction of the fusion of opposites. In this case, it is the

unity of conscious and unconscious forces, which manifest as a pure liquid, suggesting free-flowing energy.



Divinatory Meaning: Regeneration. Renewed inner harmony and a more loving and understanding acceptance of others.

Reversed: Disenchantment with a change. Failure to accept or to understand others.

Arcanum XV

The Devil

According to Baudelaire, “The Devil’s cleverest wile is to convince us that he doesn’t exist.” The Devil is only too real as a sleepy glance at the front page of any newspaper any day anywhere will tell you. Throughout all recorded history, a major problem in capturing and destroying him has been

that he is a master of disguise. But there is a surefire method for penetrating his disguise: Throw a Tarot spread for yourself and if the card of The Devil comes up, simply go over to the mirror and take a long hard look at yourself and you will see him. Jung talked about the “Shadow,” meaning a secret part of ourself which we need to confront if we are to become fully integrated human beings. In her fascinating work, *Jung and Tarot*, Sallie Nichols states that The Devil does have one redeeming feature and that is the golden antlers that he wears as “Horns are an ancient symbol for new life and spiritual regeneration, and golden antlers are specifically symbolic of divine fire.” Rehabilitation in this case has to be an “inside job.” If you are successful you can restore him to his original calling which was “Lucifer, the Messenger of Light.”



Divinatory Meaning: Fear. Division within the self. Evil influences at work.

Reversed: Much the same, only slightly less so.

Arcanum XVI

The Lightning-Struck Tower

When someone comes up with a bright idea we often refer to the inspiration as “being hit by lightning.” Arcanum XVI could be read as “the eureka card”—an instance of divine inspiration. Not everyone can reverse values with the calm and serenity of The Hanged Man and for some the only method for change is to get hit by lightning, which supposedly is why Martin Luther left the law and became a priest. The two figures on the card are head-downward like The Hanged Man. It is a reversal of their life. The ground has been cut out from under them so as to force them into building a new foundation with a broader base.



As on the card of The Reaper, one figure is humble, the other wears a crown. Material position counts for nought when spiritual progression is at

stake.

Divinatory Meaning: Psychological crisis. Accident or disaster. The possibility of accident is greatly increased if The Tower appears in the same spread with the Three, Seven, or Nine of Swords.

Reversed: Still a crisis but slightly less so.

Arcanum XVII

The Star

The large shining star of Arcanum XVII is said to be Sirius, the star of Isis, which was connected with the Nile flood which brought new life to the land. We are reminded of Arcanum XIV, The Angel of Time, associated with Hapi, god of the Nile and the two waters, agricultural and spiritual. As was the case with The Angel of Time, the figure on this card holds two urns. But instead of pouring one into the other, she is pouring one into a pool of water and the other onto earth, suggesting that she has succeeded in finding the correct balance between things material and things spiritual. In addition to the large star at the top of the card, there are seven lesser stars. In works on alchemy, similar configurations are depicted, the smaller stars representing the seven stages of the alchemical process culminating in the “philosopher’s gold”—the great star representing self-enlightenment. This is a positive card in divination.



Divinatory Meaning: Hope. New lease on life.

Reversed: Death of a dream.

Arcanum XVIII

The Moon

Arcanum XVIII might be considered the “Dark Night of the Soul.” At the top of the card shines the waning moon of illusion. She sheds her light upon a winding path which leads between two towers to the Eternal City. But to reach that destination will not be easy for there is a moat to cross in which resides a gigantic beetle said to be Kheperer, the Egyptian scarab. Guarding the tower are two jackals, most likely in the employ of the evil goddess Hecate, who can tear an individual limb from limb. Hecate’s cousin is the demure moon goddess, Artemis, who as Luna can drive men to lunacy. The pilgrim is at a critical stage of life’s journey for if s/he allows him/herself to

be caught up in the spell and glamour of The Moon, s/he will never find the true insight and will end his/her days in illusion.



Divinatory Meaning: Deception. Delays. Illusion.

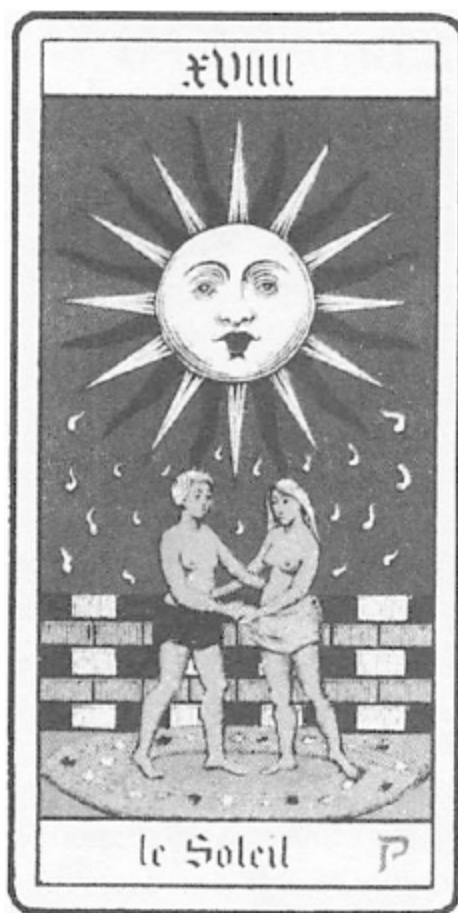
Reversed: Individual has been led astray but is “beginning to see the light.”

Arcanum XIX

The Sun

The moon country of the preceding Arcanum was dark, mysterious and fraught with hidden dangers. But here in Arcanum XIX, two children, a boy and a girl, are playing under a radiant smiling sun. Their costumes are brief for they have nothing to hide and are at ease with themselves and each other. Significantly, the boy's outfit is red, the girl's is blue, suggesting once again the yin and yang principle. But where opposites appeared on other

cards they were in the guise of sphinxes or monsters—and always apart. Here the boy and girl are touching and interacting in a very human way. The fence bordering their garden—which could be seen as a lost Eden—is constructed of both blue and red stones, further reinforcing the concept of opposing forces that have been reconciled. The fact that the figures on the card are children suggests that if one is to “be together” and find happiness in this world it is necessary to restore contact with what Jung called the “eternal child” in oneself. It is a very good sign when The Sun comes out in a spread.



Divinatory Meaning: Paradise found. The love of the life. Filling up with happiness.

Reversed: Paradise lost.

Arcanum XX

Day of Judgment

According to the ancient teachings, when the last trump shall sound, in a moment, in the twinkling of an eye, the dead would rise from their graves to be judged and then sent to heaven or hell. It has been said that heaven and hell most surely do exist but they are not somewhere “above” or “below,” rather, they are what we build each day of our lives by the thought forms we create and the way we treat ourselves and others. We cannot give heaven to others if we are in our own personal hell. The fact that the three human figures on the card are rising from coffins suggests that life was death for them because they were blind to the heaven around them. Their eyes, however, have been opened and so have their ears for they are heeding the call of Michael, the angel of the last trump. And the music they hear is truly “heavenly” for they have become spiritually attuned. The three component parts of the personality which need to function as a unit if the person is to be psychologically whole, may be represented by these human figures of a man, a woman, and a child. The indication is that the opposites within have been reconciled and all systems integrated.



Divinatory Meaning: Decision of the utmost importance is in the making.

Reversed: Failure to rise to a challenge.

Arcanum XXI

The World

Someone has suggested that The World card stands for cosmic consciousness, or what Freud called “the oceanic feeling.” Unlike The Reaper who was carrying out his mechanical dance of death, the beautiful maiden of The World is engaged in a spontaneous, free-flowing dance of life. This stands for joy, harmony, and the orderly course of the universe and time. The World’s number is 21, the reverse of 12, which is the number of The Hanged Man. If you turn the card of The Hanged Man around, he appears to be dancing a jig. The dancing woman’s legs form a cross, as the legs of The Hanged Man also do, but where he is upside down, she is right

side up. The implication is that she represents The Hanged Man's original starting point and his ultimate goal. In her hands she holds both the solar and lunar wands, indicating that now the two are one. She dances, lives, and has her being within a laurel wreath which forms a mandala. By tapping the "eternal child" within, responding to the trumpet call from on high, the pilgrim hears the music of the morning stars and dances for joy.



Divinatory Meaning: Joy.

Reversed: A karmic bill falls due. It will be a trying period but one necessary for inner growth.

The Unnumbered Card The Fool

When The Fool comes up at the end of a spread the interpretive meaning is rather different than if he comes up at the beginning for he has stumbled

and faltered and had his falls but each time he has jumped up, dusted himself off, and kept going on his journey. He has learned from his experiences and has grown outwardly and inwardly. At the beginning of the Tarot sequence he was nothing—a cipher—but now he is Arcanum XXII and 22 in numerology is the ultimate Master Number and often the number of the master. In the eyes of everyday mortals a fool is considered to be a child. And The Fool of the Tarot is more a child than most fools but that is the secret of his power. He is unfettered, moves spontaneously, and sees everything afresh with a childlike sense of awe and wonder. He is a fool only in the eyes of the world, within himself he is sublime. When he appears at or near the end of a spread it is significant.



Divinatory Meaning: The magus, or wise fool, has had more than his share of challenges and hurts but has grown in wisdom and humanity.

Reversed: In the approximate center of a spread, confusion or conflict. At or near the end of a spread, consultant has made an attempt to sort out his or her experiences but still has a way to go.

Part Two

Tarot Spreads: Questions of Concern

This section provides spreads which address any questions the consultant might have with regard to love, marriage, finances, travel, health, career, or any other immediate concern. Prior to consultant's arrived, the reader should check the Tarot pack to make sure that it is complete and that all cards are in an upright position.

Opening a Reading

A reading may vary from a few minutes to several hours. The average reading, however, takes between a half hour to an hour. Some readers prefer to do only one spread and go into each card in depth. Most readers, however, employ a variety of spreads and will throw four to eight spreads during the course of a reading. The particular spreads used in a given reading will depend on several factors but particularly the type of questions the consultant brings to the reading.

No two readers will use exactly the same method; what is important is that once you discover what feels right for you, it is a good idea to follow that same procedure in all the readings you do. Remember, a Tarot pack is a magickal tool and one of the cardinal rules of magick is that the best results are obtained by repeating a ritual as closely as possible to the way it was done before.

The exact method that you employ will only come through experience but here is a good one to start with: Ask consultant to concentrate on a

question and while this is being done, shuffle the pack thoroughly. (In a Tarot reading the person being read is called the “consultant” or “querent”; the individual conducting the reading is called the “reader.”) Then hand the pack to consultant and ask her or him to reverse three cards—that is, the individual will fan through the pack, turn a card around and do that with two other cards, but will leave the cards in the pack facing the same way as the rest of the pack. If after the cutting and shuffling, one of these three cards comes up, it will be significant.

The next step is to ask, “Are you right-handed or left-handed?” If the consultant replies, “Right-handed,” you then say, “With your *left* hand, separate the pack into three piles and shuffle each. If the response is “Left-handed,” you then ask the person to cut with the right hand. In other words, the consultant cuts with the *unconscious* hand rather than the *calculating* hand. The consultant does not have to use the unconscious hand to shuffle the cards but you should demonstrate the shuffling process so that it will be accomplished in a manner that does not reverse cards, i.e., overhand as opposed to dove-tailing.

When the shuffling has been completed, ask consultant to put the pack back together, again using the unconscious hand. You then pick up the deck and are ready to throw your first spread. You may use any spread you wish to open a reading but you will probably find that some work better than others. Most readers have their favorite openers and the two described below have been found to be particularly effective for different reasons. In Three Faces of Time, consultant personally selects each card in the spread whereas The Horseshoe Spread almost invariably focuses on the central issue or problem with the very first card the reader turns over. Here are the directions for both spreads:

Three Faces of Time

15	14	13	12	11
10	9	8	7	6
5	4	3	2	1

Following the cutting and shuffling ritual, fan the cards face down on the table forming a semi-circle. Ask consultant to concentrate on the question and while doing this to select cards. You might say something like this: "Pick up cards one at a time and then hand each one to me face down. Do not worry about how many; I will tell you when to stop." You, of course, know that there are fifteen cards you are going to use in this spread but you do not tell consultant that for then the tendency would be to concentrate on the number of cards rather than the question.

When you have fifteen cards that you have received from consultant, say, "Fine, that is enough," and put the rest of the pack aside. Hand the selected cards to consultant for shuffling (no cutting is necessary this time). Consultant then hands the cards back to you and you throw the spread according to the diagram. Notice that there are three horizontal rows indicating Past, Present and Future, and that you begin with the bottom row of the Past and lay the cards face down from right to left. Unless otherwise specified, in all spreads, always start with the top card of the deck, then the one below that, and so on.

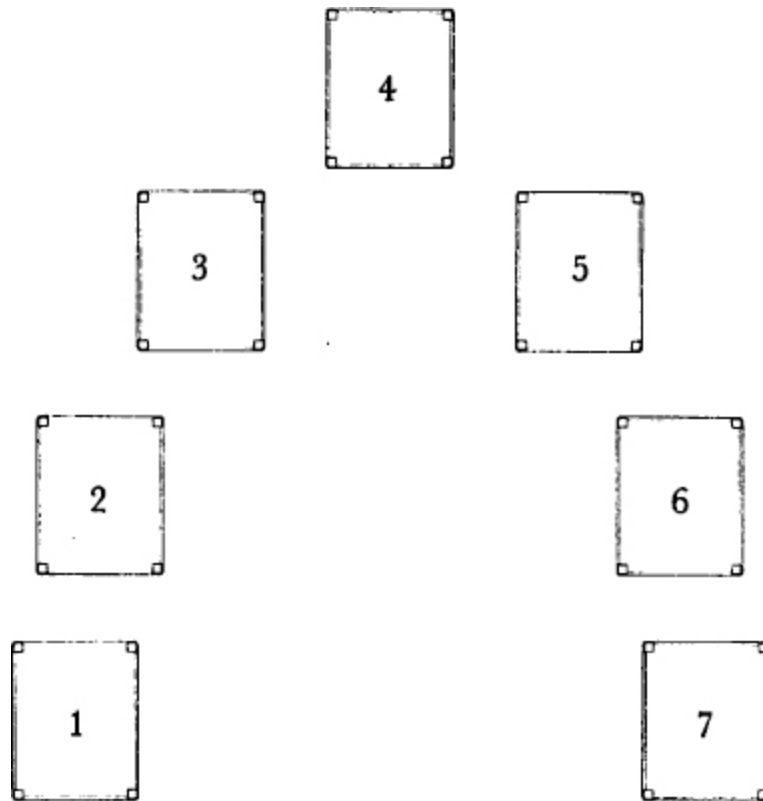
You may begin the actual reading by turning over the center card of the Present row. That is the key card of the Present as are the other center cards the keys to the Past and Future. So first read and interpret the center card of the Present and then do the same with the center cards of the Past and Future rows.

When these three cards have been read and interpreted, go to the row of the Past and turn over and read each card individually in the sequence they were thrown. Then do the same with the Present and Future rows.

When you have turned over and read all cards individually, look at the total configuration of all three time lines. Is there a particular emphasis on the Major Arcana? Court cards? Any one suit of the Minor Arcana that is heavily weighted? In the first instance, the question would have largely to do with consultant's state of mind; in the second, other people would be the dominating factor; in the third, the primary indicator would be the area ascribed to the suit of the Minor Arcana emphasized, so that Wands, for example, would suggest that the question had to do with work or career. Overall, what patterns are significant? Is the spread basically positive or negative? If it is about half and half, are the negative cards largely in the past and the positive cards in the future? If so, that is definitely something to focus on.

NOTE: It is important to be honest about what you see but it is even more important to be constructive. Remember, the consultant has come to you for help, not bad news. You cannot always tell the person what he or she wants to hear but you can present what you see in a manner that will be helpful.

The Horseshoe Spread



There are seven cards in this spread and after the consultant has cut and shuffled, throw the spread according to the diagram. Starting with card # 1, turn over each card separately, read and interpret it, and following in sequence, do the same with each card until all have been read. The meanings of each card are as follows:

Card #1—**Past:** This may be the immediate past, or it may go further back in time.

Card #2—**Present:** Immediate present.

Card #3—**Immediate Future.**

Card #4—**Card of Consultant:** Something on consultant's mind.

Card #5—**Attitude of Another:** This will usually be a person known to consultant and somehow connected with the question.

Card #6—**Obstacle:** If a favorable card comes up in this slot it would indicate that there is no real obstacle to overcome; if unfavorable, it would describe the type of obstacle consultant has to face.

Card #7—**Outcome:** This will be the logical culmination of the other cards in the spread.

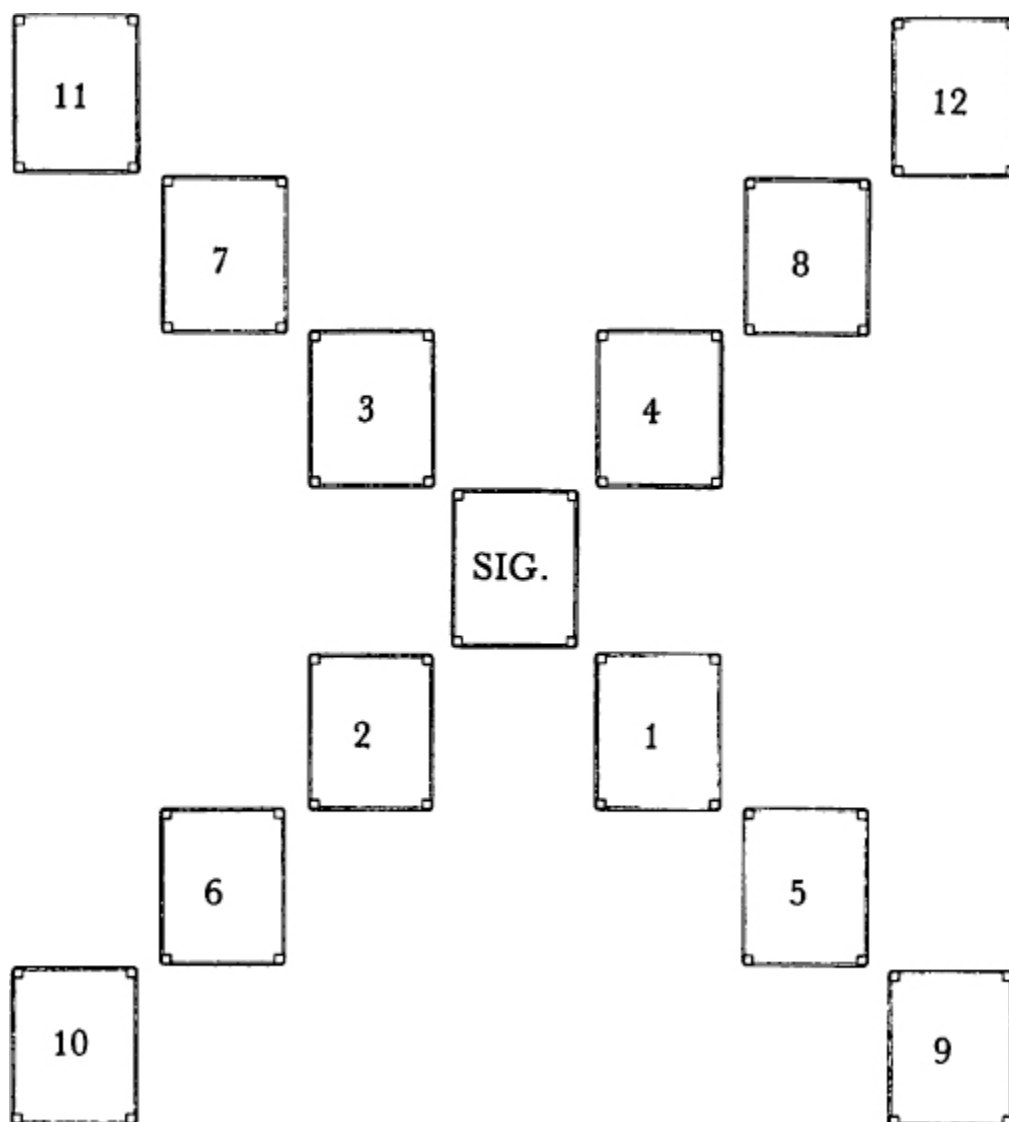
NOTE: If this is to be the opening spread of the reading, it can be quite dramatic to begin by turning over the Card of the Consultant—Card #4. What is on consultant's mind is often the key to a reading.

Using a Significator

A significator is a card selected to represent the consultant. There are any number of methods for choosing a significator. In the following spread, the Eastern Cross, The Empress is always used for a woman, The Emperor for a man. In the second spread, the Celtic Cross, an astrological method may be used. The reader may also select a card that seems to be sympathetic with the consultant, or to allow the consultant to choose a card with which he or she can identify.

A spread employing a significator can be used at any point in the reading, but the time to do so particularly is when the reading appears to be somewhat out of focus or incoherent. A significator acts much in the manner of a television antenna and attracts focused energy to the spread.

Eastern Cross



Begin by taking the significator out of the pack, The Empress for a female, The Emperor for a male. Most likely, the historical reason for this is that the shape of the spread forms the type of cross used in the Eastern Orthodox Church, and it was the emperor and empress of the Byzantine Empire who became the dominant Christian rulers when Constantinople became “the second Rome” and the world headquarters for Christianity.

After the significator has been removed from the deck, place it face up in the center of the table. Then hand the pack to the consultant and ask that the deck be cut into six piles. Next ask the consultant to shuffle each pile separately. Then take each pile, remove the top and bottom cards and discard the rest. When you have done this, hand the twelve remaining cards

to consultant and request that this pile be shuffled. When this has been done throw the spread according to the diagram.

Once the cross has been formed, you then dismantle it with the exception of the pillars of the cross—cards numbered 9, 10, 11, and 12. Lay the other cards aside and arrange the four cards that will actually be read on both sides of the significator in this fashion:



The sequence and meanings for the reading are as follows:

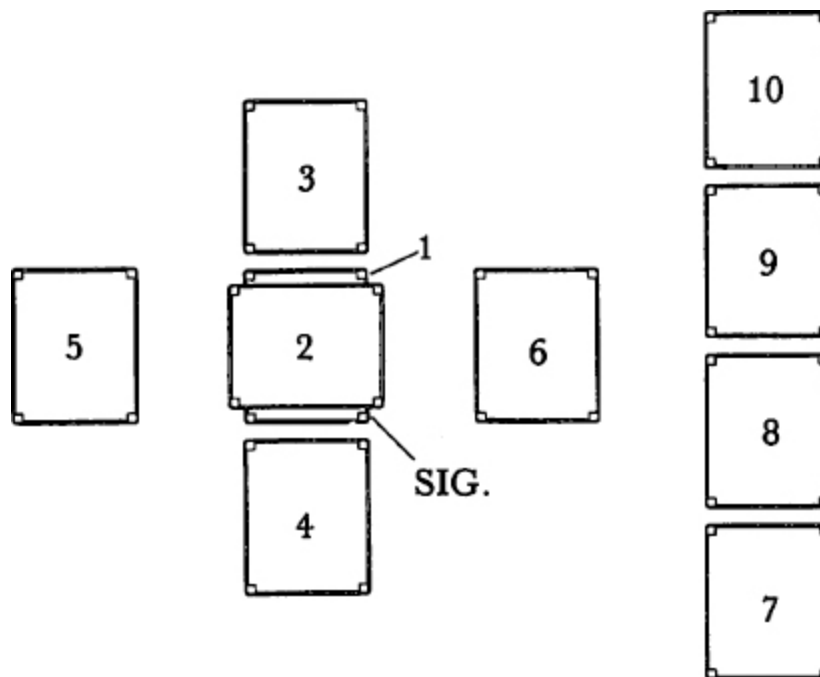
Card #11—Past

Card #10—Card of Consultant

Card #9—Immediate Future

Card #12—Outcome

Celtic Cross



This is quite possibly the most popular Tarot spread for it packs a great deal of information into a few cards and is usually right on target. It is an excellent first spread. It is also a good concluding spread. And if you are only going to do one spread for the consultant, this one is ideal.

If you wish to choose a significator based on astrological association, first find out the consultant's Sun sign and age. You need at least a rough idea of consultant's age so that you can choose a Court Card from one of the four suits of the Minor Arcana to represent the consultant. Use a page for a man or woman under thirty-five, a king for a man over thirty-five, and a queen for a woman over thirty-five. Each astrological sign is associated with a suit of the Minor Arcana as follows:

Fire Signs—Aries, Leo, Sagittarius: Wands

Earth Signs—Taurus, Virgo, Capricorn: Coins

Air Signs—Gemini, Libra, Aquarius: Swords

Water Signs—Cancer, Scorpio, Pisces: Cups

So, if for example, you are doing a reading for a fortyish man who is a native of Sagittarius, you would use the King of Wands as the consultant's correct significator card.

After the significator has been removed from the pack, place it face up in the center of the table. When consultant has cut and shuffled and returned the pack to you, throw a spread according to the diagram. As you lay each card down, think or say aloud the following litany:

Card #1— "This covers him." (Covering influence in the life at the moment)

Card #2— "This crosses him." (Obstacle)

Card #3— "This is above him." (The best that can be expected under the circumstances)

Card #4— "This is below him." (Foundation of the question)

Card #5— "This is behind him." (Past)

Card #6— "This is before him." (Immediate future)

Card #7— "This *is* him at this moment in time." (Card of consultant)

Card #8— "This is for his house and home." (Immediate family)

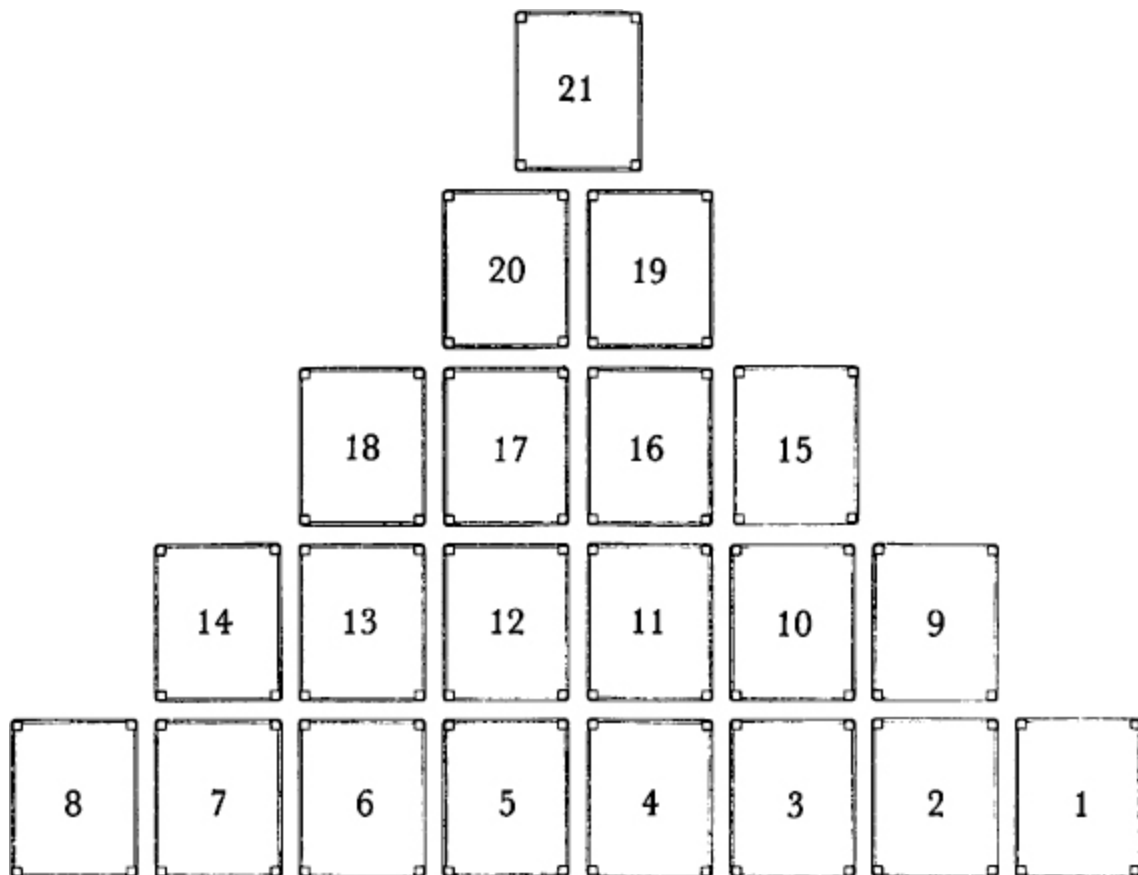
Card #9— "This is for his hopes and fears." (How expectations will be met)

Card #10— "And this is everything and all." (Card of Culmination)

Getting the Big Picture

Any of the following three spreads are informative when you are planning to do only one spread for a reading. They are also good when consultant has a number of things operating in the life for these spreads have a way of answering several questions at once.

The Pyramid Spread



This is a particularly good spread for a question that goes well back or well ahead in time—or both. Follow the plan of the diagram by starting in the lower right hand corner of the table and lay eight cards face down going from right to left. Continue with this procedure in the ascending rows of respectively six, four, and two cards, and then the final card becomes the top of the pyramid. Starting at the lower right hand corner, count five cards

and turn over the fifth card. Counting that card as one, repeat this procedure four more times until you have turned over the cards numbered 9, 13, 17, and 21. In each case, the card turned over represents the key to a particular time period. The time lines are as follows:

Cards #1–5—Distant Past

Cards #6–9—Past

Cards #10–13—Present

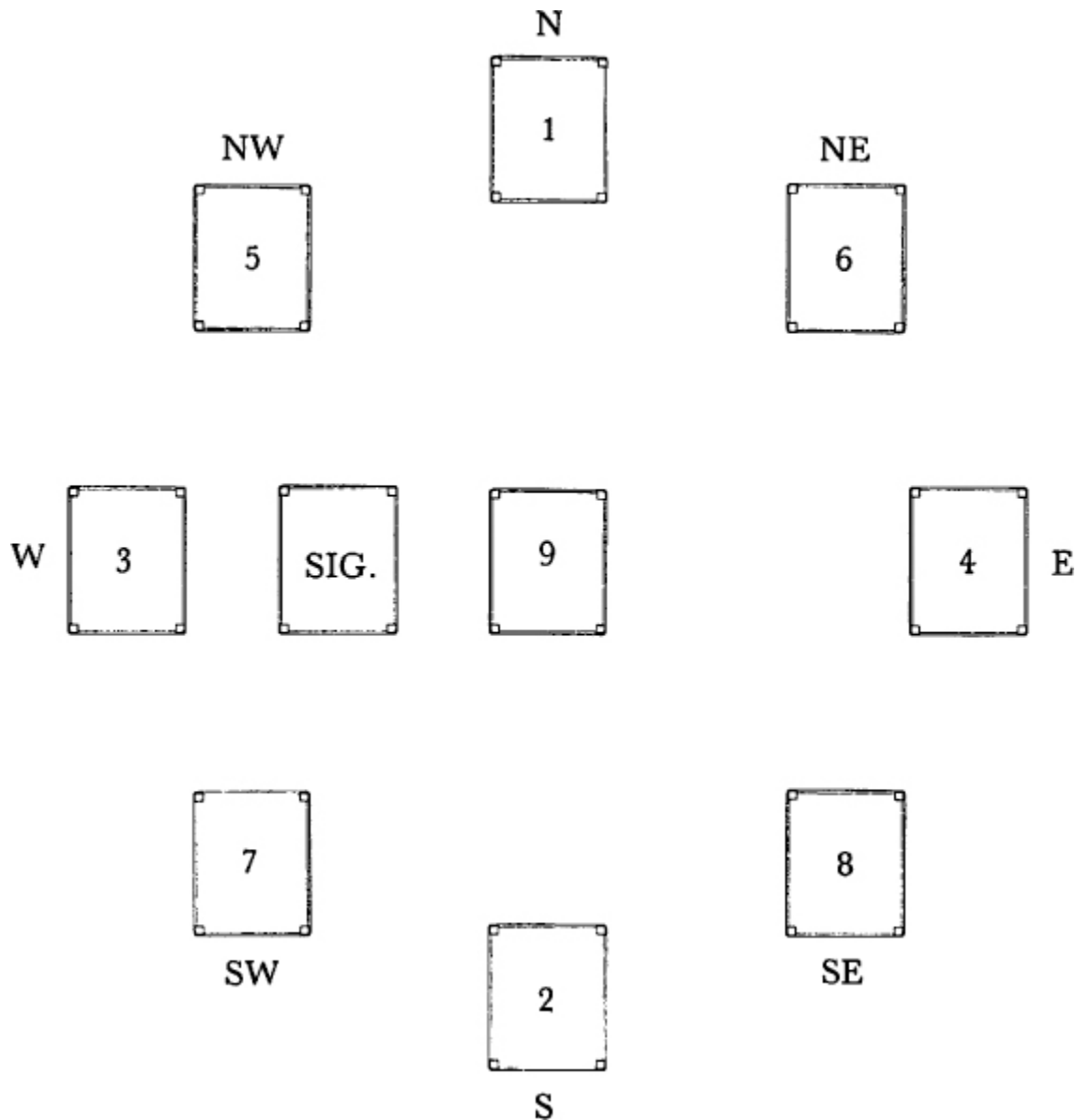
Cards #14–17—Immediate Future

Cards #18–20—Future

Card #21—Outcome

The method to follow is to start by reading card #5, the key to the Distant Past, then turn over cards #1–4 and interpret them in light of card #5. Do the same with each successive time line. The card at the top of the pyramid should be studied and interpreted with particular care for it not only represents the outcome but it ties everything in the spread together.

Wheel of Fortune



Choose a significator, using any of the methods suggested earlier and place it face up in the center of the table. This spread is in the shape of a compass, hence, the name. It is called the Wheel of Fortune and should that card appear in the spread it would be of special significance.

After consultant has cut and shuffled, take the top three cards from the pack and place them in the form of a fan face down in the pile designated #1 according to the diagram, which would correspond to the North on a compass. Continue this procedure of laying three cards at a time at the various compass points until you have eight piles on the rim of the wheel.

The ninth pile you then place in the center of the compass to the right of the significator.

As you throw this spread think or say aloud the following:

Pile #1—“Three above you.” (Covering influence)

Pile #2—“Three below you.” (Matters in control of consultant)

Pile #3—“Three behind you.” (Past)

Pile #4—“Three before you.” (Immediate Future)

Pile #5—“Three for your house and home.”

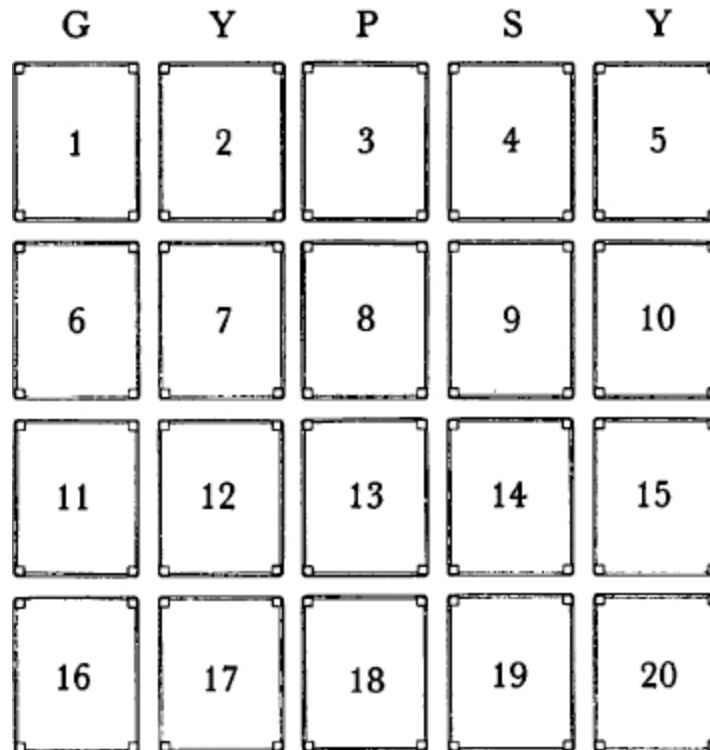
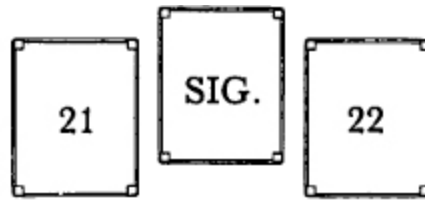
Pile #6—“Three for your hopes and fears.”

Pile #7—“Three for what you *do* expect.”

Pile #8—“Three for what you do *not* expect.”

Pile #9—“And three for what is sure to come.”

The Gypsy Spread



In this spread The Magician is used as a significator so he should be removed from the pack and placed face up at the top of the table before handing the deck to consultant for cutting and shuffling.

When pack has been returned to you, fan the cards on the table, forming a semi-circle, and ask consultant to choose twenty-two at random, one at a time, face down. After this has been done ask consultant to shuffle just those twenty-two cards and put the rest of the pack aside. Next throw the spread according to diagram the noting that you start with the top row and lay the cards from left to right. Card #20 completes the fourth horizontal row, and cards #21 and 22 go, respectively, to the left and right of significator.

You may, if you wish, as a memory aid, imagine the word “Gypsy” over the five vertical rows, so that cards #1, 6, 11, and 16 would be under the “G”, cards #2, 7, 12, and 17 would be under the first “Y”, and so on.

Note that the cards are read in *vertical rows* starting with the “G” in “Gypsy” and ending with the final “Y” in that word. Following are the meanings for each row:

G (Cards #1,6,11,16)—**Gateway:** Questions under contemplation

Y (Cards #2,7,12,17)—**Yin:** Issues to meditate upon before taking action

P (Cards #3,8,13,18)—**Partnership:** Home and Career

S (Cards #4,9,14,19)—**Self:** Present psychic state of consultant

Y (Cards #5,10,15,20)—**Yang:** Issues to give the name of action

The final cards to be read are the ones on either side of the significator:

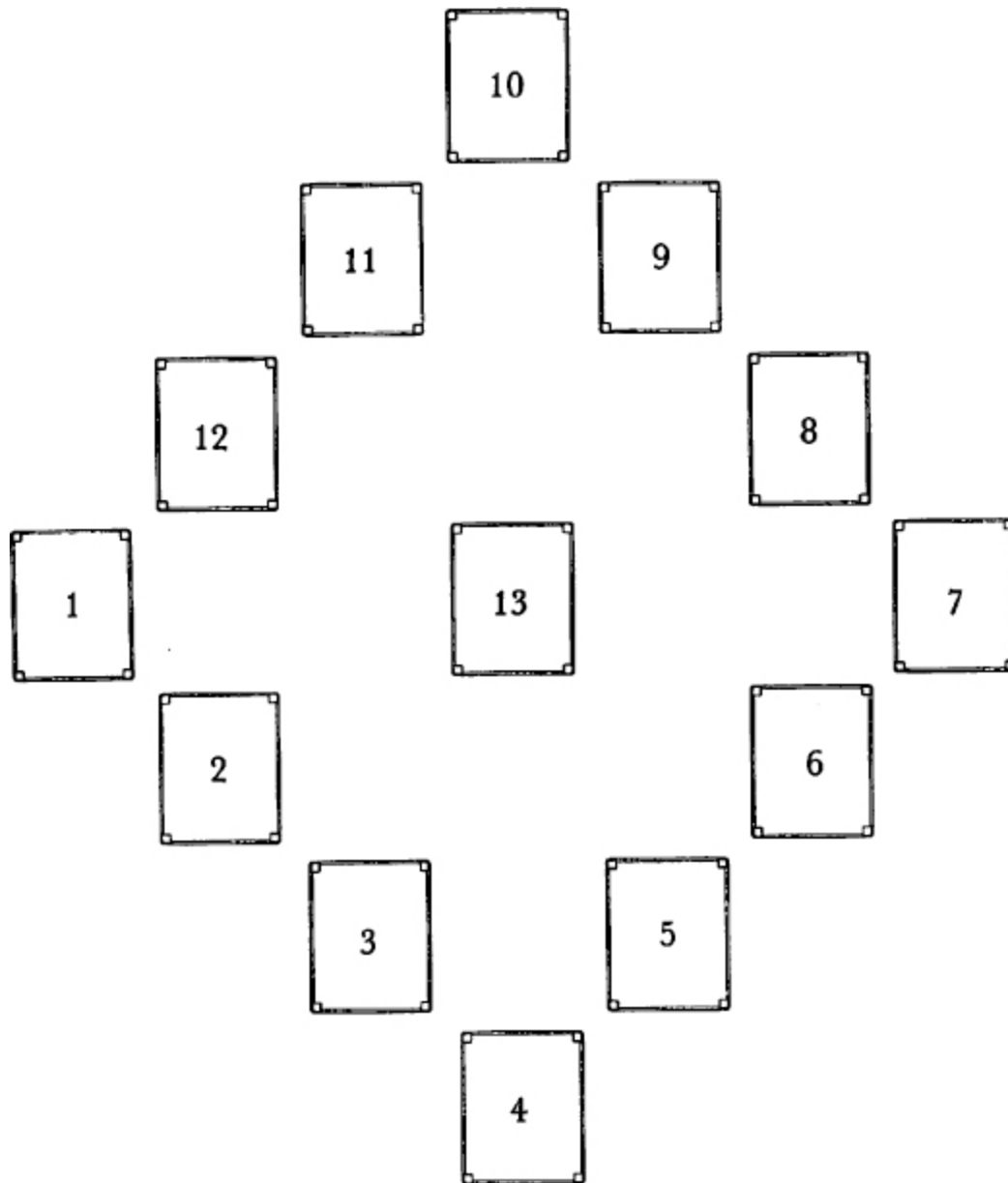
Card #21—Expectations of consultant

Card #22—To what extent consultant’s expectations will be realized

Answering Questions Concerning Health

If consultant has a health problem, is contemplating an operation, or is simply concerned about his or her health, the following spreads are just what the doctor did not order but maybe should have. The first spread—Dr. Zodiac—is extremely accurate and if the health picture it presents is generally favorable, you can reassure the consultant and then turn to some other type of question. If, however, there does appear to be a serious health problem or if there is a decision to be made about having an operation, the thing to do is to proceed further and do the Planetary Mansions spread.

Dr. Zodiac



This spread deals with the signs of the zodiac and the parts of the body they rule, which are as follows:

Pile #1—Aries: Head and shoulders

Pile #2—Taurus: Throat

Pile #3—Gemini: Bronchial tubes, collarbone, fingers, arms, nervous system

Pile #4—Cancer: Breast, stomach

Pile #5—Leo: Heart, side, upper back

- Pile #6—Virgo: Bowels, solar plexus
- Pile #7—Libra: Kidneys, lower back
- Pile #8—Scorpio: Sex organs, pelvis, bladder
- Pile #9—Sagittarius: Hips, thighs, liver
- Pile #10—Capricorn: Knees, bony structure
- Pile #11—Aquarius: Calves, ankles, bodily fluids
- Pile #12—Pisces: Feet, psychic faculties
- Pile #13—Overall Health

Begin the reading by turning over the cards in the first pile for Aries, and after reading and interpreting those, continue around the zodiac. Do not look for literal meanings of the cards in this spread but rather do the reading intuitively. Negative cards such as the suit of Swords would indicate the problem areas; mainly positive cards in a pile would suggest consultant is free and clear with regard to that portion of the body. A pattern of Sword cards combined with negative Major Arcana cards in a pile would indicate a given affliction was psychosomatic in nature. The final four cards in the center offer an overall picture of the health throughout life. The whole spread really hinges on these four cards and if they are positive, consultant essentially has nothing to worry about. This may appear a contradiction if a number of negative cards are scattered through the signs but in practice you will find it is not. Remember, this spread deals with the entire life and many people, who enjoy sound health in their mature years, had more than the usual number of childhood sicknesses. One pattern to look for: If Sword cards appear and are generally accompanied by one or more Tarot Trumps, the mental state of consultant is all-important as to whether or not a particular affliction manifests.

Planetary Mansions

49	48	47	46	45	44	43	Saturn— 7th Row
42	41	40	39	38	37	36	Jupiter— 6th Row
35	34	33	32	31	30	29	Mars— 5th Row
28	27	26	25	24	23	22	Sun— 4th Row
21	20	19	18	17	16	15	Venus— 3rd Row
14	13	12	11	10	9	8	Mercury— 2nd Row
7	6	5	4	3	2	1	Moon— 1st Row
Future			Present		Past		

This spread is reminiscent of the “Chaldean order” of antiquity, which was concerned with the seven original planets and the affairs of life they governed. If done thoroughly, the Planetary Mansions spread could easily constitute an entire reading. It is the logical follow-up to the preceding spread, for Dr. Zodiac *diagnoses* and pinpoints the health problem but this spread gets to the root of the matter and *prescribes* what needs to be done. You may wish to do only a superficial reading of the Mansions that are not

of immediate concern to consultant and give a careful interpretation of the ones that are concerned with health. But do not be too hasty for more often than not, a health condition is related to something such as family or career and that could only be ascertained by a closer reading of all Mansions. The affairs ruled by each of the seven planets of antiquity are as follows:

Moon—1st Mansion: The home, women in general, the public, and if consultant is a man, his wife.

Mercury—2nd Mansion: Writing, intellectual activities, travel, brothers and sisters.

Venus—3rd Mansion: Love, partnerships, life style, friends.

Sun—4th Mansion: Health and vitality, honor, superiors, men in general, and if consultant is a woman, her husband.

Mars—5th Mansion: Creative energies, sexuality, accidents, strife, afflictions, and enemies.

Jupiter—6th Mansion: Religion, professional people, business, employment, speculation and gambling.

Saturn—7th Mansion: Sickness, old age, real estate, losses, disappointments, secret enemies.

Throw the spread according to the diagram. If you are going to interpret all the cards in the spread, start with the first Mansion of the Moon and read from right to left. In each Mansion the first three cards deal with the past, the middle card deals with the present, and the final three cards deal with the future.

Seven Tarot Trumps have planetary associations. Should a corresponding card come up in the Mansion it is linked with, it would be significant as an indication that the affairs of that Mansion are essentially benevolent. The correspondences follow:

Moon—The Chariot

Mercury—The Magician

Venus—The Empress

Sun—The Sun

Mars—The Emperor

Jupiter—The Angel of Time

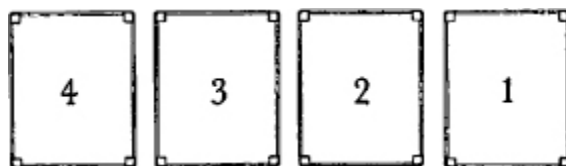
Finding Answers to Difficult Questions

Most readings proceed on course, and before an hour has passed the consultant's questions have largely been picked up by the Tarot and answered with a reasonable degree of satisfaction. On occasion, however, this does not happen. Sometimes the cards seem to be elusive or vague and do not suggest a clear direction or interpretation. There are a number of reasons for this. For example, in a given question there may be so many variables operating that it is simply not possible to answer the question at the time of the reading. This, in fact, is often the case. But what you need to know at that point in the reading is whether or not the question *can* be answered at that time. The first of the following spreads, Opening the Key, will provide an immediate yes or no, and if the answer is yes, will answer the question in a rather interesting and elaborate way.

The second, The Churchyard Spread, is somewhat different in nature, for in addition to saying yes or no, it will indicate whether the question is the real question or only a *cul de sac*. If the question is not worth pursuing or if there is a deeper or more significant question, The Churchyard Spread will bring it to light.

NOTE: It is best in a given reading to throw only one of these two spreads if you get a “No” answer the first time around. For if the Tarot tells you, “No, that question cannot be answered at the present time,” it would be pointless to ask it a second time.

Opening the Key



First, decide upon a significator but leave it in the pack. After consultant has shuffled, request that the pack be placed upon the table and

then he or she should cut the deck *to the left* into two piles, and following, each of these two piles should be cut to the left again. From right to left (instructions are always from reader's point of view) these piles correspond to the four suits of the Minor Arcana, which cover the following:

Goins—Money, possessions

Wands—Matters of work and business

Cups—Love, marriage, pleasure

Swords—Troubles, afflictions, sorrow, losses

Now look through the pile corresponding to the type of question asked but be careful not to disturb the order of the cards should you receive a “Yes” answer. The significator should be in this pile. If it is not, abandon the question for at least twelve hours.

But if the significator does appear in the correct pile—and it will, surprisingly often—you must now fan the cards in a circle face up with the significator at the top, taking care to preserve the order of the cards. You must now isolate certain cards in the circle by counting from the significator in the direction he or she is looking. (If the significator is full face, count to the left of it.) Here is the numerical procedure to follow:

For kings, queens, and knights, count 4

For pages, count 7

For aces, count 11

For a small card of the Minor Arcana, count its own number

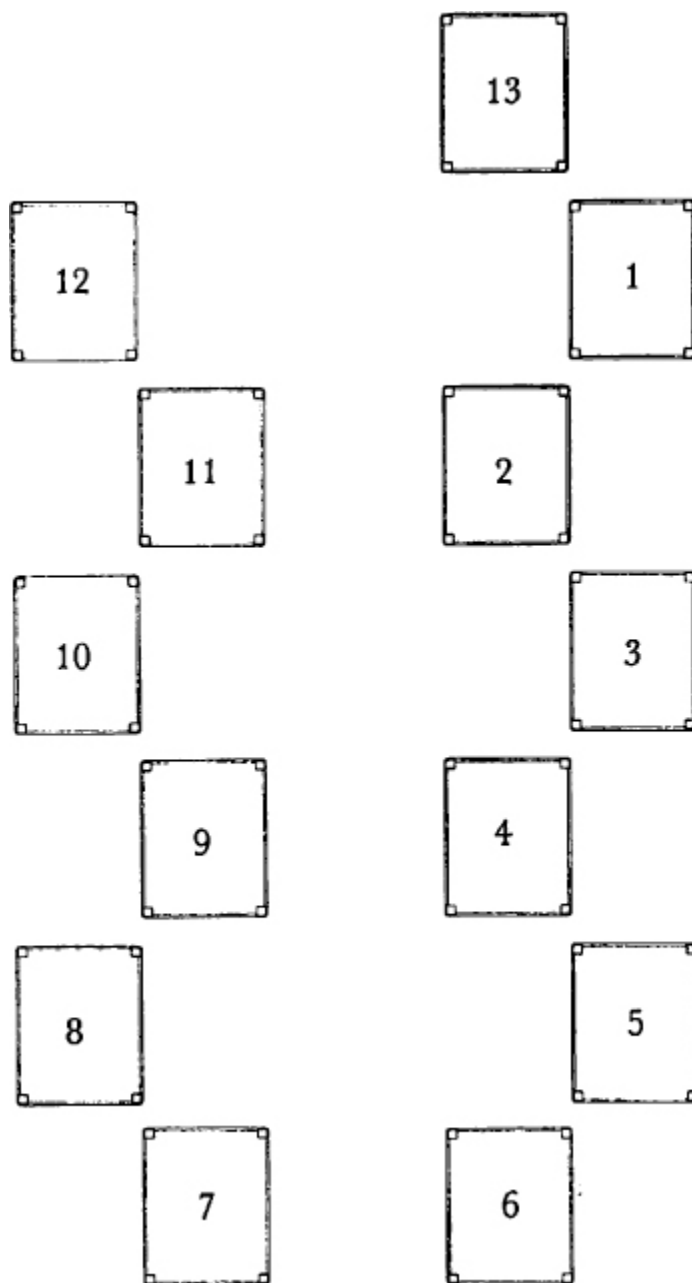
For The Fool, The Hanged Man, and Day of Judgment, count 3

For the other Trumps, count 12

Let us say that the circle has been formed with the significator at the top, which is the Queen of Cups. We know that queens count 4 so we start by counting her as the first card and moving to the left (counterclockwise). We stop at the fourth card and move it slightly out of the circle so we will know it has been counted. If that card is the Nine of Wands, we start our count with it, continue moving counterclockwise until we have counted nine cards, and the ninth card we nudge slightly so we know it has been counted. Continue the process until you reach a card you have stopped on before. Now, starting with the first counted card to the right of the significator and moving *clockwise*, read only those cards on which you

landed. If the answer is clear, well and good. If not, you can pursue the question further in the following spread.

The Churchyard Spread



Earlier it was suggested that the reader start with Opening the Key and possibly continuing with this spread in the event of a “Yes” answer. But this

spread would actually be the better one to start with if you feel there is a hidden agenda in the reading and that the consultant is not being entirely honest with you—and, more likely, with him- or herself—by concentrating on what you perceive as a relatively unimportant question. Sometimes the consultant is afraid to ask it; sometimes s/he just does not know it. This is certainly not unusual as it is quite difficult to unravel the component parts of major problems or questions. It is part of the human condition to lock some things away in the unconscious and not be aware one has done so.

Essentially, this spread will do one of two things: It will either say, “Yes, your question *is* important and this is what can be said about it at the present time.” The information given may be abundant or scanty, depending upon other factors but if the latter, consultant will at least know that the question is worth pursuing further.

Or it will say, “Look, this is not the question you need to be asking: Here is the real one....” Actually, in practice, it does not always work out quite that neatly and another possibility is that consultant will discover that his or her question is not trivial, but only that it is part of something larger that had not been taken into account.

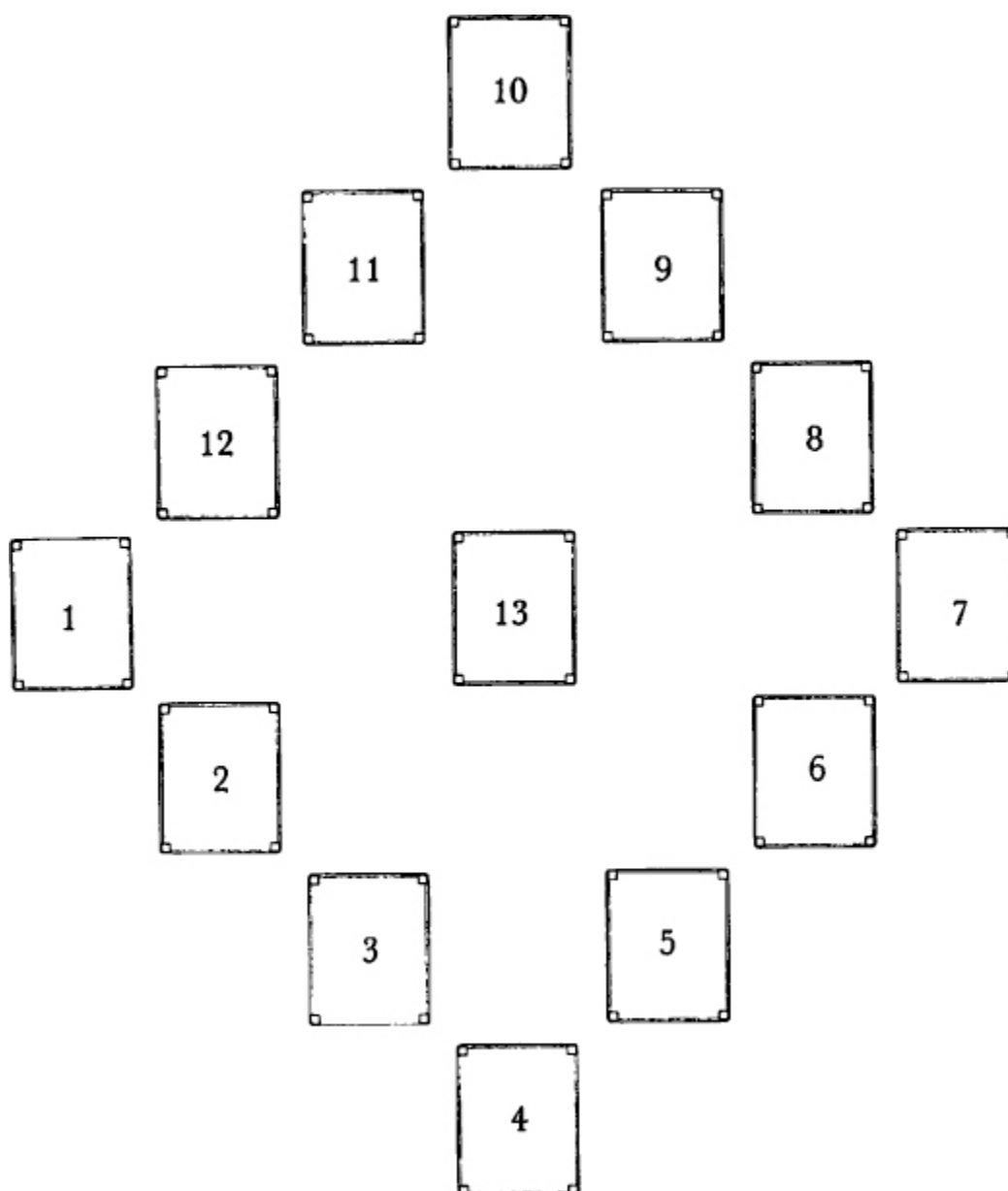
In this spread The Fool is used as a significator so begin by removing him from the pack. After consultant has cut and shuffled, take the top twelve cards for the spread and place the rest of the deck aside. Then put The Fool face down in the approximate center of the twelve-card pile and hand it to consultant for further shuffling.

Next, lay the spread according to the diagram. Turn all the cards over and note the position of The Fool. If he appears at or near the end of the spread, the indication is that the question is indeed primary and the other cards will speak to that question. If, however, The Fool appears at or near the beginning of the spread, the indicator is that the question is not worth pursuing—at least, at this time—and the real question starts with the first card following The Fool. Once you have interpreted the question, read only those cards that follow The Fool in the sequence that the spread was thrown.

Looking at the Year Ahead

The following are mainly future time spreads and are most helpful in providing the consultant with the type of information needed to prepare for the year ahead.

The Horoscope Spread



This spread is a good one to do if consultant is near a birthday and it works in much the same way that a solar return chart does in astrology. If

consultant has celebrated a birthday in the recent past, you could set it up for the time of the last birthday and the spread would encompass past, present, and future. It is important, however, that you, the reader, decide *before* the cards are shuffled what twelve-month period you wish to look at. If more than six months have gone by since the consultant's last birthday, it is usually best to project it ahead to the next one. In other words, what this spread will do is to describe influences starting around the time of a natal day and extending from birthday to birthday in a twelve-month period.

This is also a good spread for answering questions as it deals with the Twelve Houses of the Zodiac, which comprise all conditions of humankind. In laying down the spread, the first card is placed on what astrologers call "the eastern horizon" (see diagram) and the rest of the cards are laid counterclockwise with the thirteenth card going in the center. Card #1 relates to the First House of Personality; card #2 to the Second House of Material Resources, and so on for the first twelve cards. The thirteenth card is read last and serves as a major indicator for the year. Before interpreting the spread it will be necessary to know the meanings of the Twelve Houses and they are as follows:

Twelve Houses of the Zodiac

First House of Personality: Covering influence for the year

Second House of Material Resources: Money, real estate

Third House of Communications: Communications, immediate environment, brothers and sisters, short trips

Fourth House of the Home: Home environment, the mother, ending cycles

Fifth House of Creativity: Self-expression, children, love affairs, speculation

Sixth House of Health, Work and Service: Physical and mental well-being, job, community endeavors, pets, and domestic workers

Seventh House of Partners: Partnerships both marital and business

Eighth House of Death and Regeneration: Death of something or somebody in the life, regenerating influences, legacies

Ninth House of Philosophy: State of mind, long journeys

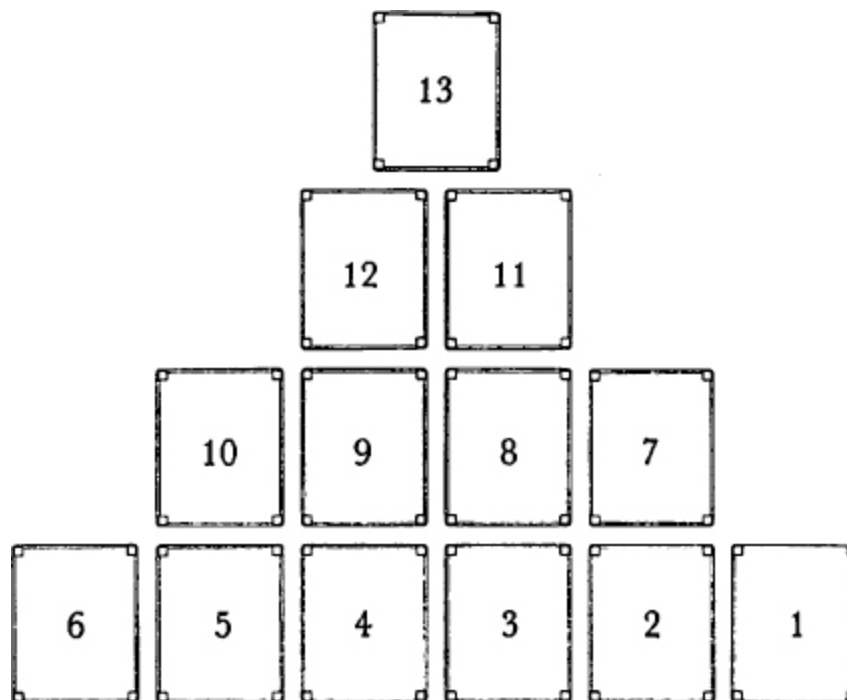
Tenth House of Career: Occupation, place in life, the father

Eleventh House of Friends, Hopes and Wishes: Favorable influences and trends

Twelfth House of Secret Enemies: Limiting influences

Start the reading by turning over and interpreting the card in the First House and continue in sequence until all twelve Houses have been read and interpreted. The thirteenth card in the center is read last and provides the major overtone for the year.

The Calendar Spread



This also is primarily a future time spread and is helpful when consultant has some expectations for the year to come and wishes to zero in on the time period when certain things will begin to manifest. The first twelve cards in the spread deal with the twelve months following and the summit card of the pyramid is the indicator for the year. Traditionally, card #1 represents the month in which the reading is being conducted—or the

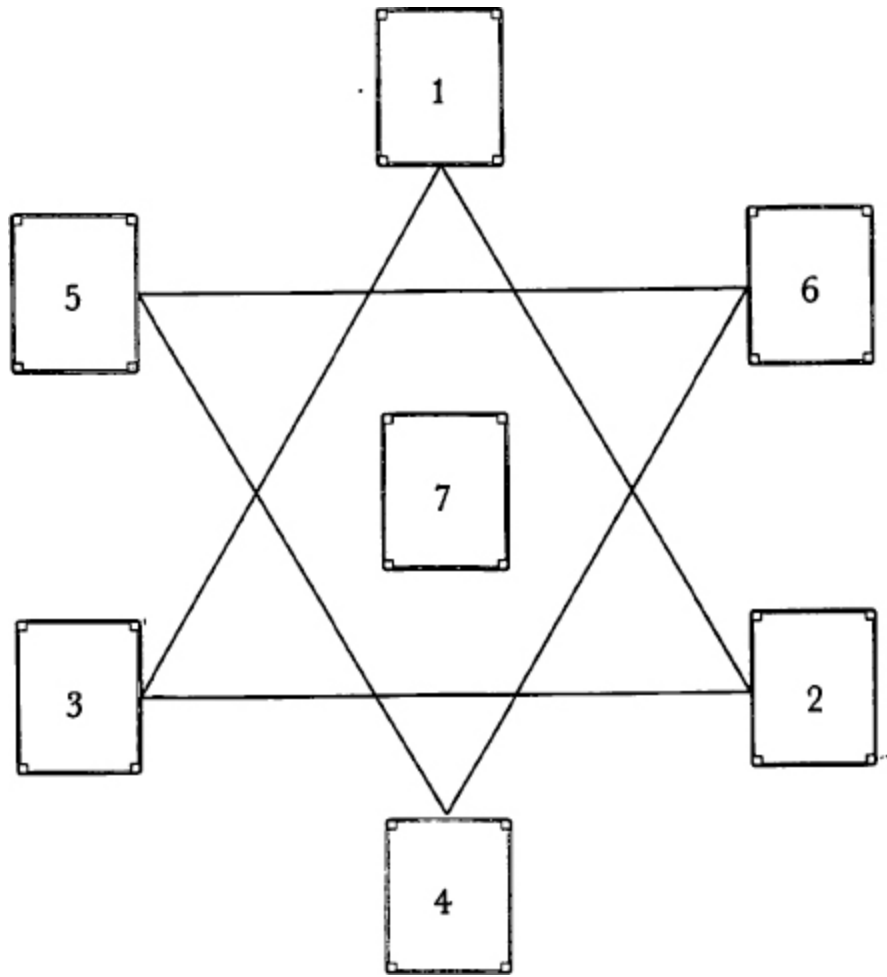
following month if it is the closing part of the month—and the next eleven cards, the succeeding months.

Ending a Reading

There is no scientific formula for picking the optimum ending spread for a reading but the two following spreads do tie certain things together. The best time to end a reading is when all questions have been answered and the reader feels that a given spread provides the right psychological moment to bring down the curtain on a reading. Sometimes a spread will be thrown that is so definitive and so up-beat it would be almost a sin to go on. It is something that has to be played by ear. Each reading has its own individual flavor and rhythm and when the right final chord is struck, that is the time to call a halt. One problem, however, is that while a reader may feel that the reading is over, the consultant almost never does, so one has to build up to it gently. One technique is to say, “Well, I think your questions have been answered. Is there anything else that you wanted to ask?”

If the consultant says “No,” then you can reply, “All right, then, for our final spread, would you like to take a look at the coming year?” Consultant will invariably answer in the affirmative and you can then exit with either the Horoscope or Calendar Spreads. If, however, consultant says, “Yes, there is...,” your cue is to say, “If anything can shed light on that question, it is this final spread we are going to do which interestingly enough is called Light of a Star.”

Light of a Star

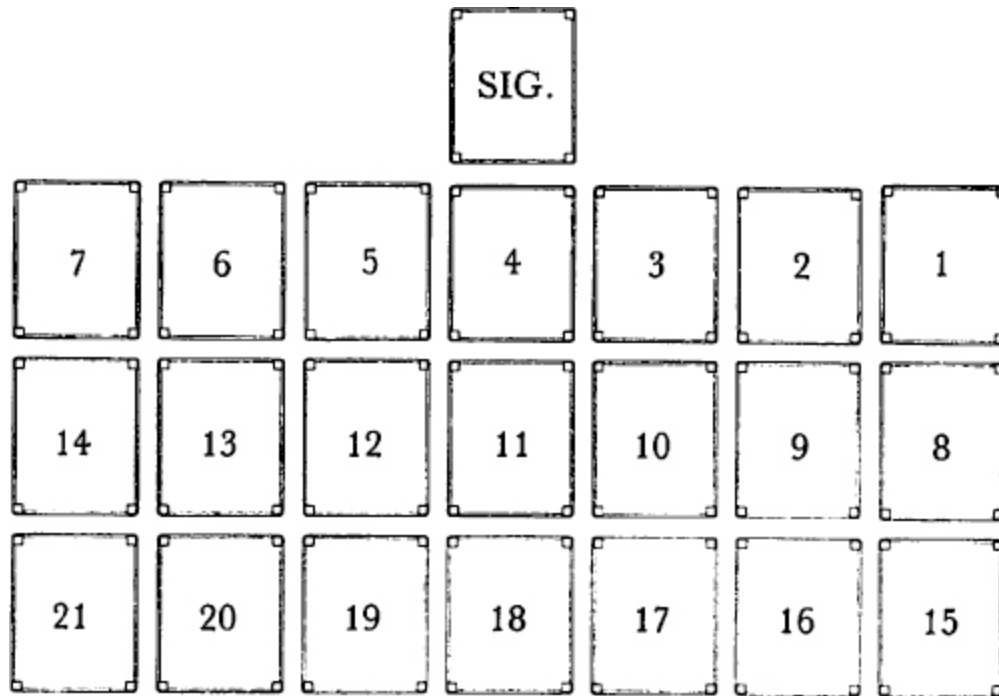


This spread takes its name from an imaginary six-pointed star, the points of which form stations for the past, present, and future of the question. The seventh station in the center of the star is the card of culmination. Following are the card meanings for each station:

- First Station: Foundation of the question or problem
- Second Station: The present as influenced by the past
- Third Station: The immediate future seen as part of the web of past and present
- Fourth Station: Type of action or lack of action that consultant must bring about for a harmonious result
- Fifth Station: Others involved whose help may prove beneficial
- Sixth Station: Opposing forces

Seventh Station: Outcome indicated by attitude and action of consultant as depicted in the preceding cards

Mystic Seven



This is a particularly good spread to end with as most of the major cards that have appeared in previous spreads will reappear in the manner of a theatre cast taking a curtain call. But what makes this spread so interesting is that a pairing technique is employed so that these same cards which may have appeared over and over again in previous spreads take on a somewhat new meaning. It is almost like fitting together the pieces of a puzzle.

Begin by choosing a significator and then remove it from the pack and place it face up in the top center of the table. After consultant has cut and shuffled, take the pack and count down to the seventh card from the top. Remove it from the deck and place it face down on the far right of the top row beneath the significator (see diagram). From where you removed the last card count down seven cards again and place this one to the left of card #1. Continue this process until you have a top row of seven cards, a middle row of seven cards, and a bottom row of seven cards. During the counting take care not to disturb the order of the pack for when you reach the bottom,

you simply return to the top and go through the pack again removing every seventh card. For example, if the bottom card is third in your count, the top card then becomes card #4, and so on.

When all the cards are in place, turn them over and comment briefly on the highlights and the meaning of the overall configuration. But the main part of the reading is the pairing process: Remove the first and last cards—cards #1 and 21—and place them next to each other off to the side of the spread. Now comment on the meaning of the paired cards as they relate to each other. Then remove card #2 and card #20 and do the same. Next will be card #3 and card #19, and you continue in this fashion until the pairs have been exhausted.

As this spread contains twenty-one cards that are actually read, there will be one card remaining that will not have a mate. If you are doing this as the ending spread then read and interpret this card with special care as it will have much to say about a particular question and quite possibly will be the key to the entire reading.

Part Three

Tarot Spreads: Life Readings

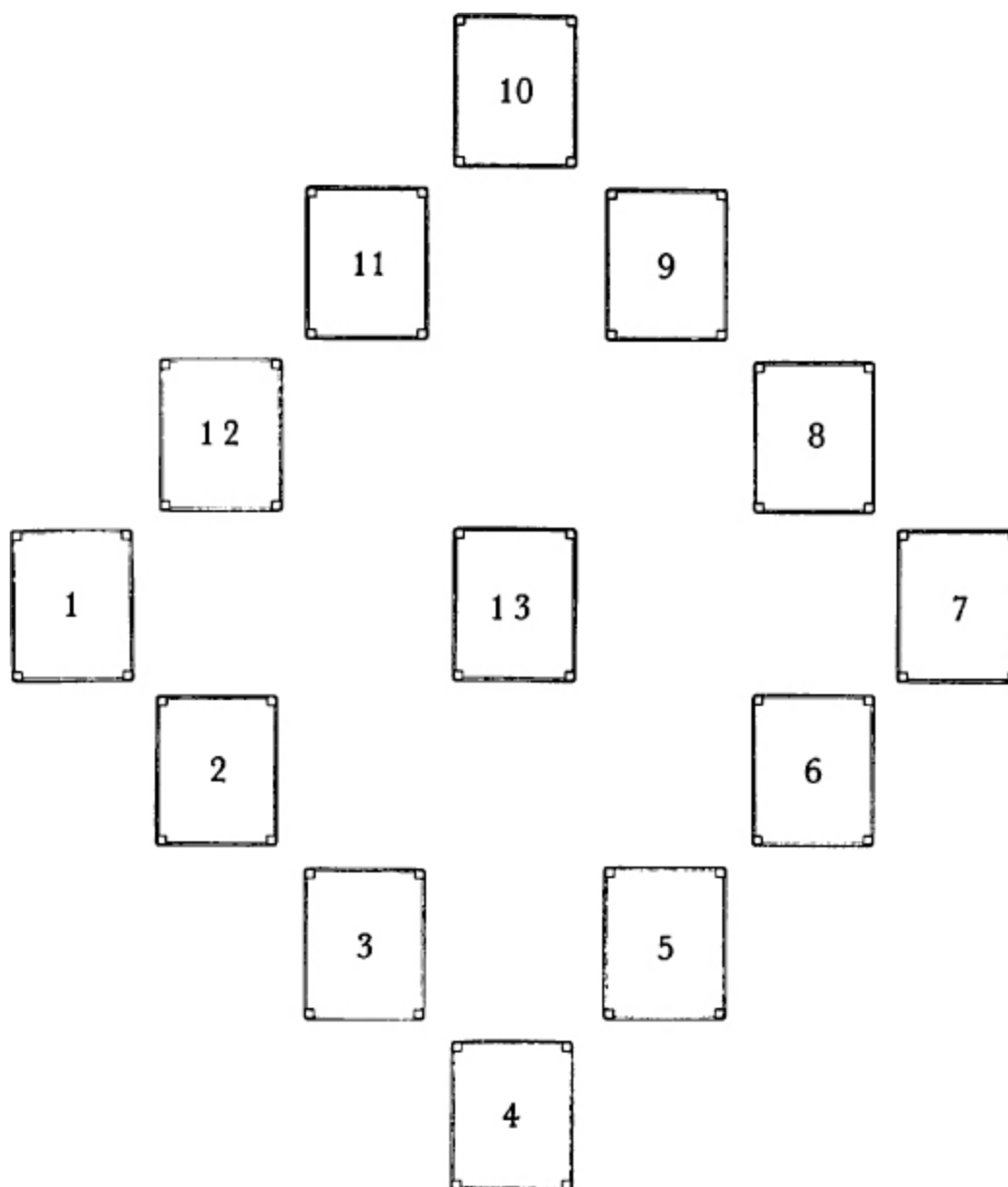
A life reading differs from an ordinary reading in that the consultant is less concerned with immediate questions and more questioning with regard to ultimate concerns. A life reading projects a picture of the entire life, its reason for being and its cardinal purpose. It can also take into account past lives of the consultant and it becomes possible to see that what we consider a lifetime is but a scene in an ongoing drama. A life reading can bring home to the consultant as nothing else can the answer to the question, “Who am I?”

A full life reading could be done on any of the seven spreads that follow, and two or three would be sufficient to digest at a single sitting. One technique that has proven satisfactory is to begin with standard spreads having to do with immediate questions and then move on to one or more of the life reading spreads.

As far as interpretation is concerned, life spreads are really the advanced course for the reader and should not be attempted by the beginner until he or she has achieved thorough mastery of the cards.

NOTE: Earlier it was suggested that a non-illustrated deck, such as the Oswald Wirth Pack depicted in this book, was best to learn on and to use in a standard reading. But life readings call for a shift in gears and for the type of spreads that follow, an illustrated deck, such as the Rider-Waite or the Morgan-Greer, might prove more evocative. Also, while the stated meanings of the cards still apply to some extent, the most profound results are usually obtained in a life reading by interpreting the cards intuitively. Just say the first thing that comes to mind; trust your instincts and do not hold back what intuitively comes to you.

The Twelve Houses

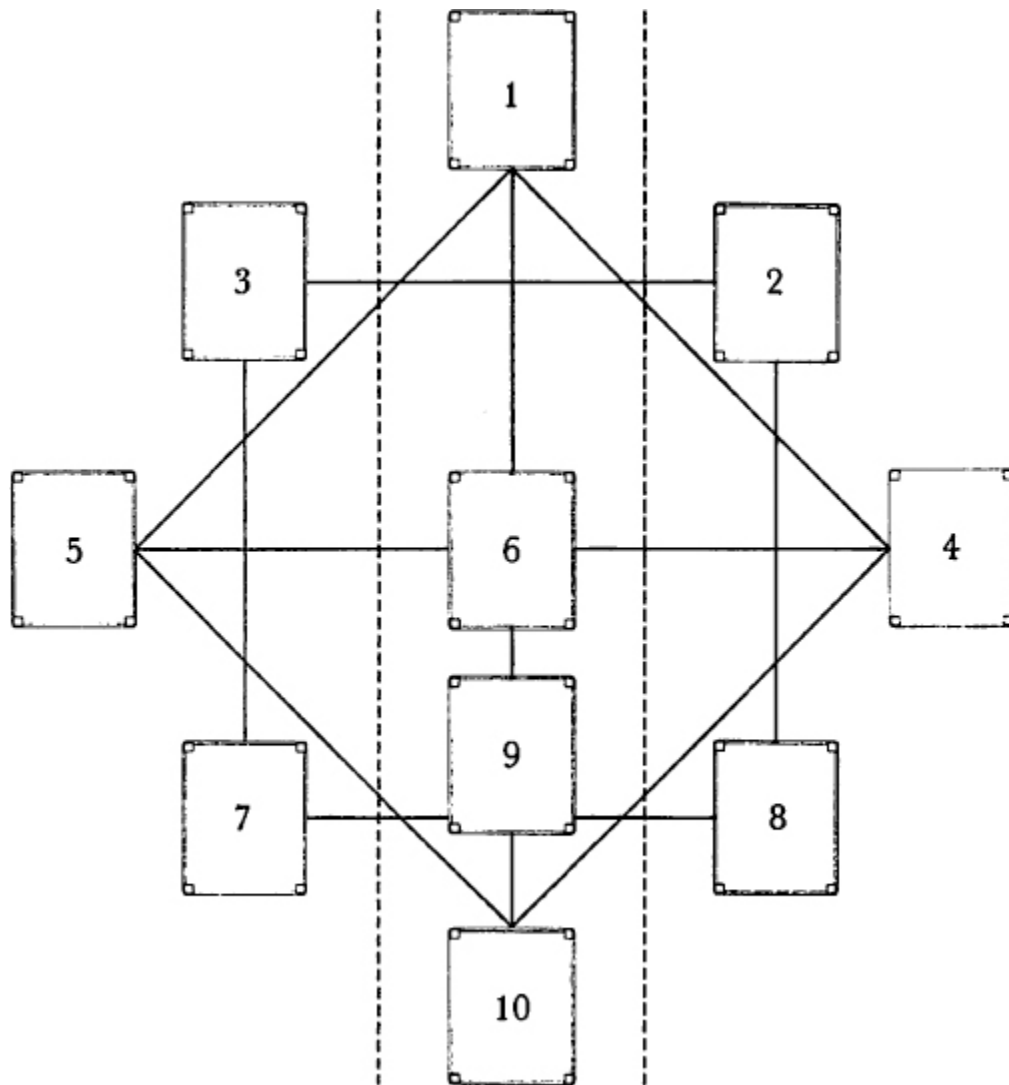


This is an excellent example of how a spread can be employed in different ways. For this spread appears in [Part Two](#) as The Horoscope Spread (see [page 96](#)) and the layout and meanings of the Houses are exactly the same. But the Twelve Houses differs from The Horoscope Spread in much the manner than an astrological solar return chart differs from a natal chart. In the first instance the emphasis is entirely on what may be expected

in the year ahead. The natal chart, however, gets into a total picture of the life and personality. But the “wheel” and Houses are the same for both.

As far as the mechanics of the spread are concerned, the beginning process is the same as The Horoscope Spread and you lay the cards in exactly the same manner. Each of the twelve cards in the circle represents a House and the meanings for the Houses also remain the same. What is different is that before cutting or shuffling is done, you simply ask the Tarot for a picture of the natal chart of the consultant as represented by the twelve Houses of the zodiac. Each House card then will represent a major issue, individual or event in the life, and of affairs pertaining to that House. The thirteenth card in the center becomes extremely important for it represents the main indicator for the life.

The Tree of Life



As is often the case, this spread can be employed in a life reading or for immediate questions. Begin by choosing a significator but leave it in the pack to fall where it may. After the pack has been cut and shuffled, lay out ten cards in the pattern of the cabalistic Tree of Life as shown by the diagram. Continue this procedure until each pile contains seven cards. Place the remaining cards aside. The meanings for the piles are as follows:

First Branch: Spiritual matters

Second Branch: Initiative, responsibilities

Third Branch: Sorrows and limitations

Fourth Branch: Money matters

Fifth Branch: Opposition, destructive factors

Sixth Branch: Achievement, the conscious mind

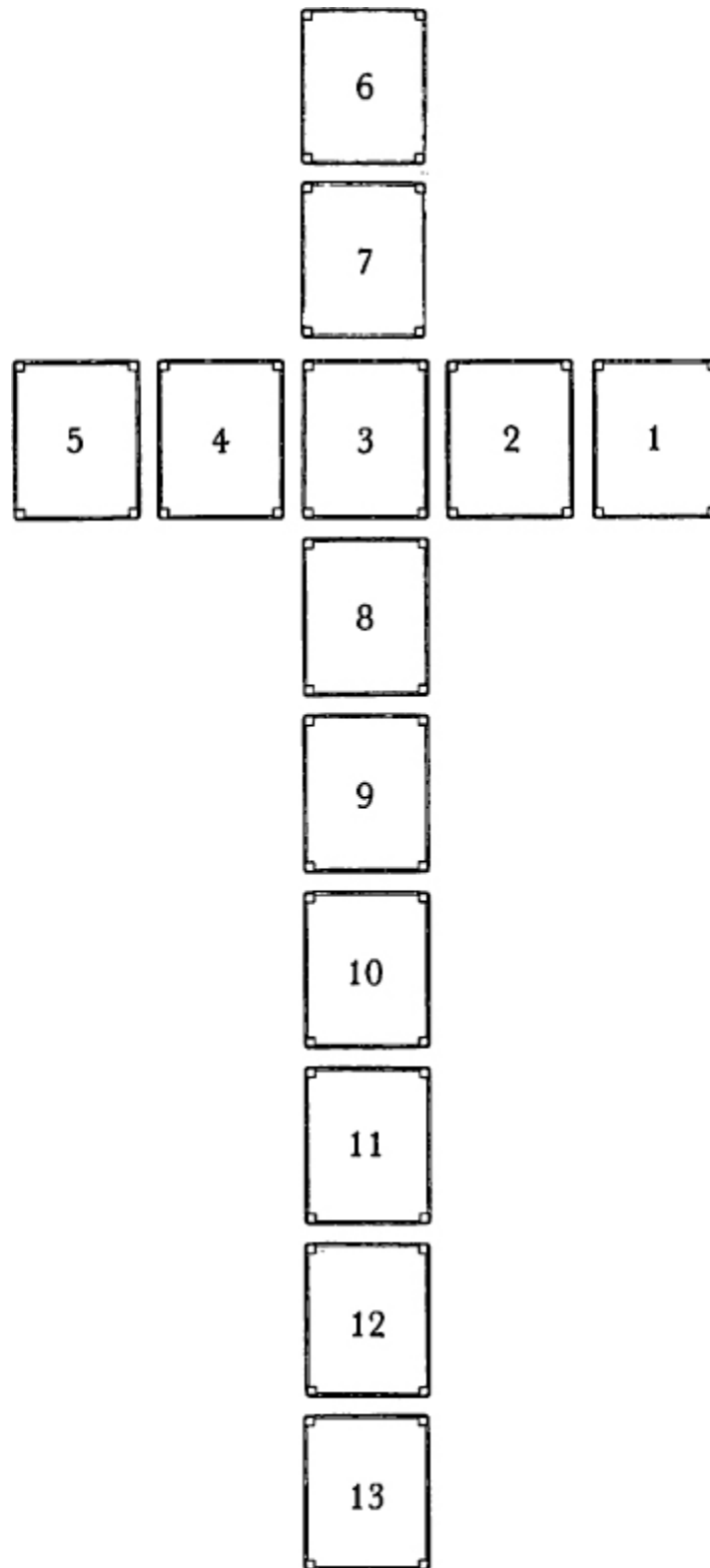
Seventh Branch: Love

Eighth Branch: Business, the arts, communication

Ninth Branch: Health, the unconscious

Tenth Branch: Home and family

The Cross of Destiny

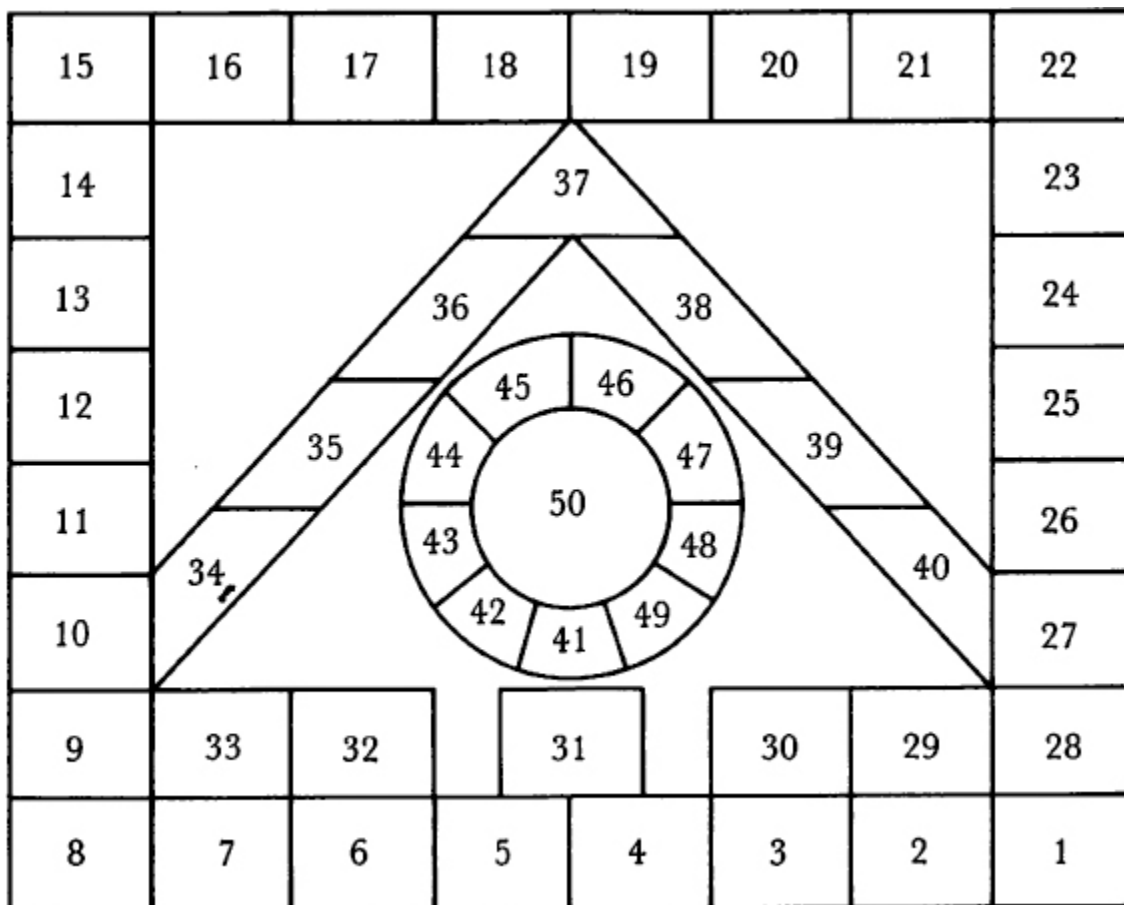


Upon cutting and shuffling, throw the spread according to the diagram.
The sequence in which the cards are to be read and the meaning for each is

as follows:

- Card #4—Id: Physical you
- Card #5—Ego: Mental you
- Card #6—Superego: Moral you
- Card #7-13—Highlights in the life
- Card #2—Karma: Main lesson to be learned
- Card #1—Central Purpose of the life
- Card #3—Culmination

Squaring the Circle



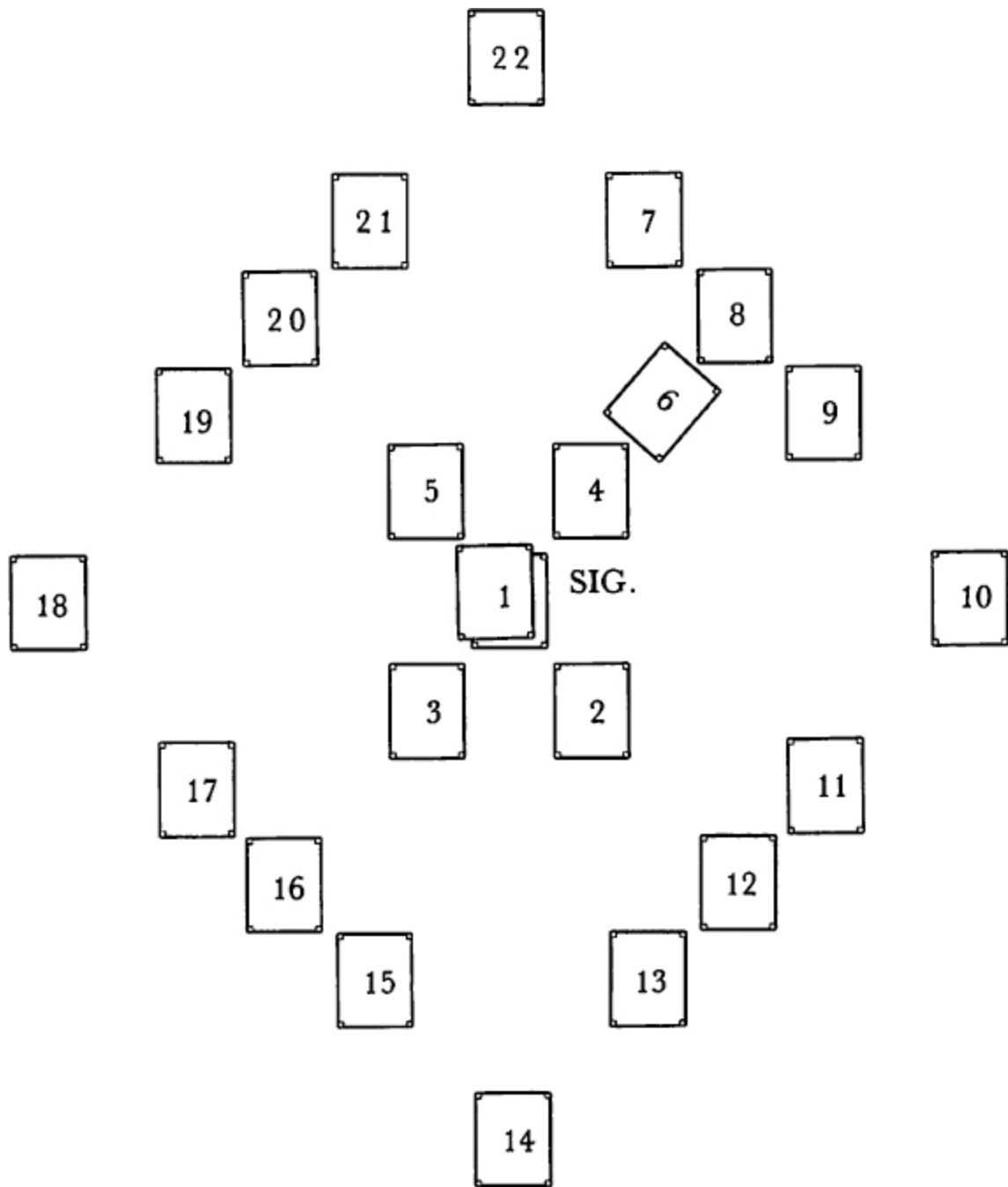
Following the diagram from right to left, form a horizontal row of seven cards, then moving up, a vertical row of seven cards, heading east a parallel horizontal row of seven cards, and a descending vertical row of seven cards, thus forming a square.

Within the square form a triangle with the base line of five cards, laying them from right to left, and then going up to form the left side of four cards, and the third side of three cards. Within the triangle, from right to left, form a circle of nine cards as depicted in the diagram. Finally, place one card in the center of the circle.

The square represents the physical plane—the body and its material attainments—past, present, and future; the triangle represents the psychological plane and has to do with mental activities; and the circle represents the spiritual plain and the higher level of being. The cards for all three planes should be read in sequence as they will show the type of development made by the individual, beginning with physical development, continuing with psychological changes, and culminating with spiritual growth.

The key card is the one in the center of the circle, which is read last as a final revelation for it will tie all three planes together and indicate the dominant influence in the life.

The Jungian Spread



In view of the fact that a number of the descriptions of the Major Arcana cards in this book are laced with insights drawn from Jungian psychology, it is only appropriate that the life spread bearing the name of this pioneering psychologist be incorporated. In *A Dictionary of Symbols*, J. E. Cirlot speaks of the relationship of Tarot to Jungian concepts of integration noting that “Tarot cards comprise an image (comparable to that encountered in dreams) of the path of initiation. At the same time Jung’s

view...recognized the portrayal of two different but complementary struggles in the life of man: (a) the struggle against others (the solar way) which he pursues through his social position and calling; and (b) against himself (the lunar way) involving the process of individuation.”

The Tarot figures clearly correspond to Jung’s theory of archetypes and it is these archetypal images in our unconscious that we must recognize and understand if we are to achieve self-realization. And to Jung, Self is “a God image, or at least cannot be distinguished from one.” Selfhood is in fact the goal of the individuation process for it represents a totality of being.

To begin this reading, choose a significator and place it face up in the center of the table. After the consultant has cut and shuffled, lay the cards according to the diagram, noting that card #1 goes face down underneath the significator. This spread consists of an inner circle and an outer circle and they correspond to the inner life and the outer life of the individual having the reading. Following are the meanings for the inner circle:

Card #1—Shadow: This represents a hidden facet of the self that needs to be recognized and accepted before total integration is possible. Card is turned over and read last and then only if consultant wishes and the twenty-second card in the midnight position on the wheel appears favorable.

Card #2—Anima: Archetype embodying the feminine principle.

Card #3—Animus: Archetype embodying the masculine principle.

Card #4—Mother: Consultant’s unconscious perceptions of motherhood.

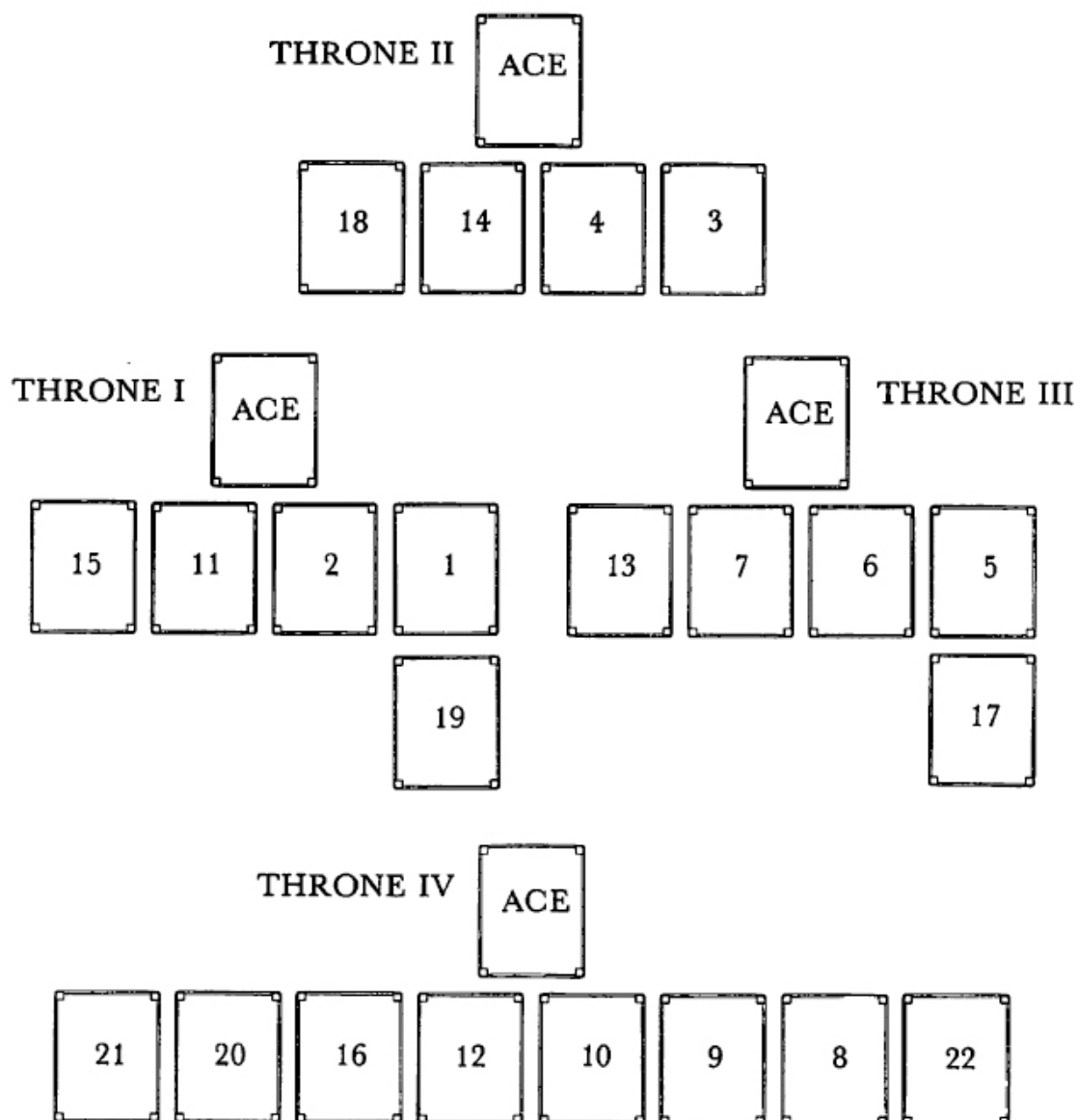
Card #5—Father: Consultant’s unconscious perceptions of fatherhood.

Card #6—Psyche: The animating life force based upon determining factors in early childhood and the unconscious.

Cards #7 to 22 of the outer circle represent key individuals, conditions and events in the life from youth to maturity.

NOTE: In a given reading, it is not possible to say in advance just how far in the life this spread will go. Occasionally it will draw a picture of the entire life up to old age and at other times it will go scarcely beyond the present. Clearly, the future is “not written in indelible ink” and the individual has the power to chart his or her own course.

Past Lives Spread



This spread is generally the *pièce de résistance* of any life reading for those who wish to mount Pegasus, the winged horse, and go riding off to the far country of time for a glimpse of another age and another life. Often as the story unfolds there is a gasp of recognition from the consultant—a feeling of *déjà vu* as it were. But this spread does more than merely titillate by offering pictorial hints of past incarnations for it helps to depict the web of relationships between this life and those gone by. In actuality, the greater portion of this spread deals with the present life but when the past lives are revealed, the karmic influence is highly suggestive. If you will look at the diagram you will see that Throne IV, the one dealing with past lives is

labeled “Psyche.” There is a reason for this: In classical mythology, Psyche was the maiden who united with Eros, the god of love, and later became the personification of the soul. So the body is transient and is something we trade in when it becomes superannuated but the soul lives on. And this soul is fashioned by every thought we think, every word we utter, every deed we do in every second of every minute in every life we have ever lived. That is why Throne IV is the foundation of the physical square representing the individual through all time for it is our psyche or soul that determines the quality of present and future lives. Fate is not something that “happens to us,” rather a series of “future reactions to past actions.” It would seem that our character is our fate.

Familiarize yourself thoroughly with the cards of the Major Arcana before attempting this spread. In regard to Throne IV particularly, use your intuitive mind as you interpret the cards. If, for example, the card of The Sun comes up, you might see that as a life in a “sun-burned” land such as Egypt or Kenya. The card of The Chariot could suggest a gladiator in ancient Rome, The Magician, a traveling sidesman during the Middle Ages. Imagination and intuition are the twin searchlights to beam on this throne of the far past.

For this spread, only the four aces and the twenty-two cards of the Major Arcana are used, so remove them from the pack but place the Trumps in one pile and the aces in another. Then hand the pile of aces to the consultant for shuffling and lay them down according to the diagram, starting with Throne I and ending with Throne IV. Next, have the consultant shuffle the Major Arcana pile and then place these cards in the following manner: The first two go in Throne I, the next two in Throne II, then *three* in Throne III, three in Throne IV, and one in Throne I as shown in the diagram. At this point you reverse direction and go counterclockwise and lay one card in each of the Thrones, continuing until you have laid down card #20 in Throne IV, after which you take the next-to-last card and place it at the beginning of Throne IV and the last card at the end.

This is admittedly a somewhat tricky spread to throw and the first few times you do it you may wish to consult the diagram as you lay the cards out. It is important to keep strictly to the stated arrangement for while Throne IV deals with past lives, the first three Thrones have to do with the present life. Also, each Throne is read in sequence going from left to right.

Begin the actual reading by turning over the ace in Throne I and comment on the meaning (see Table of Thrones below). Then read and interpret the Trumps in that Throne both individually and collectively. Continue this procedure until you have completed all four Thrones. On the following page is the meanings of the Thrones and the aces in each Throne:

Table of Thrones

Throne I—Destiny and Early Childhood

Ace of Coins: Strength and vitality

Ace of Wands: Work and responsibility

Ace of Cups: Love of pleasure, depletion

Ace of Swords: Poor health

Throne II—Career

Ace of Coins: Highly favorable

Ace of Wands: Great power

Ace of Cups: Insufficient effort

Ace of Swords: Delays and frustrations

Throne III—Love and Marriage

Ace of Coins: Powerful

Ace of Wands: Conflicts and difficulties

Ace of Cups: Joy

Ace of Swords: Quarrels

Throne IV—Psyche (Past Lives)

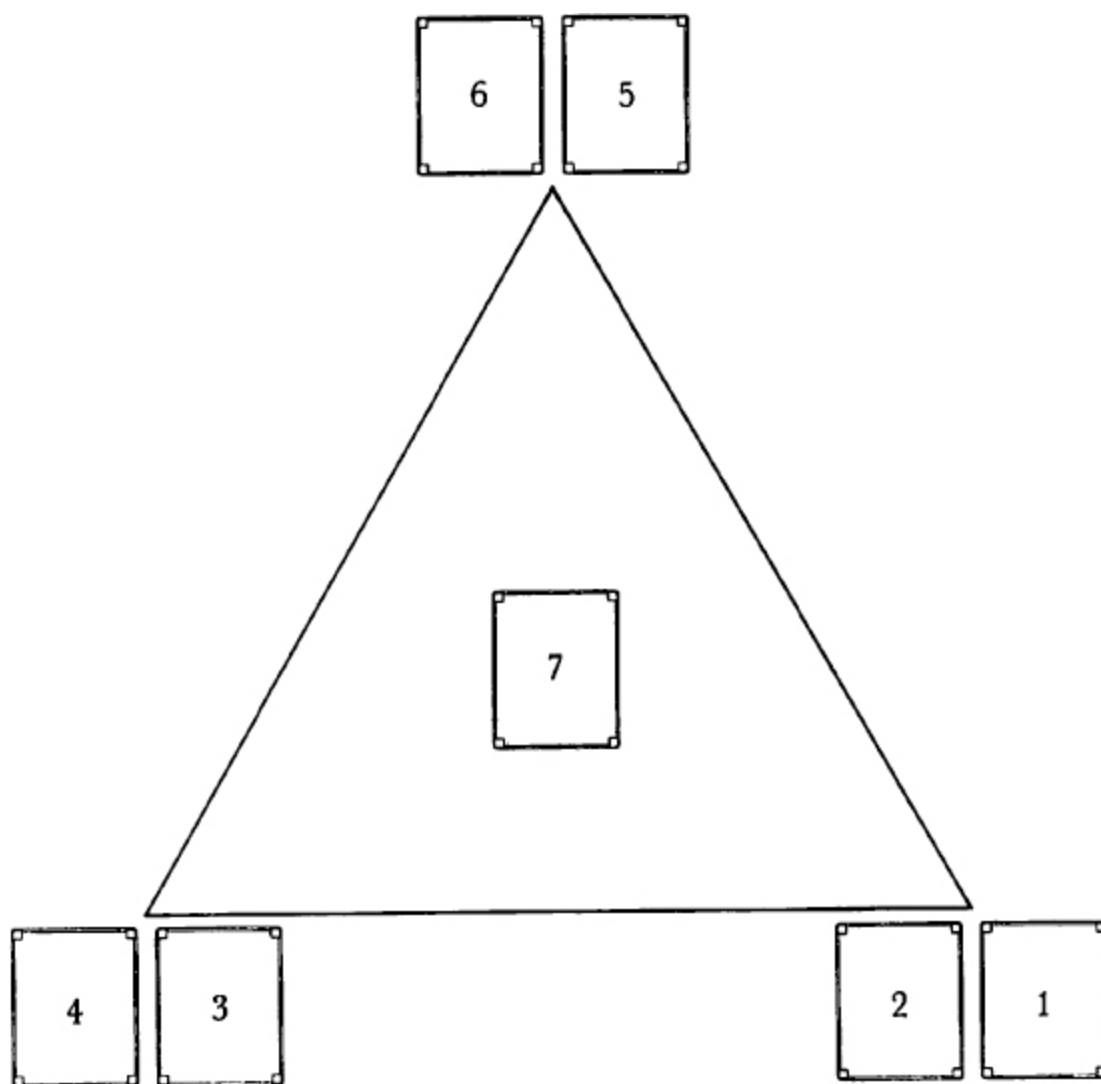
Ace of Coins: Unhappy or unlucky

Ace of Wands: Struggles

Ace of Cups: True beauty

Ace of Swords: Great power

Karmic Closeup



This spread may be imagined as taking the form of a triangle with a pair of cards at each angle and the card of karma in the center of the triangle and of the life.

This is a logical spread to do as a follow-up to Past Lives, for where that spread presented a kaleidoscope of several lives, this one allows for an intimate view of a single one—presumably, the most recent in time. Or, of course, the consultant can request a specific time period such as the medieval or the age of the renaissance. But if you ask for anything but the most recent life you have to be careful how you word the request. For instance, if you believe you were a historical figure during the Napoleonic era—maybe even Napoleon himself—you ask the Tarot for a picture of that life when the Karmic Closeup spread is thrown. But suppose you were not

Napoleon. Suppose further that you were not even “in the body” on planet earth at that time, which is an entirely reasonable supposition for reincarnation theory holds that years and sometimes centuries go by between bodily incarnations. If a spread is thrown for a life that has not been lived, cards are obviously going to have to come up but what can they possibly tell you? It would only be an exercise in fantasy and most likely, the spread itself would not be coherent.

Now, should you have reason to feel that you lived in another age, the thing to do *before* throwing the Karmic Closeup spread would be to establish that by throwing another spread first to get an answer to the question, “Was I so-and-so?” There are various ways of doing this but a suggested method would be to do the Opening the Key Spread (see [page 92](#)). You would decide on a significator beforehand and for Napoleon, the card of The Emperor would fit nicely as would any of the four Horsemen, particularly the Knight of Swords. You would also have to determine which pile would be appropriate for your Napoleon significator to be in and you might decide that the Swords pile would be apt as any.

Should you do Opening the Key and the significator for what you believe to be a past incarnation does come up in the designated pile, and the story line in that pile also seems to be on target, you can then throw the Karmic Closeup with some measure of confidence.

But not so fast. You can take one more safety measure. Ask the Tarot for a natal chart of that life (see The Twelve Houses spread, [page 107](#)) and see if that life reading is reasonably descriptive of the life as you know it. Now for the acid test: If after throwing the two spreads just named you are still convinced that you were Napoleon (or whomever), ask the Tarot to cast a transit chart for a decisive year in the life (see The Horoscope Spread, [page 96](#)). Such a year for Napoleon would have been 1815, which was when he lost his empire in the Battle of Waterloo. If a Horseman comes up reversed along with other suggestive cards such as the reversed Emperor, the Lightning-Struck Tower, The Hermit, The Fool, and a bouquet of Sword cards it could indicate the past life connection you sought.

Throwing spreads such as Past Lives and Karmic Closeup are fascinating in and of themselves but they can also be used in an instructive manner. It would be a good idea to preserve the Past Lives and Karmic Closeup spreads that you throw for yourself and spend some time meditating over them. Also, you might find it helpful to ask yourself

questions such as, “What was positive about that life?” “What was negative?” “What might I have done differently?” And particularly, you might ask yourself, “What should I be doing right *now* in this life to nourish my soul growth?” And if you have trouble coming up with answers, simply ask the Tarot for it is on this plane that its teachings are most illuminating.

Any of the spreads in this book can be used for that purpose but you will probably find that Karmic Closeup is the most provocative. In throwing this spread, the first six cards are placed according to the diagram. But since the seventh is essentially the card of karma, and karma is the sum total of our thoughts and actions, the card is determined by the six others that represent the life. After the cards have been turned over and read, the reader finds the seventh card of the Karmic Balance Sheet by adding up the numbers of the six cards in the spread and then counting down in the pack until that number has been reached. This card will indicate what was left undone—or possibly, overdone—in a previous life, and what needs to be corrected in the present life if the Balance Sheet is to come out “in the black.” Should the card of The Sun, The World, or The Fool appear in this position, it would suggest an old soul who has attained a high degree of involution and evolution.

Meanings for the cards are as follows:

Card #1—Destiny: Outer manifestation of the life

Card #2—Self: Inner purpose of the life

Cards #3 & 4—Major Influences: Shaping forces of the life

Card #5—Involution: Direction of the soul’s journey in the life

Card #6—Evolution: Destination the soul reached in the life

Card #7—Karmic Balance Sheet: Main lesson to be learned in the present life

Part Four

Transcriptions of Tarot Readings

Robin's Reading

Three Faces of Time (see [page 76](#))

Eastern Cross (see [page 80](#))

Wheel of Fortune (see [page 84](#))

Light of a Star (see [page 99](#))

The consultant is a young married woman with a career as a fabric designer. At the time of the reading she and her husband were planning to relocate.

Three Faces of Time

Past

- 1— 5 of Cups
- 2— Ace of Wands
- 3— Knight of Coins
- 4— 10 of Wands
- 5— Ace of Cups

Present

- 6— Queen of Swords
- 7— King of Wands
- 8— The Hermit
- 9— The Hanged Man
- 10— 7 of Wands

Future

- 11— 9 of Coins
- 12— 4 of Swords
- 13— Justice
- 14— 7 of Coins
- 15— The Emperor

SK: Robin, I know you have all kinds of questions at the moment so perhaps we should start by taking the one that is uppermost in your mind. I am going to fan the deck out on the table and what I would like you to do is pick cards one at a time and hand them to me. But while you are doing that I would ask that you concentrate on a particular question.

R: Okay.

SK: (Following the selection, shuffling, and throwing of the spread) Now that the spread is down, let me explain how it works: The bottom row has to do with the past, the center row with the present, and the top row with the future. I am going to begin by turning over the center cards of the Present row as that is the center of the present; it is the center of the spread; and in some ways it is the center of your life at the moment. It is the card of The Hermit and that is relevant for, like you, he is going on a journey and

because he is setting out in darkness he is not quite sure of his way or just what he is going to find when he gets there.

R: Yes, that is my question.

SK: Now we turn over the center card of the past, which is the Knight of Coins. I interpret that to be a rather young person with thoughts of establishing herself in what she does creatively in the big city.

R: Career was all I could think of when I came to New York City.

SK: And now, looking at the center card of the future, we see the card of Justice. This is your card, Robin, for you can see that Justice is holding a pair of scales in one hand, which is the symbol for your sign, Libra. Your whole life is in effect a balancing act. And this is going to be particularly true in the immediate future for you are going to have to balance between what you do creatively and raising a family.

R: It is a lesson I am starting to learn.

SK: Okay, let's look at the line of the Past and see what else was important that bears on your question. The beginning card of the spread is the Five of Cups. Five is the number of fulfillment, in this case, emotional fulfillment and since it is followed by the Ace of Wands, the Knight of Coins, and the Ten of Wands, fulfillment for you—in the past—has centered around your artwork and designing fabrics.

R: I went through some pretty rough periods and my creative life is what kept me in one piece.

SK: The final card of the Past appears to be about three years ago for it is the Ace of Cups. This is the second ace that has come up, and aces are powerful cards for they have to do with important beginnings in the life. The first ace we turned over was the Ace of Wands, which has to do with a creative venture or career beginning, but the Ace of Cups means the beginning of something new and beautiful and that seems to be when love walked in.

R: For the first time in my life I realized that career is not necessarily everything.

SK: All right, let's look at the line of the Present. The first card is the Queen of Swords. Is there a woman executive with whom you deal right

now who might also be helpful in the future?

R: Yes, there is. She has been very influential in introducing me to some of the top people in New York and she is going to continue to be a contact after I leave.

SK: The second card of the Past was the Ace of Wands, which was the beginning of your career. The second card of the Present is the King of Wands. Kings refer to men and this particular man is one who is very much on the same wavelength as you, so he most likely has to do with your second career—which is marriage.

R: That has been true for the past several months.

SK: It looks like the next few weeks are going to be a little tricky for The Hermit is in the dark and The Hanged Man is upside down. But take heart for you get help from the man next to The Hermit, the King of Wands—namely your spouse. And the line of the Present ends on an upbeat note with the Seven of Wands, which marks an important career change and that of course will be the time you and the King of Wands make your move.

R: These cards of The Hermit and The Hanged Man don't exactly look like happy cards.

SK: They are not but when one is embarking on a flight into the unknown there is usually a tense period after the countdown has started; that is the message of The Hermit and The Hanged Man. The Hermit will be okay once he sees the light and so will The Hanged Man once he gets on his feet.

R: That is nice to hear but what do the cards say about the future?

SK: The first card of the Future line is the Nine of Coins. Nine is the number that has to do with endings and beginnings and is symbolized by the card of The Hermit, who is number 9 in the Tarot sequence. The Nine of Coins is saying only that this new beginning is going to require a cash outlay, which hardly comes as news to you.

R: True enough, but it is still not easy.

SK: The next card, the Four of Swords, indicates that there is probably going to be a waiting period for you after the move. I think that too is to be expected in view of the fact that you are expecting. When is the baby due?

R: Some time in June.

SK: So, you are not going to be able to do too much career-wise until after that. But you will notice that Justice—the woman who has told you to keep things in balance—is followed by the Seven of Coins.

R: Didn't you say that seven was the number of change?

SK: Absolutely. You remember, the Seven of Wands was the card that ended the line of the Present and had to do with a change in career.

R: And does the Seven of Coins mean a change in my financial situation?

SK: Yes, but the card specifically has to do with a business trip so travel of one kind or another is probably going to be included in this change.

R: But is it a change for the better or worse?

SK: There is positively no question about it, Robin, for the last card is The Emperor. And The Emperor is someone who makes it big. But it is all of a piece. For in the Past you have the Ten of Wands, indicating someone who has the potential to rise to the top of her profession. Be patient, keep things in balance, and have faith in the future for coronation day is coming!

Wheel of Fortune

Significator: The Empress

Pile #1—"Three above you"—The High Priestess, 3 of Wands, 5 of Cups

Pile #2—"Three below you"—Ace of Cups, 7 of Wands, 10 of Cups

Pile #3—"Three behind you"—The Moon, 6 of Coins, The Reaper

Pile #4—"Three before you"—The Magician, 10 of Wands, Ace of Wands

Pile #5—"Three for your house and home"—Knight of Coins, 5 of Wands, 8 of Wands

Pile #6—"Three for your hopes and fears"—3 of Swords reversed, Page of Wands, 8 of Swords

Pile #7—"Three for what you *do* expect"—6 of Cups, King of Wands, 7 of Cups

Pile #8—“Three for what you *do not* expect”—2 of Wands, The Angel of Time, The Hanged Man

Pile #9—“And three for what is sure to come”—The Devil, Justice, Strength

SK: The spread we are going to do next, Robin, is called the Wheel of Fortune. I think that it is an appropriate spread to do at this time as I always think of the Wheel of Fortune as a traveling card. Now, we are going to use a significator card. Is there any particular one you would like to use?

R: Yes, I think, The Empress.

SK: An excellent choice! Like you, she is a radiant and highly creative woman. And like you, she appears to be pregnant.

R: Well, having a child is a creative act.

SK: Agreed—and one that is second to none! Now if you will cut and shuffle I will do the rest.

R: Okay.

SK: You will notice that there are three cards at each of the rim points of the wheel. We are going to start with the “Three above you” pile, which has to do with covering influences in the life at the present time. In your case, the card of The High Priestess in this position strikes me as being similar to the card of Justice as this woman is between two poles—career and marriage—and it is not easy to find the proper balance.

R: But she is working at it.

SK: And succeeding to a large extent. For the Five of Cups—the card that started the last spread—reappears, and we know that it means emotional fulfillment. But before it was in the past next to the Ace of Wands, having to do with fulfillment in a professional career. Now, however, it flanks the Three of Wands, which has to do with marriage—and a marriage of true minds.

The “Three below you” pile represents current influences in the life. Hello, here is the Ace of Cups again, which came up in the Past in the last spread and was seen to be “the beginning of something new and beautiful,” namely your marriage. But the Seven of Wands, which also came up in the last spread has to do with career change—and in your case, moving—

makes for a somewhat emotionally trying period and so the Ten of Cups appears and Robin, I think you need to try and relax more and just live one day at a time.

R: It's just that there are so many things that have to be done before we leave; I mean it is an awesome task.

SK: I know exactly what you mean. The last time I moved, I said, "Never again!" This "Three behind you" pile has to do with the Past, and I see you have had a problem or two there as indicated by The Moon. Did you have a marriage that did not work out?

R: No, but I was engaged to someone for three years and it was very much an up-and-down affair.

SK: But the Death card indicates that you finally did end it, which is all to the good for in the Tarot, The Moon is always bad news. The death of that relationship allowed for the birth of a new and happier one culminating in marriage, which is indicated by the Six of Coins.

Now, we turn over the "Three before you" pile, which has to do with the immediate future. We see that the Ace of Wands and the Ten of Wands—both of which came up in the last spread—are back again, only this time in relation to the future. I associate the Ace of Wands with someone who builds on a firm foundation. The Ten of Wands, which comes up for you just about every time we do a reading, is associated with someone capable of professional success. With that card anywhere in a spread, there really are no worries career-wise; it is simply a matter of capitalizing on one's resources, particularly when the Ten of Wands is flanked by the Ace of Wands on one side and The Magician on the other. The Magician is associated with versatility and successful accomplishment.

R: Well, that is certainly nice to hear.

SK: Now, this pile is "Three for your house and home." There is the Knight of Coins again, the fellow who was the center of the Past in the last spread. We saw him as someone riding off to carve out a career and there is no question but that you will continue to do that. What is rather nice is that he is adjacent to the Five of Wands, which is fulfillment in what one does creatively. Because it is where you always work, it is logical that these cards should appear in the "House and Home" pile.

R: But, Sandor, doesn't that Eight of Wands kind of throw a monkey wrench into things? Every time you do a reading for me, eights come up all over the place. And you have said that eight is the number of imbalance, no?

SK: Well Robin, you are getting to be something of an expert on that particular number. Maintaining that not-so-delicate balance is going to be very much in the fore during the coming year in view of the fact that you are moving and expecting a child. "Eight" cards have to be read in terms of context. So the fact that the Eight of Wands is next to the Five of Wands, which is fulfillment in career, indicates that you are going to continue to create and get much satisfaction; it is just not going to be easy. Raising a baby is a full time job and so what you will be doing in effect will be holding down two full time jobs at once.

R: I guess it might be prudent if I put the fabrics on the shelf for a while and concentrate on the baby.

SK: I certainly would not argue with you there. In fact, looking at this next pile, "Three for your hopes and fears," I would say that if you were to attempt business as usual you would really run into problems. Because here is another eight—this time, the Eight of Swords—which indicates an imbalance in one's affairs and the Three of Swords reversed, which has to do with domestic strife.

R: That doesn't look good at all.

SK: True enough. But keep in mind, Robin, that a Tarot reading is not fortune telling in the usual sense of the word. You remember Dickens's *Christmas Carol*, don't you?

R: At this time of the year it is pretty hard to avoid it.

SK: Well, when the Ghost of Christmas Future shows Ebenezer Scrooge the sad fate of Tiny Tim, Scrooge asks if this is what *will* be or *might* be and the ghost tells him that this is what will be *if* nothing is done to change the picture. And then Scrooge works to change things and change things he does. Tarot reading is a kind of Christmas Future experience: This will be the picture unless *you* work to change it.

R: It is good to know that we do have the power to change the future by altering our attitude and behavior.

SK: Exactly! The center of this pile is the Page of Wands, indicating the child. Surrounding the Page are two Sword cards. But if you make the child the center of your home and your heart, you will turn those swords into ploughshares.

R: You put that very well.

SK: Well, the Tarot can have a Biblical orientation. All right, now we come to the “Three for what you *do* expect” pile. Here we have the Six and Seven of Cups and the King of Wands. That seems fairly explicit. Six is the number of decision involving the domestic scene and that would be both the baby and the move, and seven is the number of change, which of course is the result of the decision. And the King of Wands, as we know, is your other half, and in your spread it is only natural that he would be in the center of any important decision and change involving the home.

R: It is amazing how the key cards have a way of coming up in the center.

SK: Yes, the Tarot does have a knack for placing the emphasis where it belongs. Now we come to the “surprise pile”—“Three for what you *do not* expect.” In your case, it is not exactly a total surprise for the Two of Wands has to do with conflict regarding career and that of course would be motherhood vs. fabric designing. The Hanged Man is telling you that things are going to be upside down for a while but if you are patient, the result will be The Angel of Time. And as you can see, this woman—who incidentally looks very much like you—has two separate things and she is not only managing, she is joining them together and creating a new unity in her life.

R: What does that card actually mean in a reading?

SK: It is quite positive. Literally, the card means somebody who has made a major change in the life and learned to accept it and has also grown both inwardly and outwardly.

We are now ready for the final pile in the center—“Three for what is sure to come.” Here is our old friend Justice again and she is right smack in the center of your future just as she was in the last spread.

R: Ouuugh, what is that card on the left? I don’t like him at all!

SK: That is the card of The Devil: a most unpopular card. We have noted before that as a Libra the particular cross you have to bear in this life

is in the shape of scales and learning how to find the correct balance. Now, you will notice that on the other side of Justice is the card of Strength. This woman is subduing a lion and she is able to do it because she has found the proper balance and developed inner strength. Anyone who can tame a lion certainly has the strength also to tell The Devil to go back where he came from.

And you can do that, Robin, for the card of Strength is on the *right* side of Justice and if you draw upon your own inner strength you will have Justice on *your* side.

Eastern Cross

Card #11—Past: Queen of Swords

Card #10—Consultant: 5 of Cups

Card #9—Immediate Future: Knight of Swords

Card #12—Outcome: 4 of Coins

SK: Now, Robin, do you have a question that has not come up yet that can be answered fairly simply—a yes-or-no question?

R: Yes, as a matter of fact I do.

SK: Okay, let's do the Eastern Cross; that is a most concise spread. The first card has to do with the past and it is the Queen of Swords. Let's see, she was in the line of the present in the first spread we did and we decided that she was the woman with whom you deal who is an important contact for you in your business ventures.

R: That's right.

SK: So the question then has to do with her in some way?

R: Yes, we talked on the phone the other day and I am going to see her Monday about a proposal that she has in mind.

SK: This card represents the attitude of the consultant and it is the Five of Cups. Remember that one?

R: Wasn't that the first card that came up when we started the reading?

SK: That's right. And I tend to look at first cards in a reading as having some special significance. The Five of Cups denotes emotional fulfillment and the fact that it was next to the Ace of Wands indicates that the Number One thing in your life has been the satisfaction you derive from what you do creatively. That has been true in the past and it is still true to some extent.

R: For quite a while, it was the only thing in my life that gave me fulfillment.

SK: Life cannot be changed overnight. The card of the Immediate Future is the Knight of Swords. This does not look very encouraging for the proposed. One way or another, I do not think you are going to be happy with it.

R: From just the few things she said on the phone, I had that feeling.

SK: In the first spread we did, the culminating card of the line of the Future was The Emperor and that means material attainment in the not-too-distant future. And the card for the Outcome of this spread is the Four of Coins, which is saying the same thing. It is not going to happen the moment you move, but in a few months it will come your way. It is unlikely that it will be connected with the woman in question.

R: Well, the important thing is that it is going to happen.

SK: Oh, it is going to happen all right; with the Four of Coins there I don't see how you could miss.

Light of a Star

First Station—Foundation of the question or problem: 10 of Wands

Second Station—The present as influenced by the past: The Wheel of Fortune

Third Station—Immediate Future: 9 of Coins

Fourth Station—Type of action or lack of action that the consultant must bring about for a harmonious result: Justice

Fifth Station—Others involved whose help may prove beneficial: King of Wands

Sixth Station—Opposing forces: The Devil

Seventh Station—Outcome as indicated by attitude and actions of consultant: Queen of Cups reversed

SK: Okay, Robin, let's close the reading with a spread called Light of a Star.

R: How poetic!

SK: Actually, it is quite descriptive as it really does shed light. It will sum up other things that have appeared in the reading but put them in a somewhat different light.

R: I'm ready.

SK: I throw this spread by imagining a six-pointed star and then place a card at each point of light and the last one in the center. The card at the First Station is considered to be the foundation of the question or problem. The card is the Ten of Wands and that, as you know, represents potential for rising to the top in whatever you do.

R: That card does seem to be following me.

SK: It may just be that the Tarot is trying to tell you something. Now the Second Station represents the present and it is The Wheel of Fortune. It looks like things are really starting to go your way.

R: Let's hope so.

SK: Also, I usually see this as a traveling card—after all it is a wheel—but the Tarot is telling you that all your systems are really Go.

R: Nice to hear.

SK: The Third Station is the Immediate Future and that is the Nine of Coins. That of course is a money card but it is money going out.

R: We know we are going to have to make some sacrifices.

SK: The Fourth Station is a most important one for it is going to indicate what it is that you will need to do in order to bring about harmony. This is a card you know very well indeed—Justice!

R: That means I must clean up my act, right?

SK: Right! But you won't have to struggle alone for the card I have just turned over, the King of Wands, indicates another whose help will

prove beneficial. I think this year is going to be something of a challenge for you but at least it is comforting to know that you have a means of moral support—your husband—who is going to be there when you need him.

R: I am most thankful for that.

SK: We are going to look at the next card with special care for that represents opposing forces. Do you recognize this fellow?

R: Oh dear, that is The Devil again!

SK: One positive thing about this is that there has to be some kind of opposing force. And what the Tarot is telling you is that it is not an outside force but rather, the enemy within. You can say with Pogo, “We have seen the enemy and it is me!”

When The Devil comes up on that opposing forces station, that final card in the center of the star usually has some kind of problem connected with it. Yes, the tale is running true to form for the card is the Queen of Cups, usually a positive card; unfortunately, in this reading she is upside down.

The question is how to get this woman right side up. If we think of the King of Wands as your husband and the reversed Queen of Cups as you, we can see that they were very close to each other when we threw this spread. The only thing that came between them was The Devil. And The Devil is fear and fear alone.

R: I guess I have some work to do on myself.

SK: When The Devil came up before in that Wheel of Fortune spread, there were two other cards next to it. Do you remember what they were?

R: Oh, let's see. One was the card of the balance.

SK: Justice, right. The other was the card of Strength, the woman subduing the lion. Now, Robin, I would like you to do something for me.

R: What's that?

SK: I would like you to imagine, no, I want you *to be* the woman of Strength and then do something for yourself.

R: Which is?

SK: The Devil is fear, right? The way to get rid of fear is by confronting it directly. So, Robin, I would like you to take that card of The Devil and turn it around.

R: You mean, turn the card face down?

SK: That is precisely what I mean. (Robin turns over the card.) Can you still see him?

R: No, he has disappeared.

SK: You literally put him where he belongs. To make sure that he stays put, all you have to remember, Robin, is that you can always call on your own inner reserves to banish fear. Since The Devil was the only thing that came between you and the King of Wands, by casting him out, you will find something mysterious and wonderful is going to happen: the Queen of Cups, who was upside down, is going to be right side up and in perfect balance with herself and the world—and it will be in no small measure due to her own inner strength.

Patrick's Beading

The Horseshoe Spread (see [page 78](#))

Celtic Cross (see [page 81](#))

The Churchyard Spread (see [page 94](#))

The Gypsy Spread (see [page 86](#))

The consultant is a young Frenchman, who after living abroad for several years, at the time of the reading was planning to return to his homeland with his wife to start a new career.

The Horseshoe Spread

Card #1—Past: 9 of Coins

Card #2—Present: 10 of Swords

Card #3—Immediate Future: 9 of Wands

Card #4—Card of the Consultant: 6 of Swords

Card #5—Attitude of Another: Strength

Card #6—Obstacle: Queen of Coins

Card #7—Outcome: Ace of Coins

SK: Patrick, I'm going to start with this card, which is known as the card of the Consultant because it will give us some idea as to how you feel about the undertaking you have planned. It is the Six of Swords, which is a warning card. What it is warning you about is worry.

P: We are wondering if we are doing the right thing.

SK: That is why I am here, to see what the Tarot says about it. We will now look at the card of the Past, which is the Nine of Coins. I would say that it is the fairly recent past for that card means money going out and I imagine you have had any number of expenses in getting ready for your return to France.

I can see that this is not a particularly easy period for you. In addition to that Nine of Coins in the past, you have the Ten of Swords in the present. But this is to be expected for it is basically sadness at leaving friends behind—people you have grown to know and love.

P: It is also that we do not know whether we will ever see them again.

SK: Yes, I know just how you feel.

The card of the Immediate Future indicates that you should proceed with your plans. It is the Nine of Wands, which has to do with new friends and a new place.

This next card indicates how someone close to you feels about this change—perhaps your wife. The card of Strength in this position suggests this is difficult for her. The woman on the card is struggling with a lion but I think she can handle it; in fact, I *know* she can.

P: She does not speak French so she is concerned that she will have to begin at the beginning in learning the language.

SK: That would give one pause but it need not be a major thing. This card represents an obstacle and it is the Queen of Coins. The Queen of Coins often runs her own business so I think the obstacle—at least, as far as your wife is concerned—is having to abandon her business. But she can probably set herself up in France, don't you think?

P: That is what she hopes to do eventually and I have friends over there who may be able to help.

SK: It looks like it is going to work out, Patrick, as the outcome card is the Ace of Coins! Aces are very potent cards for they depict important beginnings in the life and the Ace of Coins has to do with money and career. This really tells us what we wanted to know as the card of the Immediate Future said you were going to a new environment but this card is the bottom line for it says that you are eventually going to be able to set yourself up in a new career.

Celtic Cross

Significator: The Sun

Card #1—"This covers you": 8 of Swords

Card #2—"This crosses you": 5 of Swords

Card #3—"This is above you": The Reaper

Card #4—"This is beneath you": 3 of Coins

Card #5—"This is behind you": 3 of Swords

Card #6—"This is before you": 9 of Coins

Card #7—"This *is* you": Page of Cups

Card #8—"This is for your house and home": Day of Judgment

Card #9—"This is for your hopes and fears": 7 of Cups

Card #10—"And this is what you can most definitely expect": 5 of Wands

SK: You have chosen The Sun as a significator so we will place that over here on the table. I must say that it is truly appropriate as the sun is the ruler of Leo, which is your sign. It is also a beautiful card to identify with as it shows a boy and a girl who are playing together in what could be the Garden of Eden. We place the first card on top of the significator and say, "This covers you," for it represents the covering influence in the life at the moment. It is the Eight of Swords, which is an indication that things are a bit on the frenzied side at the moment.

P: As you know, Sandor, we are both rather nervous about going to France. At this point we have nothing solid at all to count on; we are just going over there and hoping that something will materialize.

SK: Well, I admire your bravado. The closing card of the first spread was the Ace of Coins and that is a pretty clear signal that you will find what you are looking for. With this card we say, "This crosses you," as it has to do with an obstacle. It is the Five of Swords which indicates help from sources that are not immediately apparent. Once you arrive in France, you may not have immediate results but there will be no real obstacle.

P: That I am happy to hear!

SK: "This is above you," tells what can be attained. This card usually means a major change in the life. One name for it is The Reaper and in this case I read it to mean that you will reap what you have sown. We will get a clearer picture of that when we come to the final card, which is the card of culmination.

"This is beneath you," is really the card that suggests the foundation of the issue. It is the Three of Coins so it appears that you are building on a firm foundation. I know that you are considering the restaurant business and I would say that you have had some pretty good training for that.

P: Yes, Sandor, I have gone to cooking school in France and have worked under some very fine people.

SK: "This is behind you," has to do with the past. The Three of Swords is a card of separation and I think it is going back to that time when you separated yourself from your homeland.

"This is before you," has to do with the immediate future and it is the Nine of Coins, which came up in the last spread and is concerned with expenditures. Perhaps not only monetary currency but emotional currency as well. What do you think, Patrick?

P: You know it is not easy to leave a place you have become friendly with.

SK: That is so true. Now this is an important card for we say, "This *is* you," and in some ways it is more you than any other card in this spread. It is the Page of Cups. The Page of Cups is a most loving warm-hearted young person and I would say it is a rather apt description of your wife. It is not a bad description of you either.

"This is your house and home," and here we find the Day of Judgment. This card has to do with a major decision in the life and in your case it has

to do with the house and home. The man and woman on the card are husband and wife and they have done what they have talked about doing and they are absolutely jubilant.

P: Who is the third person on the card with his back to us?

SK: Well, Patrick, I don't know how to break this to you but that is the newest member of your family—so new that he hasn't arrived yet. But it won't be long. And, ah, don't be too sure that it's a "he."

"This is for your hopes and fears," is the Seven of Cups, which has to do with a change in the residence or a change in the family. In your case, both are very soon going to be true, and in this hopes-and-fears slot, you should not have any real worries about either.

Okay, now we come to the card of culmination, and so, "This is what you may definitely expect," and it is the Five of Wands.

P: Didn't you say, Sandor, that Wands have to do with job and career?

SK: Yes, Patrick, and in some ways this card is similar to the one that ended the last spread. Do you remember what card that was?

P: Wasn't that the Ace of Coins?

SK: Yes, indeed!

P: And you told me it had to do with starting a new career.

SK: And so it does. But this card goes a step further. For while the Ace of Coins has you starting a new and powerful career, with the Five of Wands you find fulfillment in that career!

The Churchyard Spread

Card #1—The Lovers
Card #2—10 of Coins
Card #3—Queen of Swords
Card #4—5 of Cups
Card #5—Queen of Coins
Card #6—The Fool
Card #7—2 of Cups
Card #8—9 of Coins
Card #9—King of Coins
Card #10—6 of Swords
Card #11—4 of Swords
Card #12—The Chariot
Card #13—9 of Cups

SK: Now, Patrick, what I would like you to do at this time is to concentrate on the most important question in your mind at the moment and I will throw a spread that may help to give us some fairly specific information on it.

P: Good! That is what I would like to know.

SK: First, I am going to take The Fool out of the pack as we are using him for a significator. Then after you have cut and shuffled, I am going to take the twelve cards off the top, insert The Fool and ask you to shuffle just those thirteen cards.

All right, now that the spread is down, I am going to turn all the cards over and look for The Fool. Much depends on where he appears in this spread: If he is at the beginning, there are going to be some real problems. If he is at the end, things should work out fairly well in regard to your question. If he is in the middle, there are going to be some obstacles but the cards following The Fool should give us some insight as to what they are and also tell us how things will work out eventually.

P: It looks like he is in the middle.

SK: Yes, I would say so. Your question has to do with the career you will be following in France?

P: Yes, that is the question I had. How did the cards tell you that?

SK: To be frank, I just assumed that was your question; I could not think of any other question that would be more on your mind at this moment. But it does appear in the cards. You will notice that the King and Queen of Coins are both in this spread?

P: Yes, I see that.

SK: You may remember that the Queen of Coins came up in the first spread we did. But it came up as an obstacle. We decided that since the Queen of Coins is usually a person who runs her own business, that it was your wife. But the card came up as an obstacle because she would have to give up her profession at least temporarily until you both get settled in France and until after the baby arrives. Your wife comes up again in this spread and again as the Queen of Coins. On one side of her is the Five of Cups so we see that giving up being the Queen of Coins will not be easy for her as she gets emotional fulfillment from her profession.

The first card after The Fool is the Two of Cups—the “Heart’s Desire” card. So it looks like France is going to agree with both of you.

P: But there is that Nine of Coins again and when that came up in another spread didn’t you say that it had something to do with financial difficulties?

SK: My friend, that has come up in *every* spread so far this evening so be prepared for a few lean days. But the point is that you do something about it for the card is followed by the King of Coins, which is you. I say that because the King of Coins is the husband of the Queen of Coins and so the indication here is that you are going to be the sole breadwinner in the family for a time. But I don’t think that what you start with in France is what you are going to stay with. I know you have only tentative plans, Patrick, but what are they?

P: We plan to go first to the home of my parents in Paris and stay there for a while. While there I thought I would try to get back into the restaurant business as either a chef or a partner. But something else we have been talking about is buying a villa in the south of France and then turning it into a rather fancy bed and breakfast place.

SK: Okay, I think we are getting a fairly specific answer. The King of Coins comes up shortly after The Fool’s arrival in Paris so we can read him

as doing something in Paris—possibly a restaurateur, or a chef at one of the better places. Whatever it is, it is not working out as the King of Coins is surrounded by financial problems and worries. That is indicated by the Nine of Coins and the Six of Swords. It is further reinforced by the Four of Swords, which also suggests some problems living at the home of your parents.

With the closing cards of this spread we see an entirely different trend as depicted by The Chariot, which is victory, and the Nine of Cups, which is known as the “Wish Card.” The Chariot is a card of movement. Your wish is granted but only *after* you climb into your chariot and drive to another destination. That is where you will find the victory!

The Gypsy Spread

21—Strength		Significator	22—Wheel of Fortune	
G	Y	P	S	Y
1-6 of Swords	2-9 of Coins	3-The World	4-Ace of Coins	5-4 of Cups
6-5 of Swords	7-Page of Swords	8-The Lovers	9-9 of Cups	10-The Fool
11-King of Coins	12-8 of Wands	13-The Empress	14-2 of Swords	15-The Chariot
16-The Reaper	17-Queen of Coins	18-Page of Wands	19-The Hermit	20-9 of Wands

SK: The last spread we did, Patrick, gave us a fairly clear answer to your question. The final spread we are doing, which incidentally is called The Gypsy Spread, should bring everything into sharper focus and sum things up.

Each of these five vertical piles represents a letter in the word “gypsy.” We will begin with “G,” which stands for “Gateway” and has to do with questions you are contemplating.

The first card, the Six of Swords, is a warning card and it came up in the very first spread we did. But now we get more information. The Death card tells us that there is some anxiety on your part but specifically, it has to do with the major change of pulling up stakes in New York and returning to France. And the King of Coins tells us that you are concerned with just how you are going to set yourself up in business and bring in those coins once you hit France. But the card that gives us the answer is the Five of Swords because that tells us that while you may not immediately be able to control

events, things will be working under the surface in your favor. It is going to take a little time before you experience your success.

P: I think, Sandor, that is well indeed as it has been some years that I have spent any time at home and so while we are living under the roof of my parents there will be time to think and talk and look around.

SK: There are two “Ys” in “gypsy.” The first “Y” has to do with “yin,” the second with “yang.” As I’m sure you know, yin and yang are the dark and light components of the T’ai Chi symbol, which represents the Law of Opposites. The yin represents the dark, passive principle and the yang, the bright, active principle.

P: So these cards will tell me what I should *not* be doing?

SK: Yes. At least, not right away. The first card is the Nine of Coins. No spread for you, Patrick, would be complete without it, but since it falls in the yin row, the Tarot is telling you not to worry about money. There is a time for it to come in and a time for it to go out and this is the going out time.

P: The going out time is nothing new for me. The coming in time will be.

SK: The Eight of Wands is saying much the same thing, and the Queen of Coins is telling your wife to put her paint brushes away for the moment, and be tranquil and have her baby.

P: And, Sandor, the Page of Swords is the baby, no?

SK: Yes and no. I think it is more *your* baby than *the* baby. That is to say, what one does creatively is one’s brain child. It could be a book. It could be a painting. It could be a bed and breakfast place. But you need to think it through before you bring it into the world.

P: Suppose that card had been in the yang pile. What would it have meant then?

SK: Just the opposite. Yang is action and had the Page of Swords come up there, the Tarot would have been saying, “This Mediterranean inn is your baby but if you want it to materialize, you are going to have to do something about it *toute suite*.”

P: But as long as it is yin, I just think about it.

SK: It does not have to stop there. You can write letters, make phone calls, look around, see people, talk it over, and get it all worked out on paper.

P: I see.

SK: The “P” row stands for “Partnership” and with The World, The Lovers, The Empress, and the Page of Wands, I would say that you have made a rather good marriage.

P: That I am happy to hear!

SK: If the truth be told, Patrick, I don’t really think you needed either me or the Tarot to tell you that. But there are times when the Tarot gets up and dances a jig and it is doing that now. The card of The World is happiness personified and that happiness is with The Empress, a scintillating, charming, and creative person. And what she is creating right now will be manifesting in a few months—and that is the Page of Wands, a child who will really speak your language. And let’s not forget the card of The Lovers. If any card says it, that one does. By the by, that card came up as the foundation card of the last spread. And since it was next to the Ten of Coins, which is often referred to as the Wall Street Card, this is a very solid marriage indeed!

P: I am glad I did something right!

SK: The “S” pile has to do with the Self and indicates your state of mind. I think, Patrick, you are doing more things right than you realize but maybe you don’t always accept this.

P: Why do you say that?

SK: Because you have your own little built-in yin and yang. With the Ace of Coins and the Nine of Cups you are saying, “I can do and be pretty much what I want to do and be.” With the Two of Swords and The Hermit, you are saying, “I’m only kidding myself.” It is like the duet in which one singer says, “Yes, I can!” and the other says, “No, you can’t!”

Look Patrick, you can’t fool me. I’ve done your astro-numeric chart and I meant what I said when I told you it was a chart of great beauty and power. When you listen to that negative defeatist side of you, you are

listening to a lie. So it is the Ace of Coins and the Nine of Cups you should be listening to for they are telling you to go out and conquer, which is the rightful occupation of all true Leos.

P: Sandor, I am not sure I know what to say to that.

SK: You don't have to say anything, Patrick. Just let out a roar which will serve notice on the world that you have recognized your kingship and are ready for a long and happy reign.

In other words, just simply do and be and what form it will take will be suggested by the yang pile. I would say this is fairly explicit, Patrick. Let's start with The Fool.

P: Is that me?

SK: Yes, it is. But because he is near the end of the spread, he is The Magus, or wise fool. He is starting on a journey but he follows the Four of Cups, which is the birth of a child. So the Tarot is telling you to stay at your parents' home until your wife has her baby and then set out for another place.

P: And it will work out?

SK: With The Chariot and the Nine of Wands it would be hard to miss. The Chariot is victory and the Nine of Wands is a new environment. But as was said before, the victory comes after you climb into your personal chariot and drive yourself to that new place in the south of France or wherever.

P: Well, that is very nice and I do thank you, Sandor.

SK: Have faith, Patrick. The Tarot has a way of topping itself. First, we will read the card on the left of the significator, which has to do with your expectations. That is really the Consultant card. And in any spread, I always consider the Consultant card a most important one for it represents the thoughts, feelings, and attitude of the consultant. And if that card is positive, almost invariably, the card of culmination will be positive.

P: I think I follow you.

SK: I know you do. Before something can manifest in outer space, it has to manifest in inner space. If a person is negative inside it is unlikely

anything positive is going to happen outside. But if you set yourself a realistic goal you *know* you can attain, you will eventually attain that goal.

P: That makes very good sense, Sandor.

SK: Okay, I am going to turn over the card regarding your expectations. It is the card of Strength. And in your case, Patrick, it is rather an ambivalent card.

P: Why do you say that?

SK: As you can see, the card depicts a woman closing the jaws of a lion. She can do this in a relaxed and poised manner because she has the inner strength, which in turn gives her the outer strength to do what she needs to do.

But you see, this card is associated with the sign of Leo, which is where you live. So the question is, do you identify with the woman or the lion? If with the woman, fine and dandy. But if with the lion, then there may be problems. Because as he is depicted on this card, the lion is a loser. As you can see, he is rather moth-eaten and he has a memory problem. He has forgotten that he was born into the royal sign of Leo, king of the beasts. Once he realizes that the name of this card—Strength—applies to him as well as the woman, then he will let out a royal roar and do what he was born to do and that is, be king.

P: I will certainly work on that, Sandor.

SK: I am convinced that you will, Patrick, for the card of attainment is just that—The Wheel of Fortune—one of the most positive cards in the Tarot for it means literally a turn for the better in one's fortunes and it is usually accompanied by the undertaking of a journey or a new start in life!

NOTE: At the time of their consultation, Robin and Patrick were newlyweds.

Harriet's Life Reading

The Twelve Houses (see [page 107](#))

Past Lives (see [page 115](#))

Opening the Key (see [page 92](#))

NOTE: For this reading the Morgan-Greer pack was used and the interpretation was based on the figures and scenes as depicted by that deck.

At the time of the reading the consultant was in her late twenties and living with her young daughter.

The Twelve Houses

Card #1—The Empress
Card #2—Knight of Cups
Card #3—8 of Wands
Card #4—Queen of Cups
Card #5—Page of Wands
Card #6—Knight of Wands
Card #7—8 of Swords
Card #8—Strength
Card #9—The Chariot
Card #10—9 of Cups
Card #11—6 of Swords
Card #12—2 of Coins
Indicator card—Ace of Coins

SK: For your Life Reading, Harriet, we are going to start off with The Twelve Houses, which is similar to The Horoscope Spread.

H: Isn't that one you did for me the other day?

SK: Yes, but with this difference: The one we did last time was solely concerned with the year coming up. This one is similar to a natal chart in that it takes in the whole life.

H: I see.

SK: The twelve houses remain the same but the card in each House is a prime indicator for the life rather than an event for a particular year. When I did your astro-numeric chart, do you remember the Tarot card that I felt was suggested by the chart?

H: Oh yes, it was The Empress.

SK: It appears that the Tarot concurs for in the First House of Personality is the card of The Empress.

H: That's incredible!

SK: Yes and no. Horoscopes, astro-numeric charts and Tarot cards all seem to work for the same employer, so it is only natural that The Empress should appear as the significator card of your life. She is a most beguiling and creative woman and I always think of her as the exemplification of the workings of heaven in the things of earth.

H: I can certainly identify with her in several ways—particularly by the fact that she is in the outdoors. I've always had a special feeling about flowers and the sea and just nature in general.

SK: In your Second House of Material Resources is the Knight of Cups.

H: Is that my knight in shining armour?

SK: It could be but I suspect that knight is you as you have had to fight for what you have. But this particular knight is a very generous and loving person and that goblet she is carrying is a cup of warmth for her little daughter.

H: Yes, my daughter is a very important part of my life.

SK: The Eight of Wands appears in your Third House of Communications. There is your little home out on the hill but wands have to do with work and so many wands suggest that there is a lot of work that goes on in that house just to keep body and soul together.

H: I don't know if I told you but when the place that I work closes down for the winter, I go back to being a weaver and that I do in my home.

SK: Now that I think of it, the way those wands are placed, they kind of resemble a loom. In the Fourth House of the Home is the Queen of Cups. She is all heart and exactly where she should be—in the House of the Home. And she is of course, her majesty, Queen Harriet.

In the Fifth House of Creativity is the Page of Wands. The young woman on the card is embracing her work—it is the very stuff of life for her. This is also the House of Children and so the Page of Wands is not only you; it is also your daughter.

H: Yes, both would be equally true.

SK: Now we are looking at the Sixth House of Health, Work and Service. I think I will change the name of this spread to “Pictures of Harriet” for there you are again as another knight. I take it you have done a fair share of traveling, for knights are people usually on the move.

H: Oh yes, I have lived and worked all over this country and abroad.

SK: But the knights that have come up for you—the Knight of Cups and the Knight of Wands—are more concerned with the needs and desires of others than they are with their own selfish interests. And the Knight of Wands—the “Good Samaritan” knight—appears in your House of Health, Work and Service. So that makes me feel that you derive a certain amount of pleasure by doing work that is somehow a service to other people.

H: Well, I can’t argue that I do things for the money as I don’t have very much to show for it.

SK: In the Seventh House of Partners is the Eight of Swords.

H: I don’t like the looks of that card at all!

SK: That woman is blindfolded and bound; she does not look too comfortable. As you separated from your husband not too long ago, this may be indicative of your present situation.

The important thing is that she gets that blindfold lowered so she can see what she is about. It looks like she will for in the Eighth House of Regeneration is the card of Strength. This woman has much to contend with as evidenced by the lion trying to attack her. But she is able to handle him and a dozen more just like him if she has to for she has the strength. But it is basically an inner strength and that is truly the secret of her survival. Harriet, that is also your secret and the regenerating influence of your life.

H: It’s either be strong or go crazy.

SK: I think the card in your Ninth House of Philosophy is the key to the spread and your life as it is The Chariot. In one way it suggests your Gemini sun, which is symbolized by the twins who each want to go their own way. On this card, there is a black horse and a white horse pulling the chariot but they are spirited creatures and will go galloping off in different

directions if they are not controlled. However, the driver of the Chariot seems to be in control.

H: Sometimes though, I think maybe he is taken for a ride.

SK: But, Harriet, just look at his expression; he is enjoying every minute of it.

H: I guess you are right.

SK: In divination this is always a positive card for the meaning is “Victory.” And the fact that the card is here in your House of Philosophy is really significant for it means that you have basically a positive outlook and know that you are going to get where you want to go.

H: On the whole, I do feel fairly positive about myself.

SK: The Ninth House is also the House of Long Journeys and the card of The Chariot is another indication that you love to travel and that your trips work out pretty well for you.

Now we come to the midheaven of your “chart” and the Tenth House of Career. That card is the Nine of Cups. You know something, Harriet; I think I am going to let you interpret this card yourself.

H: That man does not exactly look like a knight but he does look like somebody I could talk to and somebody I would like to know. He looks like somebody who would enjoy talking philosophy, like to look at art and listen to music, and certainly he would take pleasure in making love and sitting down to a good meal. I like him but I don’t believe we’ve met.

SK: You will for he is in your House of Career. And since the Nine of Cups is known as the Wish Card, he will appear when you want him to appear.

H: I will certainly keep him in mind.

SK: The Six of Swords appears in your Eleventh House of Friends, Hopes and Wishes. There are two figures on this card and as their backs are to us, they could be men, or they could be women. They appear to be in a gondola, heading toward a town along the seacoast. I see the gondolier as you, and that other smaller figure, as your daughter. You are taking her to a seaside hideaway to make a new life. What the Tarot seems to be saying is

that this particular place by the sea has some quality about it that is just right for your social, psychic, and spiritual development.

H: There is a lot in what you say. Since I have been living here, I feel like a new person.

SK: I think all of us have a home. It may be a place we do not find until we cut the apron strings. Maybe some people do not discover it until they are old and gray. But the minute we set foot on that spot, we know we are “home.”

The next card, the Two of Coins, in the Twelfth House of Secret Enemies, suggests that it may not always be easy to make a living in one’s home. For this individual is standing by the sea and those two coins in front of him, along with that worried look on his face, suggest that he is having a tough time getting his checkbook to balance.

H: I just applied for another loan the other day. Getting through the winter here is something of a challenge.

SK: But this fellow on the card is standing with his back to the sea. So his eyes are not looking away from his home but right at it and he seems determined to find a way to become financially solvent. And he has a strong face. I am sure *she* will.

H: One way or another I have always managed to squeak by.

SK: And this last card, which is the indicator for the life, assures us that you will. For it is the Ace of Coins, which means that money is always there when you need it although there are probably a lot of job and career changes throughout the life. But the picture on the card says it, for there is your home by the sea and coming out of the clouds is the hand of Providence dropping pennies from heaven to provide for you.

Past Lives

Throne I—Ace of Cups

The Reaper, Justice, The High Priestess, The Wheel of Fortune, The Angel of Time

Throne II—Ace of Swords

The Lovers, The Hermit, The World, The Sun

Throne III—Ace of Coins

The Lightning-Struck Tower, The Hierophant, Strength, Day of Judgment

Throne IV—Ace of Wands

The Fool, The Devil, The Moon, The Star, The Empress, The Emperor, The Magician, The Hanged Man, The Chariot

SK: Now, Harriet, we are going to look at your life in a somewhat different way. We are going to examine three areas of your life—childhood and young adulthood, work and career, love and marriage—and trace major events in each. Then, if you like, we will take a peek at some of your past lives.

H: I can hardly wait for that!

SK: In your case, I think that should prove most interesting. We are starting, however, with Throne I, which has to do with the first thirty years or so of this present life. The Ace of Cups here suggests that you might have been something of a “party girl,” or perhaps liked to have a good time?

H: I am afraid I did start rather early and that habit pattern has been hard to break.

SK: Your childhood—or at least where the Tarot chooses to begin the tale—starts on a rather ominous note with the card of The Reaper. Was there a death in the family during your early childhood?

H: In a sense there was, for my parents divorced.

SK: Oh yes, I see it now and there must have been a prolonged custody battle in the courts for the next card is Justice.

H: Yes, there was. And “Mommy Dearest” won.

SK: I guess there is no need to ask you to elaborate on that statement as your mother comes up as The High Priestess, which says it all—a woman alone who is unhappy, moody, and critical.

H: That is her all right, and she has not changed.

SK: But then later she started going with someone else, did she?

H: Yes, for a while. That was when I was in my teens.

SK: On The Wheel of Fortune card there is a man and woman partying it up but there is a third figure who has slipped off the wheel. In fact, all you can see of this person are the legs so the indication is that you felt out of the picture at the time.

H: On the card, there is a hand turning the wheel. And it was around this time that I took up weaving as a way to maintain my sanity.

SK: It is interesting how the same card can tell several stories at once. With the final card of this throne, you are truly back in the picture as The Angel of Time, a woman who seems to have it very much together. And I think the reason for that is that she is standing by the edge of a body of water. So she is where you are. It is a nice ending for a somewhat difficult early life.

H: It did have its share of lumps.

SK: Okay, now we will look at Throne II, which deals with work and career. The Ace of Swords here indicates that there have been some problems and frustrations but the rest of the cards indicate that you find fulfillment in a career. In fact, two careers.

H: Two careers?

SK: Yes, this is a very easy throne to interpret. In sequence, the cards are The Lovers, The Hermit, The World, and The Sun. The Lovers, which is, of course, marriage, was the first career. As this is followed by The Hermit it is clear that the marriage did not work out. But The World card—which is where you are now, or at least, soon will be—depicts a woman who is dancing for joy because she likes what she does creatively. And since the final card in this throne is The Sun, it looks like marriage is definitely going to be a second career for you and this time around, love will be here to stay. And incidentally, The Sun and The World are the cards I call “the happiness twins” so to have those together in the same throne is quite positive.

H: I think right now I am in between The Hermit and The World stages.

SK: Well, that is better than being between the devil and the deep blue sea. And it is nice to know that the “good stuff” is ahead of you.

H: If I could only be sure that all the “bad stuff” is behind me.

SK: Well, the “bad stuff” never entirely disappears, but with the “happiness twins” there is plenty of sunshine coming your way, believe me, Harriet.

We now go to Throne III, which is love and marriage. The Ace of Coins here is very powerful so whatever your experiences may have been to date, things are going to work out for you eventually and very well indeed.

H: That is certainly good to hear.

SK: We can see that things do not start off very well for the first card in the sequence is The Lightning-Struck Tower with two people being hauled out of their home. That probably represents the recent past; I think you are still feeling the effects of having your marriage being “hit by lightning” as it were.

H: I would say, Sandor, that describes my feelings fairly well.

SK: The next card is important because it tells you where you go from here. It is The Hierophant.

H: He looks like a priest. Does that mean I have to become some kind of religious fanatic?

SK: Not necessarily. In ancient Egypt the hierophant was the revealer of sacred things. You can see there are two large keys on the bottom of the card and what is being suggested is that for you the key to wholeness is developing your spiritual nature. This may well be a karmic testing period and consciousness-raising may be what you need to do at this time of your life.

H: I am reading *The Snow Leopard* right now and I find this book is really hitting me where I live.

SK: I think you are very much on the right track, Harriet. It is reading works like that, along with meditation, that is going to raise your consciousness and that’s what it is all about for you at the present time. For you see, the cards show a real progression here: The Tower says you get hit by lightning; with The Hierophant you get “religion”; and the next card in

the sequence is Strength—a woman who is strong because she has developed the spiritual side of her nature. She is also known as The Enchantress and she is enchanting precisely because there is a spiritual mystique about her.

H: I think this part of the reading has indicated “Where I am coming from” more than anything else.

SK: Also, where you are going. For the final card in this throne is Day of Judgment and it could not be more explicit for it depicts a man, woman, and child, and they form a blessed trinity.

H: This reading is really picking me up!

SK: Okay, Harriet, now are you ready for a glimpse of some of your past incarnations?

H: By all means!

SK: I should point out that this part of the reading is purely intuitive. We turn all the cards in this throne over, look at them individually and then as a whole, and just see what impressions come to mind. What is interesting is that people who have tried to trace their past lives by hypnotic regression, meditation, dreams, going to psychics, or whatever, often feel that this spread confirms what they have already discovered about their past lives.

H: If a person was a historical figure, would this spread be able to show it?

SK: Possibly. One interesting thing about this spread is that you either get an overview of several different lives over the centuries, or the Tarot takes up one past life and goes into depth on that life alone. Do you have any particular feelings about who or what you were in another life?

H: Yes, I have very strong feelings about a life in czarist Russia around the turn of the century and during the years before the revolution.

SK: Okay, let's see what comes up. The Ace of Wands here suggests that you have had some real struggles in one or more of your past lives. The first card in the sequence is the card of The Fool. That indicates that you are an old soul.

H: Others have told me that.

SK: In this spread, when The Fool comes up as the first card of this Past Lives Throne, it is invariably significant for it is usually a sign of a pilgrim on The Path.

Now, let's turn all the cards in this throne over and see what we shall see. The Fool is followed by The Devil, The Moon, The Star, The Emperor, The Empress, The Magician, The Hanged Man, and The Chariot. Hmmm, I think I see this as one life. Do you feel that you might in some way have been associated with the rulers of Russia, Nicholas and Alexandra?

H: Ever since I can remember! I went to the Soviet Union one summer and when I arrived in St. Petersburg—which is now known as Leningrad—I had the most incredible feeling of *déjà vu*!

SK: Do you think you were Nicholas or Alexandra?

H: No, one of the daughters, I think. Maybe Tatania.

SK: Well, you may feel that you were one of the daughters of the czar but the life we are getting here is that of Rasputin.

H: You must be kidding!

SK: Well, see for yourself. The sequence starts with The Fool, which would be Rasputin traveling across Siberia as a *starets*, a kind of wandering holy man. The Devil and The Moon suggest the period when he was involved with the *khylsty* and satanic worship. But then comes The Star when he cleaned up his act, became profoundly religious, and discovered he was a psychic healer. Then his voices tell him he has a mission to save Russia so he journeys to St. Petersburg where he meets The Empress and The Emperor—Alexandra and Nicholas—and heals their son as The Magician. The Hanged Man tells us of his unhappy fate when he was murdered by the *boyars*, that is, the nobles who were jealous of his influence over the royal family.

H: They had quite a time killing him off, didn't they?

SK: He was poisoned, shot, and bludgeoned. But when his body was fished out of the river three days later, water was found in his lungs. So he actually died by drowning.

H: That is wild!

SK: Actually, I think it says more about the ineptness of his assassins than anything else. I mean he *did* die from a physical cause. And the tale ends with the card of The Chariot, which suggests a troika taking his body to the icy river.

H: It does seem to be all of a piece. But tell me, how does reincarnation work? I mean, is it possible to be a male in one life and then a female in the next?

SK: According to the Life Readings given by Edgar Cayce, there is no set pattern. Some people come back now in one sex, now in another, and others seem to lead a whole string of lives in the same sex. I guess that there are probably a number of things involved, including the kind of lesson you need to learn in a given life and probably sometimes it can be learned better as a woman, other times as a man.

But to get back to the spread, you may indeed have been Tatania, or one of the other daughters—or even the son—of Nicholas and Alexandra, but in order to reveal this to you, the Tarot may have found it easier to describe the life of a man who played an important role in yours and one with a number of dramatic highlights that could be pictured. What is particularly interesting is that in The Twelve Houses spread that we did for this life, The Empress came up in the First House of Personality as a covering influence for the life. It is just possible that we somehow slipped into a past life without realizing it. There are ways of finding out. It depends upon how deeply you want to go.

H: I would really like to find out more about that last life. Is there some spread we can throw that will do that?

SK: There is a spread that was supposedly favored by that incredible magician, Aleister Crowley. If any Tarot spread can give you the answer you seek about your past life, this one can. It is called Opening the Key (see [page 92](#)).

Opening the Key

SK: This should be interesting, Harriet, because if any spread can pin down that last life of yours in Russia this one should be able to do it, but we

should also keep in mind that some things cannot be pinned down so easily. We will use The Chariot as the main significator as that was the final card in the Past Lives spread. We are going to leave it in the pack, however, so go ahead and cut and shuffle the way you usually do.

All right, now that you have done that I would like you to cut the pack once to your left. Now cut each of those piles once to your left. Although I said that The Chariot would be our main significator card, I also imagined two other significator cards for your last life—the Page of Cups for Tatania and The Magician for “Father Gregory,” that is, Rasputin. If the Page of Cups appears in the pile with The Chariot the indication is that you were Tatania; while The Magician in the same pile would suggest Rasputin. If either of these combinations occurs we can then do follow-up spreads and really check it out. We find The Chariot in this second pile.

H: I am on pins and needles, Sandor. Tell me, which is it? Who was I?

SK: Guess what? Neither.

H: Neither?

SK: Neither! The failure of a pre-determined combination to appear in the Tarot does not necessarily mean that you were not one of those people. The Tarot is not saying that—or, at least, we do not know it is saying that. What it is saying is that for the moment it does not choose to reveal that information but rather considers other facts more important for you to know and dwell upon. You see, Harriet, the Tarot does not always tell us what we want to hear, but rather, what is best for us to know for the development of our soul.

H: And what is that?

SK: First, I have to fan these cards out and see which cards in the pile with The Chariot are actually to be read according to the numbering system of the spread.

Just three cards come up—the Two of Coins, The Hermit, and The Enchantress. They have all come up before so they have to be important. We will start with the Two of Coins, which came up before in your Horoscope Spread in your Twelfth House of Secret Enemies (known as the karmic house). I think now that we have done your Past Lives Spread, we can see the real significance of that card. Because regardless of who you

were, there was a duality about that life. I think you were highly evolved in some ways but also that you were carried away and failed to keep the proper balance.

H: Can you be a little more specific?

SK: I see the duality as a pull between the material and the spiritual. That is further suggested by the next card of The Hermit, who is on a mountain top, gazing at a star. In the Past Lives Spread, he came up in Throne II after your marriage breakup and so he represents the stage where you are now. You remember that The World and The Sun are the closing stages of your career throne, preceded by the lesson of The Hermit. The Hermit teaches that spiritual wisdom is often realized after a period of solitude.

Everything comes together in the final card of The Enchantress. The Enchantress is physically able to cope with all life situations because she is *spiritually* strong. By being spiritually strong she is psychologically whole—there is no longer any duality about her for she has found the proper balance and achieved harmony with herself and the universe.

Once this duality has been resolved, Harriet, the implications for success are clearly represented by the cards of The World and The Sun.